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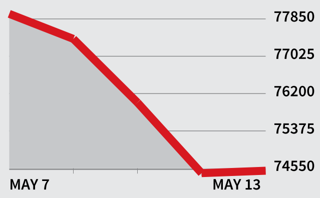

IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23412.60	+33.05
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.18	+0.01
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.70	+0.08
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	160332.00	+9307
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	287720.00	+22853

TARGETED CAMPAIGNS.
FMCG firms cut ad spends amid slowing demand and rising costs, shift focus towards targeted digital campaigns **p14**

TECHNOPHILE.
Vivo X300 Ultra packs premium cameras, immersive display and solid audio output **p4**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

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QUICKLY.

TRUST VOTE

TN CM Vijay wins floor test with 144 ‘ayes’

Chennai: The TVK-led Tamil Nadu government, headed by C Joseph Vijay, on Wednesday comfortably won the crucial floor test in the Legislative Assembly, securing the support of 144 members. While 22 MLAs voted against the motion, five remained neutral during the motion of confidence moved by the Chief Minister to prove TVK's majority on the floor. **p13**

STRATEGIC ACQUISITION

Zydus to buy US-based Assertio for ₹1,592 cr

Ahmedabad: Zydus Lifesciences, through its subsidiary Zydus Worldwide DMCC, will acquire US-based pharma firm Assertio Holdings Inc in an all-cash deal valued at $166.4 million (around ₹1,592 crore). Zydus will acquire outstanding shares of Assertio at $23.50 per share in cash. Assertio's board approved the transaction after determining that Zydus' was a “superior proposal” under its revised merger agreement with Garda Therapeutics. **p11**

Govt raises import duty on gold, silver, platinum to conserve forex

LOSING SHEEN. Tightens the concessional UAE route in a move to ease pressure on CAD

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Days after Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged citizens to defer gold purchases for a year as part of a broader national effort to conserve foreign exchange, the government on Wednesday sharply increased the import duty on precious metals amid concerns over the external sector and the impact of the West Asia crisis on India's import bill.

A Finance Ministry notification said the import duty on gold and silver had been increased to 15 per cent from 6 per cent, while the levy on platinum had been raised to 15.4 per cent from 6.4 per cent. Consequential changes had also been made to gold and silver dore, coins and related items, with the revised rates coming into effect from Wednesday.

“This has been done as a policy measure aimed at safeguarding macroeconomic stability, conserving foreign exchange and moderating non-essential imports during a period of heightened global uncertainty arising from the ongoing West Asia crisis,” an official said. Officials said the import duty on precious metals had historically been adjusted in line with prevailing macroeconomic and external sector conditions.

GETTING PRICIER. A customer checking a necklace at a jewellery shop in Amritsar. Economists said the higher tariffs could moderate gold demand PTI

In the Union Budget 2024-25, import duties on gold and silver were cut from 15 per cent to 6 per cent and on platinum from 15.4 per cent to 6.4 per cent, reflecting what officials described as a more comfortable external sector position at the time.

UAE ROUTE

The government simultaneously tightened the concessional import route available under the India-UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA), raising the duty on gold imported under the tariff rate quota to 14 per cent from 5 per cent. The move preserves only the existing 1 percentage point preferential margin over the standard duty rate and is aimed at plugging a possible arbitrage route after the sharp increase in headline Customs duty.

The tightening comes amid growing concern over rising gold imports routed through Dubai. According to an analysis by the Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI), gold bar imports from the UAE surged to $16.5 billion in 2025 from $2.9 billion in 2022, while the UAE's share in India's gold imports rose to 28 per cent from 7.9 per cent during the same period.

Officials said the latest duty hike is part of a broader strategy to conserve foreign exchange and prioritise essential imports such as crude oil, fertilizers, industrial raw materials, defence equipment and capital goods, amid global uncertainties and the risk of a widening current account deficit (CAD).

DEMAND IMPACT

Economists said the higher tariff could moderate gold demand and offer some relief to the CAD, though part of the gains may be offset by smuggling.

Chief Economist at CareEdge Rajani Sinha said a cumulative 9 percentage point increase in duty could reduce gold demand by 50-60 tonnes annually, lowering imports worth $6-9 billion at current international prices.

Debopam Chaudhuri, Chief Economist, Piramal Group, estimated that the move could save $2.5 billion, or about ₹23,750 crore, in FY27 if the tariff hike is fully passed on to consumers.

Also read p5

With inputs from Amiti Sen

Jewellery demand takes a hit on price jump; trade fears a surge in smuggling

Our Bureaus

The steep hike in gold import duty has sharply raised domestic bullion prices and triggered a broad slowdown in the jewellery market, with traders and jewellers across key centres reporting weaker demand, liquidity stress and a possible rise in smuggling activity.

The increase in Customs duty has pushed gold prices up by nearly 10 per cent, forcing consumers to cut back on purchases and shift towards lighter jewellery and lower-carat options, industry participants said.

SECTOR STRESS

The Gem and Jewellery Export Promotion Council (GJEPC) cautioned that the higher duties could further inflate prices and encourage smuggling, while exporters are already grappling with tighter working capital conditions. According to the industry body, exporters dealing in duty-free gold are now required to furnish bank guarantees of ₹28-30 lakh per kg, straining liquidity and slowing manufacturing cycles, especially for MSMEs that form a significant part of the sector. Across markets, jewellers maintained that India's long-term appetite for gold remains structurally resilient despite the disruption caused by the duty hike.

The price rise has shifted buyers towards lighter jewellery from 8-10 gm pieces

In Ahmedabad, jewellers said the sharp rise in prices had altered retail buying behaviour. Customers who earlier bought standard 8-10 g jewellery pieces were increasingly opting for lighter designs to stay within budget. Exchange of old gold is also emerging as a key trend.

Sachin Sawrikar, Founder and Managing Partner at Artha Bharat Investment Managers, said India's gold demand is deeply rooted in household savings behaviour and cultural consumption patterns, making it difficult to curb buying through price interventions. He warned that higher duties historically widen the gap between official and informal channels, increasing the risk of smuggling.

In Bengaluru, jewellers said near-term sentiment may soften, though structural demand linked to weddings and rituals remains intact. “Gold buying is culturally deep-rooted and not easily deferred,” said Varghese Alukkas, Managing Director of Jos Alukkas, adding that the industry is watching to see whether the current slowdown is temporary or behavioural.

In Chennai, N Anantha Padmanabhan, MD of NAC Jewellers, said the duty hike is likely to hurt sales volumes and could encourage smuggling. He said reviving the gold monetisation scheme and mobilising idle household gold would be a better alternative to repeated increases in import duties.

In Hyderabad, traders said gold prices jumped by around ₹800 to ₹16,500 per g, resulting in weaker buying and liquidity constraints.

Kolkata-based Senco Gold also warned of a sharp impact on volumes. “Volumes will be impacted. Consumers would prefer lighter jewellery and lower-carat gold. Old gold exchange will increase,” said MD and CEO Suvankar Sen. He estimated a 10-15 per cent decline in volumes, although overall value could remain elevated due to higher prices.

Inputs from Avinash Nair in Ahmedabad, Anupama Ghosh in Mumbai, Aishwarya Kumar in Bengaluru, Rohan G Das in Chennai, Naga Sridhar G in Hyderabad and Mithun Dasgupta in Kolkata

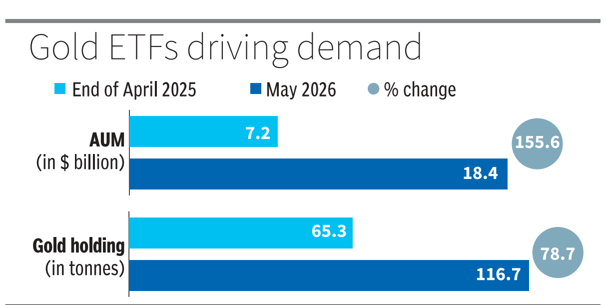
Yellow metal holdings of gold ETFs soared 79% over the past year

Lokeshwarri SK
Chennai

As the country looks for ways to bring down its imports to protect the rupee, attention has turned to the surge in gold imports in the last fiscal.

While a large part of gold imports is led by jewellery consumers, demand from exchange-traded funds has also seen a surge over the past year.

Data from the World Gold Council show that assets under management of gold ETFs listed in India increased from $7.2 billion in April 2025 to $18.4 billion in May 2026. Given the mandate to back their investments with physical gold, ETFs have increased their holdings from 65.3 tonnes to 116.7 tonnes in the same period, registering an increase of 79 per cent.



Source: WGC

WHY THE INCREASE

Gold prices have had a stellar run over the last two years, more than doubling from around $2,100 per ounce in April 2024. Heightened uncertainty caused by Trump's reciprocal tariffs and the ongoing Iran war are the prime reasons behind the increase in prices.

In times of sharp price increases, demand from jewellery buyers typically comes down while investment demand surges.

According to the World Gold Council, demand for jewellery dropped from 563 tonnes in 2024 to 440 tonnes in 2025. But in the same period, holdings of Indian gold ETFs recorded a sharp increase. Total demand from global gold exchange-traded funds amounted to 794 tonnes in 2025, driving the prices higher.

Interestingly, WGC data show that investments in gold could be in the form of gold bars and coins, besides gold ETFs.

Gold ETFs account for only 40 per cent of the gold investment demand.

INFLOWS CONTINUE

Inflows have continued into India's top gold ETFs, resulting in continued demand from them. Nippon India Gold BeES, which holds 36.5 tonnes of gold, has witnessed inflows of $1.1 billion so far in 2026. ICICI Prudential Gold iWIN ETF (gold holdings of 17.3 tonnes) received $673 million this year, while SBI ETF Gold (gold holding of 16.1 tonnes) received $522 million.

BEIJING CALLING

DIPLOMATIC PUSH. US President Donald Trump, Eric Trump and his wife Lara, along with Elon Musk, arrive to a ceremonial welcome at the Beijing Capital International Airport on Wednesday. Over the next two days, Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping will discuss both bilateral and global issues, especially the Iran war. The talks will focus on trade and tariffs, AI and technology, Taiwan and US' arms sales to Taipei, Iran and West Asia security and rare earths and supply chains **(Report on p14)** REUTERS

From Hanle to Nubra, Ladakh prepares for stargazing week

With no light pollution & vast open horizons, Ladakh turns into a natural planetarium after sunset

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

Under the vast, ink-dark skies of the Himalayan cold desert, Ladakh is preparing to turn itself into a giant natural observatory as it hosts the ‘Ladakh Astro Week 2026’ from May 20-26.

From the high-altitude plains of Hanle to the dunes of Nubra Valley, the rugged mountains of Kargil and the moonlike landscape of Lamayuru, astronomers, photographers, students and travellers will gather for a week of stargazing, astrophotography, science talks and night-sky observations under some of the clearest skies on Earth.

Organised by the Department of Tourism, Ladakh, in collaboration with the Indian Institute of Astrophysics, Bengaluru and the Indian Astronomical Observatory, Hanle, the festival reflects Ladakh's growing ambitions to position itself as a global astro-tourism destination.

COSMIC HAVEN. Hanle Dark Sky Reserve, India's first such reserve, is home to the Indian Astronomical Observatory

DARK SKY RESERVE

At the centre of the experience is the Hanle Dark Sky Reserve, India's first Dark Sky Reserve and home to the Indian Astronomical Observatory, one of the world's highest astronomical observatories. “With minimal light pollution and endless open horizons, almost every corner of Ladakh transforms into a natural planetarium after sunset,” a senior official at Ladakh's Tourism Department said.

During the day, visitors will attend solar observation sessions, science exhibitions and astro-photography galleries, while experts decode cosmic mysteries through talks on black holes, exoplanets, solar activity and the search for life in the universe.

“Between 7.30 and 11 pm each evening, guided sessions will allow participants to view constellations, planets and deep-sky objects with the naked eye and through telescopes in remote locations largely untouched by artificial light,” said the official.

Film screenings, including *Nomads Under the Stars*, and sessions on cultural astronomy will also explore how Himalayan communities historically looked to the skies for guidance and meaning.

Local tourism players said the initiative could help diversify Ladakh's tourism sector beyond its traditional summer appeal. Namgayal, who runs a travel agency in Leh, said he expected the festival to increase tourist footfall in the coming years. “The authorities must promote the event more and conduct it around the same dates every year to attract people interested in stargazing,” he added.

Kharif MSP hikes, ₹37,500 crore coal gasification push lead Cabinet decisions

Our Bureau
New Delhi

As India grapples with heightened global uncertainties and external sector pressures, the Union Cabinet on Wednesday cleared a series of measures spanning agriculture, energy and infrastructure, signalling a push to strengthen rural incomes, improve energy security and accelerate logistics modernisation.

In an apparent move to correct price distortions in certain crops, as flagged by the Economic Survey, the government announced a ₹10/quintal hike in the minimum support price (MSP) of maize and a modest 3 per cent rise in paddy MSP for kharif 2026, while pulses (except moong), oilseeds and nutri-cereal crops have been given a 4-9 per cent increase over the previous year.

Union I&B Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw briefing the media on the Cabinet's decisions SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Announcing the new MSPs for the kharif season after the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the price recommendations of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP), Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the MSPs had been fixed to ensure remunerative prices for farmers and were at least 50 per cent above the cost of production (A2+FL formula) across all 14 crops.

The government estimates the total payout to farmers at ₹2.6 lakh crore after the revision in MSPs.

ENERGY PUSH

In a major energy sector decision, the Cabinet approved a ₹37,500 crore scheme to promote coal and lignite gasification projects as part of India's broader strategy to reduce dependence on imported natural gas, methanol, ammonia and fertilizers.

The scheme aims at 100 million tonnes of coal gasification by 2030, with incentives covering up to 20 per cent of plant and machinery costs for eligible projects.

The government said coal gasification would help monetise domestic coal resources more efficiently while supporting cleaner utilisation of coal through the production of synthetic natural gas, chemicals and fertilizer feedstock. The Cabinet also approved extending coal linkage tenure for gasification projects to 30 years under the non-regulated sector framework to improve investment viability.

INFRA-DRIVE

Among other decisions, the Cabinet cleared a railway project in Gujarat involving a new broad-gauge line in Ahmedabad district to improve regional connectivity and freight movement.

It also approved the development, operation and maintenance of the Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar International Airport in Nagpur under a public-private partnership model aimed at expanding passenger and cargo handling capacity and strengthening aviation infrastructure in Central India.

Also read p3

A CH-CHE

QUICKLY.

Rolls-Royce and HAL open Hosur plant

Chennai: International Aerospace Manufacturing Private Ltd (IAMPL), a 50:50 joint venture between Rolls-Royce and Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL), on Wednesday inaugurated its expanded manufacturing facility in Hosur, Tamil Nadu, strengthening advanced aerospace manufacturing capabilities in India. OUR BUREAU

Honasa Consumer names leaders for brand building

Mumbai: Honasa Consumer Ltd, the parent company of Mamaearth, on Wednesday announced the appointment of Dheeraj Nagpal and Madhur Acharya to spearhead its next phase of category creation. They will focus on identifying and building new consumer brands, with Honasa signalling a clear strategic push beyond its existing portfolio. OUR BUREAU

Doubling of platinum import duty set to raise costs for diesel SUVs, hybrids

PAYING MORE. Increased emission-compliance costs could mean across-the-board showroom price hikes

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

ON THE CARDS. Estimates suggest price hikes of ₹2,500-4,000 for entry-level cars, ₹8,000-12,000 for mid-size diesel SUVs and ₹12,000–18,000 for strong hybrids if the costs are passed on

The decision to more than double the effective import duty on platinum to 15.4 per cent from 6.4 per cent is expected to raise the cost of emission-control systems used in cleaner internal combustion vehicles, with the biggest impact likely on diesel trucks, SUVs and strong hybrid models that use larger quantities of the precious metal in their catalytic converters.

Sharing his assessment of the development, Hemal Thakkar, Senior Practice Leader and Director at CRISIL Intelligence, said the increase in emission-compliance costs could translate into showroom price hikes of about ₹2,500-4,000 for entry-level petrol cars, ₹8,000-12,000 for mid-size diesel SUVs and ₹12,000-18,000 for strong hybrid vehicles as automakers pass on higher costs to consumers.

He noted that most original equipment manufacturers procure precious metals such as platinum and palladium directly because of economies of scale and then supply them to vendors for the manufacture of catalytic converters. Given the current demand conditions, automakers are more likely to pass on the increase gradually rather than implement a full price hike immediately.

Thakkar added that the duty hike could marginally improve the relative cost competitiveness of battery electric vehicles, which are largely insulated from this specific increase because they do not use catalytic converters or platinum-based emission-control systems. He said the move also highlights platinum's growing strategic importance in hydrogen fuel cells and electrolysers.

EMISSION COMPLIANCE

"The duty hike essentially raises the cost of emission compliance," said Randheer Singh, Founder of ForeSee Advisors and former Director, Electric Mobility, at NITI Aayog.

Industry estimates suggest entry-level petrol cars typically use 2-4 gram of platinum-group metals in their emission-control systems, compared with 6-10 gram in mid-size diesel SUVs, 10-15 gram in strong hybrids and 20 gram or more in heavy commercial vehicles.

Commercial vehicle manufacturers such as Tata Motors and Ashok Leyland are expected to be among the most affected, as heavy-duty diesel engines require larger quantities of platinum in diesel oxidation catalysts and particulate filters. Mahindra & Mahindra may also face higher costs across diesel-intensive models such as the Scorpio-N, Thar and XUV700, while strong hybrid vehicles sold by Toyota Kirloskar Motor and Maruti Suzuki are also likely to see a greater impact.

"The impact will be most visible in commercial vehicles, diesel SUVs and strong hybrids, where precious metal loading is higher," Singh said.

Girish Wagh, Managing Director and CEO, Tata Motors, said the impact of the platinum duty increase would be modest compared with the broader rise in steel, aluminium, rubber and other commodity costs.

"The duty has gone up, but the overall impact of platinum duty increase and the resulting cost increase is not going to be as significant compared to the other commodity increases we are facing," he said during the company's post-results conference call.

Demand for heavy trucks lifts TaMo CV Q4 profit 70%

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Tata Motors Commercial Vehicles on Tuesday reported a 70 per cent jump in March-quarter profit after tax to ₹2,406 crore from ₹1,419 crore a year earlier, while revenue from operations rose 22 per cent to ₹24,452 crore, driven by strong heavy truck demand and operating leverage.

For FY26, revenue increased 11 per cent to ₹77,399 crore. Profit after tax fell 23 per cent to ₹3,362 crore, reflecting ₹3,700 crore of exceptional items related to mark-to-market losses on Tata Capital investments, new labour code provisions and demerger-related costs. Excluding these one-time charges, the company delivered record operating profit and free cash flow.

EBITDA margin for FY26 improved to 13.2 per cent (12 per cent), while profit before tax before exceptional items rose 46 per cent to ₹8,682 crore. Free cash flow increased to ₹9,186 crore (₹7,007 crore), domestic net cash stood at ₹7,500 crore and Auto ROCE improved to 72 per cent (61 per cent). On a consolidated basis, Tata Motors ended FY26 with net cash of ₹13,713 crore.

Commercial vehicle wholesales rose 25 per cent to 132,000 units in Q4 FY26 and 14 per cent to 428,000 units for the full year. Domestic and export volumes increased 12 per cent and 54 per cent, respectively, while Tata Motors retained a 35.7 per cent share of the domestic commercial vehicle market, including 55 per cent in heavy commercial vehicles.

Speaking during the post-results conference call, MD and CEO Girish Wagh said FY26 marked a "clear inflection point" for the CV industry, with volumes surpassing the pre-FY19 peak, supported by GST 2.0 reforms and sustained infrastructure spending.

In FY26, Tata Motors launched 17 next-generation trucks, introduced the Ace Pro mini-truck, secured export order for 70,000 vehicles for Indonesia and won more than 5,000 bus orders from State transport undertakings.

Petitioner withdraws plea to stall Tata Trusts meeting after Bombay High Court's criticism

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Petitioner Suresh Tulsiram Patilkhede, who was seeking a stay on the May 16 board meeting of the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), withdrew his plea before the Bombay High Court on Wednesday after the Court strongly criticised his conduct and questioned the basis of the petition.

A vacation Bench of Justices Advait Sethna and Sandesh Patil said it was "shocked" to learn that the petitioner had not himself filed the representations before the Charity Commissioner on which his case was based. The court observed that the representations had instead been made by third parties.

The Bench said, "We are constrained to observe that the proceedings bring out a shocking state of affairs. This is more so for the reason that certain representations are made to the Charity Commissioner with regards to violation of section 30(A) 2. On a query put to petitioner, I have been informed that the representations are pending. What is disturbing is that these representations aren't made by the petitioner but by some other party whose particulars aren't known to this court."

The court observed that the lawyer said the petitioner admitted it was a mistake and to condone it.

It also pointed out that the petition was moved on grounds of extreme urgency as the meeting was on May 16, and it would violate the section and the resolution passed should not be acted upon.

The court expressed *prima facie* displeasure with the manner in which the proceedings had been filed and

The court expressed *prima facie* displeasure with the manner the proceedings had been filed

said that the petitioner's request to withdraw was granted. It added that if they wanted to apply somewhere else, they could, but strictly in accordance with law.

CHALLENGE PLEA

Patilkhede had challenged the composition of the SRTT board, contending that it violated amendments to the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act that came into force on September 1, 2025. The petitioner argued that three of the trust's six trustees were perpetual trustees, exceeding the amended law's 25 per cent cap unless specifically permitted by the trust deed.

The petition said that the board must first be reconstituted before any meeting could be held, claiming decisions taken at the May 16 meeting would otherwise be illegal. However, the bench questioned the plea's maintainability, observing that the Charity Commissioner was already empowered to examine such issues.

"Do not pre-empt anything. This is too early for you to say all this," Justice Patil remarked.

Senior advocates Abhishek Manu Singhvi and Janak Dwarkadas, appearing for some board members, argued that Patilkhede was neither a trustee nor a beneficiary of SRTT.

They also contended that the amendment was prospective, not retrospective, and noted that the board had already held several meetings since September 2025 without objection.

To protect demand momentum, Tata Motors holds back truck price hikes despite input cost surge

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Tata Motors Commercial Vehicles on Wednesday said it will absorb a significant part of the recent surge in commodity costs rather than pass them on to customers, holding back further truck price hikes to protect demand momentum even as raw material inflation intensified in the current quarter.

"We have taken a price increase of around 2 per cent effective April 1. For the rest, we have decided not to pass through and will work on other cost levers to manage the situation, because we do not want to disturb the growth momentum," Girish Wagh, Managing Director and CEO, Tata Motors, said during the post-results analyst and media call.

Sentiment is a bit cautious, customers may be thinking twice, but since the demand is there, they are going ahead with purchases

GIRISH WAGH
MD and CEO, Tata Motors

"The commodity increase has been quite severe."

Wagh said cost pressures, driven by steel, aluminium, rubber and precious metals, intensified further in the June quarter after rising in the March quarter.

FUEL IMPACT

He added that diesel remains a critical variable for fleet operators because depending on the segment, it accounts for 25-50 per cent of a truck's total cost of ownership, making fuel prices a key determinant of replacement demand.

Despite these pressures, Wagh said underlying demand remains strong. April volumes posted healthy double-digit growth across segments, supported by robust freight availability and e-way bill activity.

CAUTIOUS MOOD

"Sentiment is a bit cautious, customers may be thinking twice, but since the demand is there, they are going ahead with purchases," he said.

For FY27, Wagh expects the domestic commercial vehicle industry to grow in the single-digits, with the outlook dependent on diesel prices, the trajectory of the West Asia conflict and the strength of the monsoon. He said the demand revival that began after GST rate rationalisation continues to support the market.

Tata Motors has also introduced tighter controls on travel and other discretionary spending as a precautionary measure while maintaining its planned capital expenditure programme.

Wagh said FY27 priorities include scaling the next-generation truck and battery electric vehicle portfolios, consolidating gains in small commercial vehicles and expanding non-cyclical businesses.

TVS to launch Norton motorcycles in India in Q2 FY27

Our Bureau
Chennai

TVS Motor Company is gearing up to launch premium motorcycles under the Norton Motorcycles brand in India and globally from the second quarter of FY27, while stepping up investments in product development, manufacturing capacity and R&D.

Speaking to analysts after announcing the company's Q4 and FY26 results, TVS Motor Managing Director KN Radhakrishnan said FY27 would be a "very important" year for Norton as the company prepares to introduce new models, including Atlas and Atlas GT.

The Solihull plant in the UK will manufacture one high-end model, while other models will be produced in India. "We are leveraging India, especially the Hosur plant, in a big way," Radhakrishnan said.

Sources said Norton motorcycles being manufactured at Hosur are already undergoing road tests in India ahead of their commercial launch. TVS Motor acquired the iconic British premium motorcycle brand in April 2020, marking its entry into the superbike segment above 850cc.

GROWTH OUTLOOK

Radhakrishnan said the company expects to outperform the industry in FY27, driven by strong demand for scooters, electric vehicles, premium motorcycles and exports across Africa, Asia and Latin America.

"However, we will remain watchful of commodity inflation, supply-chain disruptions and geopolitical uncertainties, particularly their

KN Radhakrishnan, Managing Director, TVS Motor

impact on logistics and input costs," he said.

CAPEX PUSH

The company has planned capital expenditure of around ₹3,000 crore for FY27. Of this, nearly ₹2,000 crore will be allocated towards product development and new products, while over ₹1,000 crore will go into expanding two-wheeler and three-wheeler manufacturing capacity and strengthening R&D infrastructure, Radhakrishnan said.

Norton motorcycles being manufactured at Hosur are already undergoing road tests in India, ahead of their commercial launch

TVS Motor plans to add 1.5 million units of capacity over the next 12 months, taking total production capacity to around 8.3 million units.

STRONG FY26 SHOW

TVS Motor on Wednesday reported a 17 per cent increase in consolidated net profit to ₹819 crore for the quarter ended March 31, 2026, compared with ₹697 crore in the year-ago period. Revenue rose 34 per cent to ₹15,053 crore from ₹11,542 crore, driven by robust ICE and EV sales.

For FY26, the company reported a 34 per cent rise in net profit to ₹3,186 crore, while revenue grew 37 per cent to ₹56,069 crore.

The company recorded its highest-ever annual sales of 58.9 lakh units in FY26, up 24 per cent year-on-year.

Other income for the March 2026 quarter included a ₹53 crore loss on fair valuation of investments held by the company.

The board, at its meeting held in March, declared an interim dividend of ₹12 per share (1,200 per cent), involving a payout of ₹570 crore for FY26.

Airtel Q4 PAT down on high base last year

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Q4 scorecard (₹ crore)

	Q4FY25	Q4FY26	change (%)
Net profit	11,021.8	7,325.1	-33.5
Revenue	47,876.2	55,383.2	16.0
ARPU (₹)	245	257	4.8

Bharti Airtel reported a 33.5 per cent year-on-year dip in consolidated net profit to ₹7,325.1 crore for Q4FY26, down from ₹11,021.18 crore in the year-ago period. It attributed the drop primarily to an exceptionally high base in the previous year which included a one-time tax gain of ₹2,892 crore.

Despite this bottom-line compression, the telco's top-line health remained robust, with consolidated revenue climbing 16 per cent to ₹55,383.2 crore (₹47,876.2 crore). This divergence between profit and revenue highlighted a quarter defined by steady organic growth and high capex, even as accounting adjustments masked the company's operational momentum.

"We ended FY26 on a strong note, demonstrating the power of our diversified portfolio. FY26 was an important year in our journey – we crossed the 650 million customer mark, launched our telco grade sovereign cloud, received RBI approval through our subsidiary to commence the lending business, and accelerated the expansion of our data centre footprint," Gopal Vittal, Executive Vice-Chairman, said.

He said the company would continue to accelerate its investment towards building world-class digital networks, future proof Airtel by putting artificial intelligence (AI) at the heart and sharpen the portfolio for long-term growth. "In addition, a major focus for us is to completely eliminate diesel from our operations. We are working with Indus Towers to scale clean energy...Our balance sheet strength is underpinned by disciplined execution and prudent capital allocation. At the same time, we believe further tariff repair remains critical to support continued investments and long-term value creation," Vittal added.

RE-APPOINTMENT

The company also said in a regulatory filing that its board had approved the re-appointment of Sunil Bharti Mittal as Chairman for a further term of five consecutive years from October 1.

Tube Investments Q4 revenue up 20%; nod for long-term borrowing of up to ₹350 crore

Our Bureau
Chennai

Tube Investments of India (TII), part of the Murugappa Group, reported robust financial results in the fourth quarter of FY26, and the full fiscal year, driven by strong performance across its various businesses.

TII's consolidated revenue for Q4FY26 was ₹ 6,215 crore against ₹5,150 crore in the year-ago period. Profit after tax was ₹234 crore (₹158 crore).

For FY26, TII's consolidated revenue was ₹22,847 crore, up 17 per cent. Profit at ₹1,118 crore grew 6 per cent. The company's revenue was driven by the performance of CG Power and Industrial Solutions, a subsidiary company, in which TII holds 56 per cent stake.

However, Shanti Gears, another subsidiary, where TII holds 70 per cent stake, saw a decline in performance.

BUSINESS BREAK-UP

TII operates across engineering, mobility, metal-formed products and industrial businesses, with its focus areas spanning bicycles, automotive components, electric mobility and precision engineering. The engineering business revenue for FY26 was ₹5,612 crore (₹5,029 crore). Profit before interest and tax was ₹689 crore (₹617 crore). Mobility business revenue was ₹783 crore (₹671 crore). Profit before interest and tax was ₹19 crore (₹5 crore).

To meet the company's funding requirements for FY27, the board has approved long-term borrowing up to ₹350 crore. This will be by way of term loan and/or privately placed secured non-convertible debentures.

With focus on e-mobility, JBM Auto renames OEM division as EV business

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

JBM Auto is sharpening its focus on electric mobility, with its board renaming the OEM division as the "EV business," signalling a strategic shift from a traditional auto components maker to an electric mobility platform. The move comes as the EV business has emerged as its principal growth engine, even as rapid expansion places increasing pressure on working capital and the balance sheet.

Revenue from the EV business rose 16.2 per cent to ₹2,307 crore in FY26 from ₹1,985 crore in FY25, accounting for nearly 38 per cent of consolidated revenue. In Q4, segment revenue increased 11.4 per cent to ₹831 crore, while segment profit climbed 44.5 per cent to ₹106 crore. At the consolidated level, revenue rose 4.1 per cent to ₹6,088 crore (₹5,849 crore) in FY26. However, trade receivables more than doubled to ₹2,185 crore (₹1,007 crore), operating cash flow fell 59.4 per cent to ₹160 crore (₹394 crore) and borrowings increased 61.4 per cent to ₹2,070 crore (₹1,282 crore).

CAPITAL-HEAVY

The numbers highlight the

JBM Auto said it now commands 79 per cent of the electric tarmac bus market

capital-intensive nature of JBM's electric bus model, where vehicles, batteries and charging systems must be deployed well before payments are fully realised from public transport contracts.

JBM said it now commands 79 per cent of the electric tarmac bus market and more than 50 per cent share in intercity electric luxury coaches.

Capital expenditure remained elevated at ₹713 crore in FY26, including ₹389 crore of capital work-in-progress, while the EV business asset base expanded to ₹5,129 crore — more than twice the division's annual revenue. Nishant Arya, Vice-Chairman and Managing Director, had told *businessline* earlier that JBM's order-book stands at around 10,000 electric buses and could at least double over the next one-two years as it brings in leasing partners to support deployment and financing. JBM is also exploring a potential $500 million fundraise to support execution of the order pipeline and strengthen its electric mobility platform.

Cabinet clears ₹37,500 cr scheme to promote coal gasification

EXPLORING OPTIONS. Move to enhance energy security, reduce import dependency

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

To reduce import dependency for gas, the Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved a policy to extract gas from coal. The scheme is expected to deliver gas in 4-5 years.

"The scheme for promotion of surface coal/lignite gasification projects that has been cleared by the Cabinet will further energy security, boost investment and create job opportunities. It will add strength to our efforts to strengthen the tech and innovation system as well," Prime Minister Narendra Modi said in a social media post.

Coal gasification refers to the process of converting dry fuel into synthetic gas (syngas), which is used as an alternative fuel and helps reduce carbon emissions.

This process supports the production of methanol, fertilizers, hydrogen and chemicals, cutting the reliance on imports.

Earlier, speaking on the decisions taken by the Cabinet, Union Information & Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said, "An outlay of ₹37,500 crore has been kept for this scheme, and there will be an investment of around ₹3 lakh crore in this, and the projects will be put up for gasifying 75 million tonnes of coal."

KEY DECISION. Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw at a press conference in New Delhi on Wednesday SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Further, he said that the country had 401 mt of known coal reserves, which are enough for the next 200 years.

"We all know about the current geopolitical situation. So, we have to take all the decisions to become *aatmanirbhar*. In this context, a big decision on coal gasification was taken today," he said. The scheme marks a major step towards accelerating the country's coal gasification programme, advancing the national target of gasifying 100 mt of coal by 2030, strengthening energy security and reducing the dependence on imports of key products such as LNG, urea, ammonia and methanol.

FINANCIAL INCENTIVE

Under the scheme, the financial incentive at a maximum of 20 per cent of the cost of plant and machinery will be provided, the statement said, adding that the selection would be through a transparent and competitive bidding process, with an evaluation framework benchmarking project cost, coal input and syngas output.

The incentive will be disbursed in four equal instalments and linked to project milestones.

CAPS FOR INCENTIVES

Under the scheme, "financial incentive for any single project (will be) capped at ₹5,000 crore; for any single product (except synthetic natural gas and urea) at ₹9,000 crore; and any single entity group at ₹12,000 crore across all projects". Due to the scheme, the investment mobilisation is likely to be at ₹2.5-3 lakh crore.

The utilisation of coal and lignite is likely to generate ₹6,300 crore annually from 75 mt of gasification envisaged under the scheme, plus downstream revenue from GST and other levies.

The incentive builds on the National Coal Gasification Mission (2021) and an ₹8,500-crore scheme approved in January 2024, under which eight projects worth ₹6,233 crore are under implementation.

Lease extension paves way for Nagpur airport upgrade

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Union Cabinet has approved a lease extension for the Nagpur International Airport, clearing the way for its modernisation under a public private partnership (PPP) model.

The decision assumes significance as it marks an important milestone in the development of the airport under the multi-modal international cargo hub and airport at Nagpur (MIHAN) project.

According to an official statement, the move will allow MIHAN India (MIL) to license the airport to concessionaire GMR Nagpur International Airport Ltd (GNIAL) for 30 years. The asset has been under MIL since its formation in 2009. The company is a joint venture between the AAI and the Maharashtra Airport Development Company.

However, the lease deed was delayed due to land demarcation issues and was set up until August 6, 2039.

In 2016, MIL invited global bids to run the airport through the PPP model. GMR Airports emerged as the highest bidder, offering a revenue share of 5.76 per cent, which was later revised to 14.49 per cent of gross revenue. The bidding process was cancelled in March 2020, leading to a legal dispute. The Bombay High Court case eventually went to the Supreme Court, which ruled in favour of GMR Airports.

Following the Supreme Court judgment dated September 27, 2024, MIL signed a concession agreement with GMR Nagpur International Airport Ltd on October 8, 2024.


This enables the concessionaire to operate the airport for 30 years from the commercial operations date

Consequently, with the Cabinet's approval, the lease period will now align with the 30-year concession period, enabling the transfer of the airport to the joint venture company.

KEY AVIATION HUB

The project is expected to drive infrastructure upgrades, improve passenger services and expand cargo handling capacity.

As per the statement, GNIAL will develop Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar International Airport in phases, with a planned capacity of 30 million passengers annually.

The airport is expected to emerge as a key aviation hub in Central India, strengthening connectivity and economic development in the Vidarbha region, while also significantly boosting cargo operations.

Nod for Ahmedabad–Dholera semi high-speed rail project

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India will build a semi high-speed double-line rail project between Ahmedabad (Sarkhej) and Dholera at an estimated cost of ₹20,667 crore.

Accordingly, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved the project under the Ministry of Railways with a completion timeline up to 2030–31.

The project, an official statement said, will add about 134 km to the Railway network and is being developed using indigenously developed technology.

According to the statement, it will be India's first semi high-speed rail project and is planned as a reference model for the phased expansion of such corridors across the country.

FASTER CONNECTIVITY

The proposed line will provide faster connectivity between Ahmedabad, the Dholera Special Investment Region, the upcoming Dholera airport and the Lothal National Maritime Heritage Complex. Besides, the corridor is expected to reduce travel time between Ahmedabad and Dholera, enabling improved daily commuting and same-day return travel.


The project will add about 134 km to the railway network

Further, the project is aligned with the PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan, with a focus on multimodal connectivity and logistics efficiency through integrated planning and stakeholder consultations.

The new line is expected to improve mobility and enhance service reliability within the rail network.

Additionally, the project is expected to provide direct connectivity to around 284 villages with a combined population of about five lakh.

India, Chile review progress of free trade pact talks

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

India and Chile, a South American nation, on Wednesday reviewed the progress of negotiations for the proposed free trade agreement and discussed modalities for its early conclusion, an official statement said.

Chilean Foreign Affairs Minister Francisco Perez Mackenna held meetings with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal and Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal here.

"Apart from discussing the modalities for early conclusion of Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement, the interactions also covered a broad range of issues relating to trade facilitation, market access, investment promotion and strengthening institutional economic engagement between the two countries," according to the Commerce Ministry.

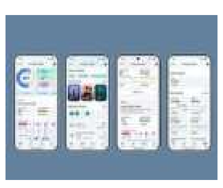
CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - MAY 14 - 2026

TECH DIGEST.

OnePlus unveils Nord CE6 series

OnePlus has introduced the Nord CE6 series in India, comprising the Nord CE6 and Nord CE6 Lite, focusing on performance, gaming, battery life and long-term usability. The Nord CE6 is built around a Snapdragon 7s Gen 4 platform with a dual-chip architecture, supporting up to 144 FPS gaming and sustained performance through features such as a high touch sampling rate and dedicated gaming optimisations. The Nord CE6 Lite is powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 7400 Apex chipset, with support for high frame rate gaming and sustained thermal performance through a vapour chamber cooling system. It features a 6.72-inch FHD+ display with a 144 Hz refresh rate and similar input optimisation technology as the standard model. The device includes a 7000 mAh battery with 45 W fast charging and bypass charging and AI-assisted imaging features. The Nord CE6 starts at ₹27,999 with open sales that began on May 8, while the Nord CE6 Lite went live on May 12.

Fitbit joins Google Health app, introduces AI coach



Google has announced updates focused on expanding its health and wellness ecosystem, aimed at enabling users to take greater control of their personal health through continuous, proactive and personalised guidance. As part of this, the Fitbit app is being transitioned into the Google Health app from May 19, building on Fitbit's existing health-tracking capabilities and consolidating it into a unified platform for managing overall wellness. Central to this update is the introduction of Google Health Coach, an AI-powered feature built on Gemini that provides personalised guidance based on user data, goals and routines. The coaching system continuously adapts using real-time health metrics, offering dynamic fitness plans, sleep analysis and contextual recommendations within a single platform. It combines activity data, sleep patterns and other health inputs to generate tailored insights, identify trends and support goal tracking. Users can interact with the coach conversationally to interpret their data, adjust fitness plans or receive guidance for specific situations such as travel and recovery.

EH-LS9000B 4K Home Theatre Projector out now

Epson has introduced the EH-LS9000B 4K Home theatre projector designed for high-end, large-screen viewing environments. It features native 4K resolution (3820 × 2160) combined with Epson's 3LCD projection technology. The projector uses a solid-state laser light source, for stable performance, reduced maintenance and long operational life.

The system supports screen dimensions of up to 300 inches (762 cm). The laser light source is rated for up to 20,000 hours of operation. The projector is also optimised for quiet operation, with noise levels as low as 22 dB in Eco mode and supports flexible installation and integrates with modern AV ecosystems, allowing seamless compatibility with home automation and professional control systems.

In terms of connectivity, it includes HDMI with eARC/ARC support, along with RS-232C and trigger output interfaces for advanced system integration. It comes with a warranty of three years or up to 20,000 hours of operation, whichever comes first, and is priced ₹3,69,999.

reMarkable launches Paper Pure tablet

reMarkable has introduced Paper Pure, a 10.3-inch black-and-white paper tablet designed for note taking, document annotation and focused digital workflows. Built on the company's existing paper tablet platform, it combines a textured writing surface with updated display and software capabilities aimed at replicating a paper-like experience while enabling digital organisation and sharing.

The device uses a third-generation Canvas display designed for high contrast and clarity, with low-latency ink response of around 21 milliseconds. Paper Pure is designed as a lightweight and portable device, weighing 360 g and measuring 6 mm in thickness. It is powered by a battery rated for up to three weeks of use under typical conditions, such as approximately one hour of daily note taking. The device also incorporates sustainability-focused design elements, with 38 per cent of its materials sourced from recycled inputs.

The reMarkable Paper Pure is expected to begin shipping in early June, with a starting price of $399 (approximately ₹38,160).

Ultra by features, ultra by price

VIVO X300 ULTRA. Discover the phone's premium features, stunning camera capabilities

COMPELLING CASE. The X300 Ultra offers arguably the most comprehensive camera experience currently available on Android, supported by a top-tier display, audio and multimedia package BIJOY GHOSH

Siddharth Mathew Cherian

Daylight shots exhibit excellent shadow and highlight retention with edge-to-edge sharpness. The hardware allows up to 10x optical zoom without breaking

At a time when global supply chains and rising component costs have pushed smartphone prices higher, true flagship releases have become increasingly rare. In a year with fewer top-tier launches, vivo has expanded its line-up with the X300 Ultra and the X300 FE. As the premium centrepiece of the series, the X300 Ultra has been on my test bench, and here is my comprehensive take on how it performs.

DESIGN

The Ultra measures in at 6.42 × 3.02 × 0.33 inches, which is slim for a huge phone. I reviewed the Victory Green edition, which pairs a polished aluminium frame with a brushed finish glass back panel. The build is sturdy, and the Glass Fiber Back Cover gives a premium feel and proved resistant to smudges and scratches throughout the testing period.

Rated at IP68 and IP69 for dust and water resistance, the X300 Ultra is built like a tank for the weather elements. However, at 232 g, its heft is noticeable and it tends to weigh down a pocket.

The massive rear camera housing causes significant wobbling when the phone is placed on a flat surface. Further, the module's prominent profile catches on fabric when sliding it into pockets and attracts smudges easily, requiring frequent cleaning before shooting.

DISPLAY

The phone's 6.82-inch 2K ZEISS Master Color AMOLED display is great, characterised by vivid colour rendition and deep contrast. The near-borderless design provides an immersive multimedia experience; while streaming *Citadel* or *Person of Interest*, the panel rendered daytime scenes with striking vibrancy and night time sequences with true, ink-like blacks.

Equipped with Ultra XDR and viewfinder-grade calibration, the screen offers high-accuracy monitoring that remains perfectly legible even under direct sunlight. While the panel occasionally boosts sky brightness beyond natural levels on the display while shooting, this high luminance proves invaluable for outdoor shooting and precise framing in harsh lighting.

SOUND

The dual stereo speaker setup delivers a balanced audio profile with respectable bass and treble response even at maximum volume. While streaming *Tame Impala* on Spotify, the system effectively isolated Kevin Parker's vocals, ensuring they remained distinct and clear without being overshadowed by the complex, layered psychedelic synth-pop instrumentation. The speakers feel just good as opposed to a rounded experience in terms of soundstage depth at higher volumes.

PERFORMANCE

The X300 Ultra is powered by the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 mobile platform, paired with a dedicated Pro Imaging Chip VS1+ for enhanced processing. Thermal management is handled by a large liquid cooling vapour chamber to maintain performance stability during intensive tasks.

In AnTuTu, the X300 Ultra scored 39,09,801 placing it second after the Red Magic 11 Pro (3963575) and above the iQOO 15 at (3719658). Gaming was fluid with games such as BGMI being able to run at a steady 120 FPS for sustained duration without throttling.

The phone runs on Origin OS 6 based off Android 16 and the interface is pretty much clear and with minimal bloatware which, on occasion, tends to give push notifications from v-store and other app notifications.

CAMERAS

The X300 Ultra's imaging system is headlined by a 35 mm main camera using a 200 MP Sony LYTIA 901 sensor (1/1.12") with CIPA 6.5 OIS and 12-bit HDR. The 85 mm telephoto lens features a 200 MP sensor (1/1.4") paired with a 3° gimbal-like OIS system rated at CIPA 7.0, meeting strict ZEISS APO standards for chromatic aberration control. Complementing these is a 14 mm ultra-wide camera powered by a 50 MP Sony LYTIA 818 sensor (1/1.28") with CIPA 6.0 stabilisation, while a 50MP autofocus sensor handles the front. These modules are integrated with a multi-spectral imaging system using a 5 MP sensor with 12 colour channels to ensure high colour accuracy.

In practice, this ZEISS lens array delivers some of the sharpest, clearest daylight and low-light images currently available. Daylight shots exhibit excellent shadow and highlight retention, with impressive edge-to-edge sharpness. The hardware allows for up to 10x optical zoom before any noticeable degradation in quality occurs.

Night time performance is equally strong, preserving fine details with minimal noise. For action shots, the 60 fps AF tracking in Snapshot Mode proves highly effective at locking onto fast-moving subjects. Selfies, too, retained more details on the face along with capturing the natural skin tone.

The videography suite is equally robust, featuring a new Pro Video Mode that supports multi-focal 4K 120 fps recording in 10-bit Log, alongside 4K 120 fps slow-motion across various focal lengths. The quad-mic recording system effectively reduces ambient noise, providing clear, high-fidelity audio that holds up well for professional use.

For power users, vivo offers accessories, including a 400 mm Telephoto Extender (₹27,999), a 200 mm Extender (₹15,999), and an Imaging Grip with a 2300 mAh battery (₹11,999) or a comprehensive photography kit, including the phone and all these accessories for ₹2,09,999. While I tested the device without the external extenders, the native 10x optical zoom provided more than enough reach and versatility for most photography needs.

BATTERY

The X300 Ultra features a 6,600 mAh silicon-carbon battery that supports 100 W wired and 40 W wireless FlashCharge. In real-world testing, the device comfortably lasts a full day under medium-to-heavy workloads including frequent calls, extensive photo and video capture and web browsing—while light usage can stretch the battery life towards the two-day mark. Using the included 100 W power brick, the phone charges from 10 per cent to 100 per cent in under 50 minutes, a commendable result for a flagship with a capacity this large.

VERDICT

The X300 Ultra offers arguably the most comprehensive camera experience currently available on Android, rivalling the high standards set by the Oppo Find series in recent years. This imaging capability is supported by a top-tier display, robust audio and a refined multimedia package. However, entering the pricing territory of the iPhone 17 Pro Max and the Samsung Galaxy S26 Ultra, especially with the additional cost of the Zeiss lens extenders and accessories makes for a challenging value proposition.

Yet, for those specifically seeking the best Android camera system to fuel a career in content creation and photography, the X300 Ultra stands as a powerful tool.

SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹1,59,999 (16 GB + 512 GB)
Pros: Top of the line cameras, great display and decent sound
Cons: Expensive, light bloatware

Apple and MAMI Select showcase how filmmakers are redefining the medium with technology

Ashwin Rajagopalan

POCKET CINEMA. (left) The vapour chamber in iPhone 17 Pro Max kept the device running smoothly throughout the filming of *Pathanam*, and (right) Shreela Agarwal using internal stabilisation on the iPhone 17 Pro Max

If you had walked in late to PVR Lido, Mumbai, where four short films (in Malayalam, Hindu, Marathi and Bengali) were showcased as part of MAMI (Mumbai Academy of Moving Images) Select, you might not have guessed that these films were all shot on an iPhone 17 Pro Max. This year's films featured an assortment of stories that took viewers to the streets of Mumbai that became the backdrop for a clandestine affair to a young misfit navigating Goa's vibrant beaches and divinity and humanity in Kerala.

FOUR CHOSEN FILMS

MAMI 2026 marks the third successive year of MAMI's collaboration with Apple. One of last year's shorts — *Seeing Red* (a Tamil film mentored by Vetrimaaran) has crossed one million views on YouTube. This year's mentors included Sriram Raghavan, Chaitanya Tamhane, Dibakar Banerjee and Geetu Mohandas — winners of accolades from the National Film Awards, the Asian Film Awards, the Venice International Film Festival and the Sundance Film Festival, to name a few. To make their shorts, filmmakers Shreela Agarwal, Ritesh Sharma, Robin Joy and Dhritisree Sarkar tapped into the pro camera system, cinema-grade video capabilities and advanced features of iPhone 17 Pro Max, as well as MacBook Pro with M5 and iPad Pro with M5 for additional support.

PARADISE FALL

Robin Joy was influenced by the films of Werner Herzog and Giuseppe Tornatore that made him realise that it's okay to be a little weird in telling stories. The Film and Television Institute of India graduate served as associate director and dialogue writer on *All We Imagine as Light*, which was awarded the Grand Prix at the 2024 Cannes Film Festival. Joy's MAMI Select: Filmed on iPhone short, *Pathanam* (Paradise Fall), tells the story of an angel who collapses in the backyard of an atheist — and the socio-political chaos that ensues. He told me that shooting on an iPhone 17 Pro Max allowed him the option of shooting in Pro-Res 4K RAW. It helped him in the post-production stage with a higher dynamic range.

Joy believes the unique land and waterscapes of Vypin, Kochi, enabled him to create magical realism that was boosted by the iPhone's camera creds. One of the highlight shots of the film is a moon reflection complemented by night shots that add to the film's visual appeal. The iPhone's Action Mode came to the fore when the team was thrown about on a small boat in the middle of a lake. He adds that the advantage with a smaller camera like a phone is that you can move closer without intimidating the subject as much as a cinema camera.

"Cinema is built on emotions and what we want to communicate, the medium is not important. When first started off, I shot a short film on a super 16 and blew it up to 35. I wanted that flavour. The digital medium exploded after that. There's also a voyeuristic element, especially where you want to shoot at certain locations without disturbing the ambience or the people," says Geetu Mohandas, who served as Joy's mentor, but wasn't sure what was expected of her as a mentor. She reminisced about her initial years as a film maker when she preferred working alone rather than assist someone. It's why she tried not to step on Joy's shoes and blur his cinematic vision.

A PRACTICAL SHOOTING OPTION

A graduate of Singapore's Lasalle College of the Arts, Shreela Agarwal put cinema aside to chase her dream of becoming a boxer after a career-ending injury. Fittingly, her first film was a boxing documentary titled *BMCLD*. Her newest film, *11.11*, "a love letter to Mumbai after dark", tells the story of two women on a first date. In the script, her protagonists walk and dance under city street lights and on dim beaches, presenting challenging lighting conditions. "We tested iPhone 17 Pro Max in a very unique way," says Agarwal. ProRes RAW data capture allowed her team to push the ISO in post-production. According to her, the benefits of filming on iPhone for aspiring filmmakers aren't just aesthetic — they're also practical.

SHIFT FOCUS

Ritesh Sharma credits his origins as a street theatre performer for paving the way for his pivot to filmmaking: Filmed on iPhone entry, *She Sells Seashells*, follows Maruti, a 17-year-old Rajasthani migrant who sells trinkets on the beach, and her dream of stepping inside an upmarket seaside restaurant in Goa — a seemingly trivial act that becomes a study in dignity in the director's capable hands. iPhone 17 Pro Max allowed Sharma to draw the audience deeper into his protagonist's mental state. "There are dreamlike sequences where we see Maruti's internal world," he explains. "Cinematic mode allows us to shift focus between her reality and what she is feeling. "During preproduction, I'd record whatever I was hearing with the native mics on iPhone, transfer the file and edit it right away on MacBook Pro."

ZOOMING IN

Shot on iPhone 7 during the height of the Covid pandemic, Dhritisree Sarkar's first short film, *Chhaddonam* (Pen Name), went on to be acquired by MUBI. "Accessibility is important for a beginner," she says. "You can just pick up your phone and shoot whatever story you want to tell." Her new film, *Kathar Katha* (The Tale of Katha), tells the story of a news anchor who has been diagnosed with a rare condition that progressively seals all of her external orifices — a premise that emerged from a personal moment.

She pushes in close with an iPhone to capture the reflection of a *luchi*, a Bengali bread, puffing up in Katha's eyeball as an expression of her growing rage. The 8x optical zoom at 200 mm on iPhone 17 Pro Max was also pivotal to depicting the character's emotion.

At a time when most content creators rarely think beyond 60 seconds for their Instagram reels, these films are evidence that new tools and smartphones are changing not just the way films are made but which stories get told. As award-winning director Sriram Raghavan puts it, "Film-making today is about vision, and iPhone makes it possible for anyone with a strong voice to create something meaningful."

‘Higher import duty may ease gold demand by 60 tonnes, saving $2.5 b’

WAR SHOCK. Rise in gold, silver prices on account of duty hike will also impact headline inflation: Experts

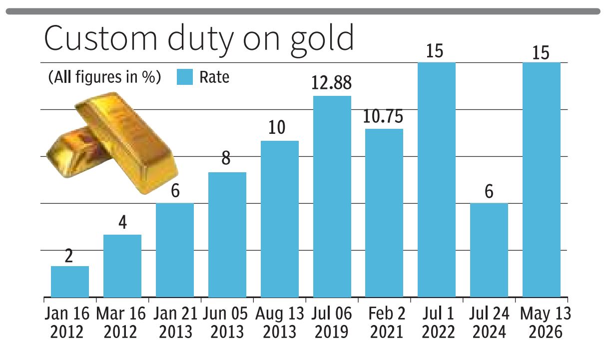
Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

A hike in gold import duty is projected to trim annual demand by nearly 60 tonnes, potentially saving the exchequer $2.5 billion (approximately ₹24,000 crore) in import bills. While the move is designed to narrow the Current Account Deficit (CAD), analysts warn that a potential surge in smuggling could dilute these fiscal gains.

DUTY AT ITS PEAK

With the hike, custom duty is back to its highest level in 14 years. Between 2012 and 2026, the lowest rate was 2 per cent. With effect from May 13, duty on gold and silver has been hiked to 15 per cent. India nearly imports 700-800 tonnes of gold annually.

“A moderation in import volumes due to higher duties could help narrow the merchandise trade deficit, thereby easing pressure on the CAD and supporting forex reserve conservation. However, the impact may be limited to some extent, as gold demand in India remains relatively inelastic due to strong cultural and traditional preferences,” said Rajani Sinha, Chief Economist with CareEdge.



Source: World Gold Council

CONSUMER DEMAND

According to estimates by the World Gold Council, every 1 per cent increase in import cost can reduce consumer demand by around 0.8 per cent, or nearly 6 tonnes.

Accordingly, “the cumulative 9 per cent hike in duty could potentially reduce gold demand by nearly 50-60 tonnes, translating into lower imports worth approximately $6-9 billion at current international prices,” she said, adding that the favourable impact on the CAD may be partially offset if elevated duties encourage unofficial gold inflows through smuggling channels.

Debopam Chaudhuri, Chief Economist at Piramal Group, said, “In our assessment, every 1 per cent increase in retail gold prices can potentially reduce year-on-year growth in gold imports by at least 40 basis points.”

GLOBAL PRICES

“Accordingly, if the entire tariff hike is passed on to end consumers, India’s gold imports could decline by approximately 4 per cent, translating into potential savings of nearly $2.5 billion in FY27, assuming international gold prices remain broadly in line with FY26 levels,” he said.

However, some economists are not so optimistic about a reduction in the current import bill.

“We do not think the current gold import duty hike will significantly affect the current account deficit,” said Aastha Gudwani, India Chief Economist at Barclays.

According to her, there is an inverse relationship between international gold prices and India‘s imports. Gold import demand was already weak and trending lower in March with 35 per cent reduction.

FALL IN VOLUMES

Though February saw rise in import demand by 120 per cent (volume growth), but on a 12-month rolling basis, volumes were down since August 2025, as the surge in gold prices began to pinch.

“While the duty hike may indeed have a dampening effect on volume demand (based on historical experience) amid elevated international gold prices, we expect the gold import bill to rise further in FY27 ($15 billion versus FY26), offsetting the volume decline,” said Gudwani.

Rise in gold and silver prices on account of duty hike is also likely to impact the headline inflation. It is expected that retail inflation rate might see a rise of 5-6 basis points in May, while the full impact will be seen in June, where the increase could be up to 10 bps.

Gold demand for weddings holds firm, but volumes may lose shine

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi


CONTINUING TRADITIONS. While there may be a moderation in gold imports, wedding-related demand remains sound due to deep-rooted cultural traditions

The government’s move to sharply hike import duty on gold to 15 per cent is unlikely to dent Indian weddings significantly, though jewellers expect consumers to increasingly opt for lighter-weight designs. This may lead to some moderation in purchase volumes even if the overall spending in value terms remains resilient.

Industry players said wedding-related jewellery buying, deeply tied to cultural and family traditions, is expected to hold up despite elevated prices, with higher gold rates and duties likely to alter consumption patterns rather than suppress demand outright.

Suvankar Sen, MD and CEO, Senco Gold Ltd, noted that while the high-duty environment will likely lead to a moderation in overall gold imports, wedding-related demand remains structurally sound due to deep-rooted cultural traditions.

LIGHTER JEWELLERY

“What we are more likely to witness is a shift in consumer behaviour, with customers opting for light-weight jewellery, including 9kt, 14kt and 18kt jewellery, along with exchange-led purchases and more value-oriented designs to optimise budgets while continuing wedding-related buying,” he said.

Players said that while value growth for the industry may remain intact because of elevated gold prices, actual volumes could see some pressure as consumers trim quantities and ticket sizes.

“The industry is preparing for at least one year of relatively high duties on gold, and we believe this could result in a 10-15 per cent moderation in gold imports over time. However, we do not see much risk to achieving our 20-25 per cent value growth guidance for FY27,” said Sen.

AUSPICIOUS DATES

While a few auspicious dates seen for weddings in May, wedding-related jewellery purchases are expected to gather further momentum from mid-June onwards through the latter half of the year.

Raghav Dhir, Director of Dhirsons Jewellers, added, “Higher import duties are not going to impact purchases for wedding jewellery as that is part of the traditions and they usually do not cut back on spending. So, we are not expecting to see any major change in wedding-related demand for gold jewellery. However, non-occasion based buying may see some decline due to the general cautiousness among consumers across categories. Given the recent gold price trends, the shift towards lighter-weight jewellery is expected to further amplify.”

‘VALUE-CONSCIOUS’

Jignesh Mehta, Founder & MD, Divine Solitaires, said that Indian consumers have weathered several cycles of high gold prices, and wedding and engagement-related purchases have so far remained relatively resilient, although consumers are increasingly becoming more value-conscious in terms of quantity and design preferences.

Duty under India-UAE pact raised in line with standard rate hike

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The Finance Ministry has increased the import duty on gold sourced from the UAE under the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA), raising the rate for the specified quota to 14 per cent from 5 per cent. The move is in sync with the government’s decision on Wednesday to increase the standard import duty on the yellow metal to 15 per cent from 6 per cent in a bid to bring down demand and check forex outflows amid the West Asia crisis.

Under the India-UAE CEPA, gold imported through the tariff rate quota (TRQ) enjoys a 1 per cent concession compared to the prevailing standard rate. The TRQ for gold at concessional duty under the CEPA was set at 120 tonnes in 2022 when the partnership agreement came into force, and is set to reach 200 tonnes by 2027.

India’s gold bar imports from the UAE surged to $16.5 billion in 2025 from $2.9 billion in 2022, while the UAE’s share in India’s gold imports increased to 28 per cent in 2025 from 7.9 per cent earlier, pointed out Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI). “The trend raises concerns because the UAE neither mines gold nor carries out major processing activity. Much of the trade appears to involve routing gold from third countries through Dubai simply to benefit from lower Indian tariffs,” it stated.

MISUSE OF RULES

There are also chances of possible misuse of rules of origin provisions and artificial processing aimed only at qualifying for tariff benefits, the GTRI warned.

Industry fears soaring gold may lead to smuggling, exert liquidity pressure on exporters and MSMEs

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

A steep hike in gold import duty sent domestic gold prices soaring nearly 10 per cent on Wednesday, worsening sentiment in India’s bullion and jewellery market, where traders and retailers said demand has slowed dramatically amid rising prices and weak consumer affordability.

Fears were raised by industry associations such as the Gem and Jewellery Export Promotion Council (GJEPC), which said the latest move may push up domestic gold prices, fuel smuggling and worsen liquidity pressures for exporters and MSME manufacturers. The duty hike triggered caution across bullion markets and jewellery showrooms, with retailers reporting weak footfalls, shrinking purchases and a growing shift towards exchange transactions.

Hareshkumar Acharya, Director at India Bullion and Jewellers Association (IBJA), said, “Ever since the Prime Minister spoke about reducing gold imports and the duty hike was announced, there has been no rush in bullion markets or among retailers to buy gold.”

“If there were 10 sellers earlier, there is now barely one buyer. After the duties were raised, the situation worsened further,” he said.

NOTHING TO CHEER

Retail jewellers echoed similar concerns, saying the sudden spike in prices had sharply eroded affordability in a market that was already witnessing subdued demand ahead of the wedding and festival season.

Manoj Soni, Director at the Ahmedabad-based AB Jewels Pvt Ltd, said that customers were increasingly cutting down on purchases as prices rise.

“A customer who set aside ₹25,000 for gold four days ago now gets nearly 10 per cent less in value,” said Soni.

On the other hand, the GJEPC said, “Despite gold prices doubling recently, imports have not declined proportionally. Such measures often fuel smuggling and escalate export costs.”

It said exporters will face bank guarantees of ₹28-30 lakh per kg of duty-free gold from nominated agencies, severely blocking working capital and stifling exports.

The most severe impact of this policy will be felt by MSME manufacturers, who are the backbone of the industry. They account for 80 per cent of GJEPC’s membership and are currently facing a critical liquidity crunch.

With inputs from Anupama Ghosh in Mumbai

Jewellery industry preparing for behavioural shift

Our Bureau
Bengaluru/Kochi/Hyderabad

The jewellery industry is preparing for a behavioural shift, not a demand collapse, after the government increased import duty.

Large organised jewellers said that the immediate impact, mainly after Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s remarks, could lead to consumers increasingly exchanging old gold for new jewellery.

“What we expect over the coming quarters is not a contraction in demand so much as a shift in how that demand is met,” said MP Ahammad, Chairman of the Malabar Group. He said he expects exchange-led purchases to become the dominant buying trend as consumers turn more value-conscious.

Executives said that wedding and occasion-led jewellery demand remains relatively resilient, while investment-driven buying is likely to slow first.

“The investment-led segment is more vulnerable to messaging of this kind than jewellery is,” said Varghese Alukkas, Managing Director of Jos Alukkas.

Joy Alukkas, Chairman and Managing Director of the Joyalukkas Group, said consumers may become more value-conscious or shift towards lighter designs, but emotional and cultural demand for gold is expected to remain strong.

GOLD RECYCLING

Industry players also see a broader opportunity emerging around gold recycling and monetisation.

Industry players also see a broader opportunity emerging around gold recycling and monetisation

While organised retailers said that footfalls and wedding bookings have held steady so far, they admitted that the next few weeks will determine whether it will translate into a sustained behavioural shift.

The Kerala Gold and Silver Merchants Association urged the government to focus on recycling domestically held gold, instead of discouraging gold purchases through higher import duties.

State General Secretary of the association S Abdul Nazar said that if effective gold recycling measures and a transparent bullion banking system are introduced, India could significantly reduce or even eliminate its dependence on gold imports.

In Hyderabad, traders said they were witnessing a cash crunch in the market, resulting in a significant drop in sales over the last few days.

“After the increase in duties, one gram of gold costs ₹17 lakh for 100 grams. But we are selling at ₹16,500 a gram as internal gold stocks are currently being sold,” a bulk gold trader told *businessline*.

C Vinod Hayagriv, Managing Director of C Krishniah Chetty Group, proposed restricting bullion sales to GST-registered buyers to discourage speculative hoarding and reduce raw bullion imports.

CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - MAY 14 - 2026

thehindubusinessline.
THURSDAY - MAY 14, 2026

Failing the test

NEET exam leak must lead up to systemic overhaul

We've been through this before — the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET) for medical aspirants, held on May 3, has been annulled, following a widely circulated "guess paper" leak. The paper was remarkably similar to the actual exam. Even as the CBI has swung into action, this comes as a shock for 23 lakh aspirants who doubtless invested their physical, mental and emotional energies into cracking an exam that opens doors to the top medical colleges.

So far, a 'paper trail' that appears to circulate around Kerala, Jaipur, Sikar, Gurugram and Nashik has come to light. The National Testing Agency (NTA) and CBI owe an assurance to these traumatised aspirants and their families, as well as future aspirants, that such leaks will not recur, and that the individuals or groups involved will be punished as per the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. The NTA has not covered itself in glory, as such leaks occur rather too often. The UGC-NET, conducted by the NTA, was cancelled in 2024 after the Home Ministry noted that the integrity of the examinations had been compromised. In 2024, NEET-UG exam paper leaks were identified in Jharkhand and Bihar, but the Supreme Court had rejected calls to cancel the entire exam, noting that there was no systemic leak of the question paper. This time around, the leak has gone far and wide, and it seems to have happened through the printing press, or with the involvement of those privy to the preparation of the paper. If there is a pattern to the modus operandi of these leaks, it needs to be addressed.

The NTA's abysmal record when it comes to NEET exams is baffling because the same agency has been conducting the Joint Entrance Examinations for admissions to IITs without a blemish since it took over the mandate in 2019. The CBSE, which was administering JEE until then, had also acquitted itself well save for the one incident of paper leak in 1997. Similarly, the Union Public Service Commission, which manages the civil services exams has also had a spotless record in the last three decades. Perhaps the NTA should consider moving NEET into an online testing system, like the JEE. The technology deployed in JEE, which involves encrypted question papers that are decrypted at the last minute, can be adapted to NEET as well.

The working of the NTA must be subject to more scrutiny and accountability. In the case of SAT and GRE exams, the US government does not conduct them. Private, non-profit agencies are responsible — such as the College Board for the SAT and the Educational Testing Service for the GRE. These are yet early days to consider a similar model; bodies such as the UPSC and CBSE have not fared badly, after all. Finally, the insane scramble for medical seats points to a bizarre demand-supply mismatch. A higher supply of medical seats through NEET can curb corruption and commercialisation in medical education and practice.

Allow gold ETFs to unlock vaults

RIGHT FIX. When gold ETFs were allowed in 2006, full physical backing made sense. A relaxation now can reduce imports

V SHUNMUGAM

When the Prime Minister asks Indians to stop buying gold, it is not merely a moral appeal to household thrift; it is a warning signal from the macroeconomy. But gold does not obey sermons. The more anxious the nation becomes, the more instinctively Indians turn to the yellow metal — not as consumption, but as insurance. That is exactly the paradox now playing out: even as citizens are urged to pause gold purchases, fear has only sharpened their appetite for it.

The government's response has been to raise import duties on gold and silver from 6 per cent to 15 per cent, hoping to cool demand and conserve foreign exchange. But tariffs only feed into raising the symptom; they do not treat the disease. If India wants to reduce the import intensity of gold investment without denying savers their preferred hedge, the next reform must come from within the financial market itself: Gold ETFs should unlock their vaults and be allowed to use exchange-traded futures as part of their portfolio architecture. That would convert part of India's gold demand from a physical import problem into a financial risk-management solution.

In January 2026, gold imports amounted to $12 billion, nearly tripling December's figure. Demand for gold ETFs accounted for 16 per cent of that monthly expenditure. Gold ETFs, designed to reduce India's physical import burden, have become one of its major drivers. This irony is worth highlighting, and it also points to a potential solution

GOLD DEMAND. Emanates from two distinct markets that behave very differently ISTOCK

TWO GOLD MARKETS

Indian gold demand comprises two distinct markets that behave very differently. The first is socio-cultural gold — weddings, Akshaya Tritiya, Dhanteras, inheritance and religious observances woven into the calendar. Listed jewellers reported revenue growth ranging from 32 to 124 per cent in Q1 2026. These events are price-inelastic and emotionally non-negotiable, unaffected by macroeconomic policies and may take a generation to change from now on. You can't influence a wedding; it's best to leave it undisturbed.

The second category is investment gold. Demand for bars and coins surged 34 per cent to 62 tonnes in Q1 2026, the highest first-quarter total since 2013, nearly matching jewellery demand. Gold ETF assets under management rose dramatically by 191 per cent, from ₹59,000 crore in March 2025 to ₹1.71 lakh crore in March 2026. Commodity ETFs saw greater inflows than equity ETFs for the first time. Each rupee invested compelled asset management companies (AMCs) to source physical gold, with most crossing customs checkpoints as imported gold. Prime Minister Modi rightly focuses on this issue. The real question isn't if but how to address it.

115 TONNES GOING NOWHERE

By the end of March 2026, India's 26 Gold ETFs will hold 115 tonnes — worth $18.5 billion or ₹1.7 trillion — stored in vaults. These are fully imported, duty-paid, assayed, insured, with daily storage fees. They offer zero yield and track prices published every minute by exchanges, without requiring physical bars. Each new ETF unit purchased by an investor initiates another import cycle.

When SEBI initially allowed Gold ETFs in 2006, full physical backing made sense because commodity derivatives were outside its regulation. Physical gold served as a trustworthy anchor. This was a sensible approach in 2006. However, defending it in 2026 appears to be institutional inertia masquerading as prudence.

THE RULEBOOK CHANGED

On a close reading of SEBI's circulars one can't help but notice how far the regulation is ahead of actual practice. The SEBI circular issued in May 2019 explicitly classified Exchange Traded Commodity Derivatives (ETCDs) with gold as the underlying asset as eligible gold-related instruments for Gold ETFs. It also excluded them from the 10 per cent single-commodity ETCD cap that applies to all other schemes. The latest investment guidance clarified this further, allowing Gold ETFs to allocate up to 95 per cent of their net assets to gold and gold-related instruments — including GDS, GMS, and ETCDs.

In February 2026, the capstone was introduced. SEBI's master circular required Gold ETFs to determine their NAVs based on exchange-polled domestic spot prices, which are also used to settle physically delivered gold derivatives. As a result, the NAV benchmark and futures settlement price now align with the same figure.

Read that again. The regulator aligned ETF valuation with exchange derivatives pricing. Legal approval for futures has been in place since 2019. The valuation bridge was introduced in April 2026. The door has been open for years, but AMCs seem to consider it a wall.

WHAT NEEDS TO HAPPEN

There is no need for a new circular law or product. AMCs to release physical gold in tranches — 5 to 10 tonnes initially — through structured auctions to refiners, bullion banks and jewellers who would otherwise place import orders. Every tonne sold domestically never crosses a customs checkpoint. Proceeds fund long positions in gold futures on domestic exchanges across near- and next-month contracts, restoring 100 per cent gold price exposure. Investor sees no change in NAV behaviour. Physical gold and futures settle against the same exchange-polled spot price. Investor interest protected.

> As physical gold re-enters the domestic supply, it eases pressure on refiners who might otherwise order from abroad. ETF investors receive collateral returns that are lost today

Futures require margin rather than full notional deployment. Surplus cash — after margin and variation buffers — can earn 6-7 per cent in Treasury Bills or TREPS. Currently, investors earn zero on the cash equivalent of vaulted gold. A futures sleeve offers collateral return in addition to complete gold exposure. It is not a compromise but a better product.

Position discipline is essential. Domestic exchanges see gold futures open interest averaging 16-18 tonnes, while ETF holdings of 115 tonnes far exceed this amount.

No ETF should hold more than 15-20 per cent of open interest in any given contract month. Positions are distributed across different maturities, with rolls carefully scheduled and capped.

Exchanges need to support this with liquidity incentives such as tighter spreads and fee waivers during rollover periods. This is about strengthening market infrastructure, not charity.

WHAT SEBI SHOULD DO

Existing norms are adequate, but one gap remains as balance sheets transition from physical to financial gold. Monthly factsheets should separately report physical gold holdings, ETCD exposure by contract month, the basis between futures and exchange-polled spot, and collateral returns on surplus cash. Few AMCs have indicated that ETCD exposure is reserved for rare situations — a conservative interpretation of a permission meant to be operational. SEBI does not need to rewrite rules; it should confirm that a managed futures allocation is standard portfolio practice and require disclosures to ensure every shift is transparent to unit-holders.

WHAT INDIA GETS

Executing this causes the payoff to compound. Investment demand is satisfied by existing vaulted metal stops, which trigger new imports. As physical gold re-enters the domestic supply, it eases pressure on refiners who might otherwise order from abroad. ETF investors receive collateral returns that are lost today. Exchanges attract institutional participants, deepening order books and improving price discovery. India shifts from a passive price taker to a benchmark setter in its bullion market.

The Prime Minister urged a sacrifice. Nonetheless, this strategy presents a superior solution — implementing a structural fix that benefits investors, the rupee, and the current account — without forcing any family to give up the grams they need for their socio-cultural obligations. The vault is full. The rules are ready. The exchanges are open. Let us unlock it.

The writer is Partner, MCQube

New govt must boost farm economy in Bengal

Agriculture growth is less than the national average. Structural issues have led to farmer distress, underinvestment in agri sector

Kushankur Dey

One pressing agenda for the newly elected government in Bengal is improving the lives and livelihoods of farmers and making the farm economy resilient and responsive. This agenda gains ground against the backdrop of State's long history of land reforms and tenancy regulations, which marked a departure from the large farmer or '*jotedar*' dominated farming system prevalent in the colonial period.

Though the State has a productive agrarian base, structural vulnerabilities have led to farmer distress and underinvestment in agriculture. For example, 96 per cent of the State's 7.12 million farming households are small and marginal, and the average holding size is 0.77 hectare, which is much below the national average (1.02 ha).

The State's per capita income (₹1,81,786 in 2024-25) is below the national average (₹2,34,859), due to a lack of economies of scale, wage stickiness, and the absence of large-scale agribusiness. The State's agricultural growth (3.3 per cent) is below the current national average (4.5 per cent).

However, Bengal's diverse agro-climatic zones and biophysical resources offer a competitive edge and

LAND HOLDINGS. Much smaller than the national average PTI

can outweigh its structural shortcomings. Bengal remains one of the top paddy/rice producers, reporting 16.49 million tonnes of rice production in 2024-25.

The State accounts for 74 per cent of India's jute and *mesta* production. Potatoes account for 35 per cent, and the State leads in fruits and vegetables production, including brinjal, banana, and cauliflower. The State leverages its strategic 'gateway to South-East Asia' location to boost exports, having a share of 9 per cent in India's food processing exports.

The State has vibrant inland, coastal, and brackish-water fisheries, accounting for about 18 lakh tonnes of total fish production, with a 10.26 per cent share in India's fish production, and generating livelihoods for more than 30 lakh fishermen. The State Fisheries Development Corporation and 'BENFISH' enhance production and promote the development of fishermen cooperatives.

Bengal's tea industry, located in North Bengal and encompassing Darjeeling, Dooars, and Terai, is India's second-largest producer, accounting for 24 per cent of India's tea output. It has more than 300 large tea estates and generates livelihoods for 2.64-5 lakh workers involved in the tea value chain.

PERVASIVE ISSUES

Given this diversity and magnitude of agriculture and allied activities, farm distress and out-migration remain pervasive issues. A district-level study shows that technical and allocative efficiency in agriculture is skewed towards the central Gangetic region in the State. The most agriculturally advanced districts are Hooghly, Purba Bardhaman, and Nadia. Purulia remains the most agriculturally backward district, given its dry, undulating terrain and inadequate irrigation facilities.

The northern mountainous region and the south-western highlands also report higher crop productivity. 24 Parganas (North) and Murshidabad reported a higher agricultural contribution to their district-level domestic products and outperformed several southern counterparts. So, the government must develop a district-wise plan of action or targeted interventions.

First, ground-level credit disbursement, PM Kisan beneficiary coverage, and the Kisan Credit Card-linked interest subvention scheme beneficiaries must be increased from current levels.

Second, the government must promote activity-specific State-level federations of farmer-producer organisations to address market and credit access problems for member FPOs and their farmers.

Third, the agriculture ministry, in consultation with the Central government, must implement the AgriStack project to improve information governance and real-time monitoring of farming activities.

Direct benefit transfer under central sector schemes, including the insurance programme and price support scheme, must be implemented diligently to safeguard farming communities.

To sum up, agribusiness enterprises using the PMFME and AIF schemes should be promoted alongside the "ODOP" scheme to induce export-led agricultural growth.

The writer is an Associate Professor of IIM Lucknow. Views are personal

OTHER VOICES.

CHINADAILY

China ready to work with US in spirit of equality, respect

While global turbulence does not always stem from shifts in major-country relations, stable and healthy ties between the world's two largest economies can help facilitate the easing of international turmoil as their intertwined economic relationship is a stabilizer for the world economy. Under such circumstances, US President Donald Trump's state visit to China from Wednesday to Friday has naturally attracted wide attention as head-of-state diplomacy plays an irreplaceable and strategically vital role in guiding China-US ties. As Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesman Guo Jiakun said on Wednesday, China welcomes Trump's visit, during which the two leaders will have in-depth exchanges of views on key issues concerning bilateral ties and global peace and development. (BEIJING, MAY 13)

The Guardian

Keir Starmer's manoeuvres signal decline

It was said of John Major, the Tory prime minister fatally damaged by party infighting, that he was "in office but not in power". Sir Keir Starmer finds himself in a similar spot. His government is planning a king's speech that contains ambitious proposals. But after Wednesday's pomp and circumstance will come the real test: six days of Commons debate, then a vote that governments almost never lose. Almost. The last prime minister defeated on such an occasion was the Conservative Stanley Baldwin in 1924. He and his party were forced from office. With ministers resigning and roughly 90 Labour MPs openly questioning Sir Keir's leadership, this is no longer parliamentary theatre. (LONDON, MAY 2)

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Curbing retail inflation

'April retail inflation hits 14-month high of 3.48%" (May 13) is a reminder that price stability cannot be taken for granted, even when numbers remain below the RBI's target. Food items like onions and tomatoes, along with the sharp surge in gold and silver prices, are once again driving household costs higher.

While the central bank's cautious stance is welcome, the government must act on the supply side. Strengthening buffer stocks, improving cold storage and logistics for perishables, and timely market interventions can prevent seasonal spikes from becoming persistent.

A coordinated effort between monetary and fiscal authorities will be essential to protect the common citizen's purchasing power.

K Sakunthala
Coimbatore

Bank credit flow

This refers to 'Decoding banks' return to health' (May 13). The authors are right in flagging the unsustainability of debt-induced consumption growth.

Banking metrics have improved considerably since 2015, but the composition of that credit tells a more cautious story.

Personal loans growing at 370 per cent while infrastructure credit grew at merely 30 per cent is not a healthy balance.

An economy needs productive lending, not just retail expansion. The concern about housing loans is equally valid — classified as secured does not mean risk-free, as 2008 demonstrated. RBI aligning credit growth guidance with nominal GDP projections is sensible. But equally important is nudging banks to redirect flows toward manufacturing and infrastructure, where multiplier effects on employment and income are far more durable.

SM Jeeva
Chennai

Food contamination

This refers to 'Poison in the food' (May 13). This is a serious issue that has remained unresolved for too long. Two major reasons for excessive and imprudent use of weedicides, not excluding pesticides, are ease of access and misguidance by traders.

Unless authorities impose severe restrictions and mandate reportage of sales with details of farmers and the crop cultivated, the menace cannot be mitigated. However, random check of residues in farm produce at farm-gate may help to a certain extent, unless there are legal hindrances.

Rajiv Magal
Halekere Village, Karnataka

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Telecom insolvency

SBI seeks review on spectrum ruling

Debarshi Chakraborty

The State Bank of India's decision to seek review of the Supreme Court's recent spectrum ruling has revived a dispute that extends far beyond telecom insolvency. At stake is a basic question — can the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 (IBC), designed to rescue distressed businesses and maximise creditor recoveries, override the sovereign character of scarce public resources such as a spectrum?

Running alongside that question is another equally important one — can large statutory dues owed to the State be pushed down the repayment ladder as mere operational debt while financial creditors recover first?

The Supreme Court's February 2026 ruling drew a clear conceptual line. Telecom spectrum, it held, is not an ordinary corporate asset available for unrestricted transfer through insolvency proceedings. It remains a national resource allocated by the State subject to statutory conditions, payment obligations and continuing regulatory control. A telecom operator enjoys a right to use spectrum, but not unfettered ownership over it. That distinction, though legally orthodox, has significant ramifications.

SPECTRUM. Recovery issues
/ISTOCKPHOTO

LENDERS' WORRIES

For lenders, the concern is immediate. Telecom borrowing is underwritten not merely by towers or equipment, but by the cash flows generated through access to spectrum. If those rights cannot be effectively dealt with during insolvency, recoveries become uncertain. Where recovery becomes uncertain, risk premiums rise. Banks and bondholders do not wait for jurisprudence to settle; they price the uncertainty in advance. The eventual burden is borne by the sector through higher borrowing costs and reduced investment appetite.

For the State, however, the concern is different. Spectrum usage charges, licence fees and AGR liabilities are not routine trade claims. They arise from the use of a public resource and form part of the consideration for that use. Treating such dues as ordinary operational debt raises a difficult policy concern: public revenue may take steep haircuts while private credit recovers ahead of it.

The IBC was built as a general code. But sectors such as telecom, mining, aviation and power function through licences, concessions and permissions that originate in sovereign authority. Their value is commercial, yet their resource is public. This dual character makes them resistant to a universal insolvency process.

The legal friction is therefore unsurprising. Creditors rely on the IBC's broad objective of value maximisation and speedy resolution. Regulators insist that insolvency cannot dilute statutory obligations or convert licences into transferable private property. Both positions have force.

The present uncertainty is costly. As the British economist Ronald Coase argued in *The Problem of Social Cost*, markets allocate resources efficiently only when property rights are clear and transaction costs remain low. Where rights are uncertain, bargaining becomes expensive, delay increases, and assets are abandoned rather than redistributed. That is precisely the danger here. If distressed telecom assets cannot be resolved smoothly, valuable spectrum may remain tied up in litigation while subscribers migrate, infrastructure declines and enterprise value erodes. A scarce national resource then becomes commercially idle.

Consumers are not untouched by these disputes. If borrowing becomes costlier and stressed companies cannot be resolved quickly, telecom firms may expand networks more slowly, face weaker competition, and delay new technology rollouts.

The review petition reflects market unease that the present framework does not adequately reconcile insolvency principles with regulated-sector realities.

A more practical way forward may be to re-consider clearer insolvency rules for sectors that depend on public licences or natural resources.

The writer is an advocate at the Delhi High Court

C RANGARAJAN
B SAMBAMURTHY

GETTY IMAGES

Global size via bank consolidation

CHALLENGES AHEAD. Big banks have the advantage of scale but small banks too perform well. NBFC model's vulnerabilities need to be addressed

We continue with the critical issues to be addressed by the banking system in the coming years.

Besides enhancing the ability to underwrite big ticket loans, the aspiration is also to have a couple of Indian banks in the global top league table.

Consolidation does not by itself improve liability structure and solve the ALM (Asset Liability mismatch) issue, an essential precondition to take up big ticket projects. Some of the amalgamated banks have attained size comparable to SBI of few years ago.

But these banks now need organisational upgrade and cannot be just an exercise in addition and subtraction of resources of amalgamated entities. Low hanging fruits of savings in tech and other operating costs are already plucked. They need to build in fintech like features for better customer service and risk management.

While not discounting the value of big banks, it may be useful to note that small banks are not inherently disadvantaged. For example, a case study by NIBM points out that a relatively small bank, like Bank of Maharashtra has scored well above almost all the big banks in terms of various financial metrics consistently over period of over four years. This drives home that leadership and governance are as important as scale. This also underscores that banks of all sizes and focus have a role and place in contributing to the growth of real economy.

RRB CONSOLIDATION

It is also critical to analyse if in the process of consolidation, the local character of RRBs has been lost. For example, in Uttar Pradesh with a population of nearly 24 crore, 36 RRBs were merged into one RRB. Uttarakhand with a population of about 1.2 crore has also one RRB.

The four regions in UP are not evenly developed. The credit/deposit ratio of UP at around 60 per cent trails behind national average of 80 per cent. So is the case of Bihar which has much lower credit/deposit ratio of only 55 per cent.

Some of these States need more banks and not less. It is important to review the outcome of such mergers and corrective action taken, if the original purpose with which these banks were set up has been lost sight of.

WRITE OFF OF BAD LOANS

The reduction of gross NPAs was largely achieved by write off of loans. During the last five years ending 2025, the write offs were quite staggering at ₹9.2 lakh crore and only about ₹2.10 lakh crore was recovered from written off accounts.

Haircuts in some of the large accounts were as high as 75-90 per cent of the claims against the borrowers. The real test of the efficacy of the new amendments to IBC passed by legislature recently lies in faster resolution of stressed loans and lower haircuts.

The test of performance of banks therefore lies in less accumulation of non-performing loans.

RISK MANAGEMENT

Probability of Default (PD) and Loss Given Default (LGD) were very high in recent years and this was manifest in huge haircuts ranging from 75 per cent to over 90 per cent in resolution and recovery. Lenders need to revisit and upgrade their risk management practices to significantly reduce credit losses.

Lending particularly to business entails multi-layered risks. Inherent risk lies in the top layer and this is essentially base value of the risk. The default and delinquency risk are inherent as credit appraisal and decision is driven by projections and assumptions on various dimensions of business and the over all economy. Animal spirits amplify opportunities and risks.

Even after mitigation of inherent risks, there is always a residue and this residual risk is embedded in the second layer. Lenders need to mitigate this risk through online and real time monitoring of business performance and effective and mandated use of funds.

Risk may be redistributed outside the banking system through securitisation and insurance products like Credit Default Swaps (CDS). These may be the building blocks for mitigation of Expected Loss provisions as mandated by latest RBI guidelines.

> **The reduction of gross NPAs was largely achieved by write off of loans. During the last five years ending 2025, the write-offs were quite staggering at ₹9.2 lakh crore and only about ₹2.10 lakh crore recovered**

ON TAP LICENSING

It is over a decade that RBI granted licenses to new banks.

RBI may put in place a licensing system to authorise one or two new banks on an annual basis so that over a decade we have 15-20 new banks which may encourage innovation and competitiveness and also help in deepening and widening banking access.

IMBALANCE IN FUNDING

Most of the NBFCs are non-deposit taking category and they depend heavily on banks and wholesale markets for deposits. As of September 2025, the aggregate loans of NBFC stand around ₹52 lakh crore which was funded by borrowings of about ₹45 lakh crore and public deposits are a paltry ₹1.2 lakh crore.

This best illustrates vulnerability and imbalance in funding. This creates huge ALM mismatches and liquidity issues may turn to solvency issues. The collapse of three large NBFCs exposes these fault lines.

Banks account for over 40 per cent of NBFC resources directly and indirectly and this close interlinkage is another source of problem. NBFCs have huge exposure of nearly ₹13 lakh crore to the power sector, far exceeding commercial banks' exposure of about ₹6 lakh crore and this sector contributed to huge NPAs of commercial banks in the earlier decade.

Between 2023-2025 September, aggregate credit of NBFCs grew much faster at 52 per cent as compared to commercial banks credit growth rate of 36 per cent and this only emphasises the need to address imbalance in funding.

RBI's scale-based regulation (SBR) is a welcome measure, but it does not address the fundamental vulnerability of the business model of NBFC. Even DFIs face this imbalance problem.

TECHNOLOGICAL CHANGES

The adoption of AI, including agentic AI in banking is gaining momentum. Banks need to reskill the entire workforce at strategic, operational and tactical levels. Digital frauds however are on the increase and it is important to further step up preventive as well as curative actions and avoid erosion of public trust in digital channels.

Bank credit is a supportive condition for growth of real economy. Growth of other sectors of finance notwithstanding, banking will continue to play a dominant role. At the current growth rate, bank credit may treble in the next 10 years or even earlier.

Hence it is vital that policymakers and bankers pay heed to the opportunities, issues and concerns that may confront the banking system and we have highlighted some of them.

(**This is the second and concluding part of a two-part series**)

Rangarajan is Former Chairman of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister and Former Governor, RBI; Sambamurthy is Formerly Director and CEO, IDRBT and led a commercial bank

thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

May 14, 2006

Govt plans stockholding limits for sugar

After cement, the Government is now apparently training its guns on sugar prices. With open market rates showing no signs of easing despite release of higher free sale quotas (FSQ) to mills, there is a 'serious move' to bring back restrictions on the trade, including licensing of dealers and stockholding and turnover period limits.

IT, ITES industry may add 3.2 lakh jobs this fiscal

Even as their revenues continue to grow at a scorching pace, Indian IT services and BPO companies are likely to add close to 3.2 lakh jobs during 2006-07, taking the overall employee base to about 1.6 million by the end of the current financial year.

Suzlon, Siemens replace SCI, Tata Chem in Nifty

Suzlon Energy Ltd and Siemens Ltd have been included in the NSE's 50-share index S&P CNX Nifty index. The two companies will re place Shipping Corporation of India Ltd and Tata Chemicals. The changes will be effective from June 26, said India Index Services & Products Ltd, a joint venture of the NSE and Crisil. As on Friday, market capitalisation of Suzlon amounts to Rs 38,047 crore and that of Siemens Rs 20,148 crore.

Hantavirus shows no sign of mutating to become more contagious

Marthe Fourcade

The respiratory virus that caused a deadly outbreak on a cruise ship is showing no sign of mutating to become more contagious, even though more cases among former passengers may arise in coming weeks, said experts from the European Center for Disease Prevention and Control.

The hantavirus's genome has been sequenced and it's similar to the one that caused outbreaks in South America in the past, said Andreas Hoefer, the center's expert on microbiology and molecular epidemiology. That's likely where the first passenger was infected before getting on the Hondius expedition vessel and spreading the pathogen, according to the EU's public health agency. "At the moment there is no data to suggest this virus is behaving any differently in transmissibility or severity," Hoefer said Wednesday at a briefing. "All sequences to date are virtually identical."

Passengers were repatriated to their home countries earlier this week under a patchwork of measures that reflect uncertainty over how the Andes strain of hantavirus spreads. Health officials stress that the risk to the broader public remains low, but exactly how contagious the virus is and whether people are infectious before developing symptoms remains unclear.

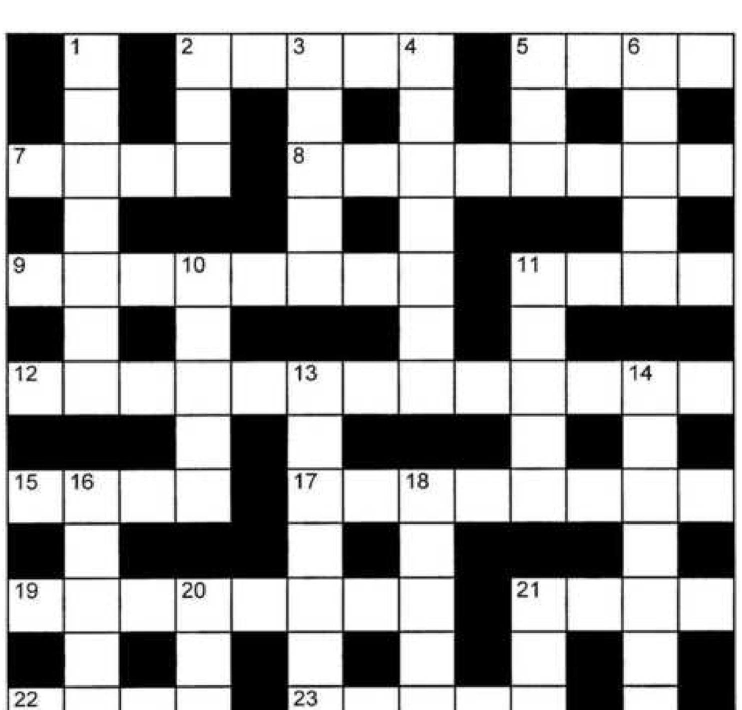
The cruise ship MV Hondius, affected by a hantavirus outbreak (file picture) REUTERS

An ECDC expert who joined the ship in Cape Verde found that distancing and other precautions were already in place on board but that passengers had had the kind of "close, prolonged contact" that could lead to infection, said Gianfranco Spiteri, who heads the agency's global epidemic intelligence and health security operations.

Asked whether patients might be contagious before they develop symptoms, Spiteri said the virus could be found in the blood of patients two days earlier. That means "there might be some risk" of an earlier transmission, he said, leading the agency to recommend that contact tracing include people who were exposed to an infected person two days before their symptoms began.

BLOOMBERG

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2679



EASY

ACROSS

02. Not having been given anything to eat (5)
05. Shape that's square all around (4)
07. Produce yarn (4)
08. Be in bed but unsleeping (3,5)
09. 'Light' creature (8)
11. Have sufficient courage to (4)
12. Meteorological bulletin (7,6)
15. Entrance (4)
17. Turning on a point (8)
19. Poisonous (8)
21. Lofty (4)
22. Daybreak (4)
23. Consumed (5)

DOWN

01. Push back (7)
02. Funerary vase (3)
03. Sheet of paper once folded (5)
04. Not a realist (7)
05. Subdue one's spirit (3)
06. Breadmaker (5)
10. Irrigate (5)
11. American railway station (5)
13. Investigate uncharted territory (7)
14. Refuse; revoke at cards (7)
16. Musical work(s) (5)
18. Pay a call (5)
20. Possess (3)
21. Laying bird (3)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

02. Not given to bite? (5)
05. A shapely thing it is, to the power of three (4)
07. Sort of bowler has a pleasant run in the car (4)
08. Be unable to sleep, though flat out? (3,5)
09. It makes light of its existence, the low creature! (8)
11. Challenge Daniel initially to set time back (4)
12. It's bang up to date with its indication of depression (7,6)
15. ... die? This way in! (4)
17. Being sanctimonious, is at the poll turning on single point (8)
19. You French give me no internal upset, but are poisonous (8)
21. This time not a moment too soon: old as well? What a spree! (4)
22. How it may occur to one day is breaking (4)
23. Vanquished and has been beheaded – by cannibals, no doubt (5)

DOWN

01. Being concerned with heartthrob, beat off (7)
02. Sort of vase one will soundly merit at the end? (3)
03. Two pages of book once folded in paper (5)
04. One having free picture show is no realist (7)
05. Milk supplier to keep under (3)
06. Bread supplier will break out (5)
10. '_________ everywhere and all the boards did shrink' (Coleridge) (5)
11. Part of the regiment left at home where Uncle Sam trains (5)
13. Used to be quietly teaching how to go out and discover (7)
14. Fail to follow the Sapper Northeast with half the guests (7)
16. Work-time gets sung on stage (5)
18. Six take the chair on which they have come to see one (5)
20. Admit nothing two ways (3)
21. Layer essential to British endeavour (3)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2678

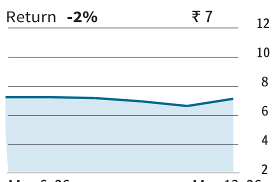
ACROSS 1. Back and forth 8. Resolute 9. Pair 11. Reeve 12. Vertigo 13. Gain 15. Help 19. Tangent 20. Ruche 22. Vain 23. Hazel-nut 24. Sunday school

DOWN 2. Aisle 3. Killer 4. Native 5. Realise 6. Horn of plenty 7. Prerogatives 10. Ore 14. Inn-sign 16. Jet 17. Straws 18. Breech 21. Congo

CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - MAY 14 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Easy Trip Planners to raise ₹500 crore via rights issue



New Delhi: Travel tech platform Easy Trip Planners Ltd on Wednesday said its board has approved raising ₹500 crore through a rights issue. The board of directors has approved the issuance of shares on a rights basis for an amount not exceeding ₹500 crore, Easy Trip Planners, which operates under the brand EaseMyTrip, said in a regulatory filing. Fully paid-up equity shares of face value of ₹1 each will be issued as security, but the number of securities proposed to be issued and the issue price will be determined after finalisation of the terms of the rights issue by the board, as recommended by the rights issue committee, it added. PTI

Federal, Indian Bank, 2 others in MSCI Index

New Delhi: Federal Bank, Indian Bank and two other companies are set to enter the MSCI India Index with effect from May 29, while four entities will move out. Leading global index provider MSCI, which announced the changes in various indices, also said Adani Energy Solutions will not be added to the India Index as the scrip is under the surveillance of the NSE. Apart from Federal Bank and Indian Bank, the Multi Commodity Exchange of India and the National Aluminium Company will enter the index. At the same time, Hyundai Motor India, Jubilant Foodworks, Kalyan Jewellers India and Rail Vikas Nigam will move out, according to an announcement made by MSCI on Tuesday. PTI

SEBI proposes easier norms for MFs to use intra-day borrowing facility

COST BENEFITS. This will help AMCs fund trade settlements, forex obligations and other cash-flow mismatches

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on Wednesday proposed to broaden the use of intra-day borrowing facilities by mutual funds, allowing asset management companies (AMCs) to use such lines beyond redemption payouts and unit holder payments.

The move will allow intra-day borrowing facilities for purposes other than redemption payouts, including trade settlements, forex obligations, mark-to-market (MTM) of derivative positions and other cash management needs.

It will also allow such borrowings to exceed both guaranteed and non-guaranteed receivables during the day, subject to safeguards.

MFs currently use intra-day borrowing facilities mainly to bridge timing mismatches between payouts and receivables during the trading day and as a cash flow management tool. The proposals aim to address operational challenges faced by AMCs due to timing mismatches between outflows and receivables within a scheme.

"Since the pay-in has to be made before specific cut-off timings, the scheme receivables received later in the evening cannot be deployed effectively, which may impact the returns of the scheme," the regulator said.

TRADE SETTLEMENTS

The industry body Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI) had made representations in March that such borrowings were also required for trade settlements (pay-in obligations), forex settlements, derivative obligations and repayment of existing borrowings.

BALANCING FUNDS. The proposals aim to address operational challenges faced by AMCs due to timing mismatches between outflows and receivables within a scheme

For instance, equity and bond trade pay-ins are typically due in the morning, while sale proceeds or TREPS receivables may only come in later in the evening. Restricting such facilities could affect "fund management flexibility and returns of the scheme," the regulator said. The regulator has proposed that the amount borrowed intra-day need not be restricted to guaranteed receivables from entities such as the Government of India, the RBI, the Clearing Corporation of India and other clearing corporations.

BORROWING LIMITS

SEBI also suggested that intra-day borrowings converted into overnight borrowings must remain within existing regulatory limits. Current rules permit borrowing up to 20 per cent of a scheme's net assets for temporary liquidity needs, with a maximum borrowing duration of six months.

AMCs would remain responsible for ensuring all intra-day borrowings are repaid by the end of the day.

Public comments on the proposals have been invited till June 3.

Markets snap 3-day losing streak; metals rally as ₹ slips

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Benchmark indices ended marginally higher snapping a three-session losing streak amid heightened volatility driven by elevated crude oil prices, persistent geopolitical tensions in West Asia and continued foreign fund outflows, while the rupee weakened to fresh record lows against the US dollar.

"After two consecutive heavy sell-off sessions, Indian equity markets witnessed a relatively stable session today although underlying sentiment continues to remain cautious amid persistent global and domestic macro concerns," said Hariprasad K, SEBI-registered Research Analyst and Founder, Livelong Wealth.

The Sensex closed 49.74 points, higher at 74,608.98, while the Nifty 50 gained 33.05 points, to settle at 23,412.60 after a volatile trading session.

The Nifty slipped to an intra-day low of 23,262.55 before recovering to touch 23,582.95, though profit booking in the latter half of the session trimmed gains.

MID-CAP STRENGTH

Broader markets outperformed the frontline indices, with the Nifty Midcap 100 index rising 0.77 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 index advancing 0.31 per cent.

Metal, oil and gas, consumer durables and defence-related counters led gains during the session, while IT and auto stocks remained under pressure.

Analysts said the metal pack benefited from supply disruptions linked to the ongoing West Asia tensions, higher global metal prices and the government's decision to raise customs duty on precious metals to 15 per cent from 6 per cent.

SEBI eases FPI tax liability concerns

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has clarified to banks, custodians and brokers that they will not be held liable for the tax dues of offshore funds in India, easing concerns that had delayed fresh foreign portfolio investor (FPI) registrations and PAN issuance since last month, according to people familiar with the matter.

A public clarification note on the issue is expected to be issued soon by depositories or Income Tax Department, sources said.

"This will be very helpful for foreign investors to find appropriate domestic rep-

resentatives to complete the new RA or AR entry in the CAF form," one person aware of the discussions said, adding, "I believe a clarification note will be published soon."

The issue arose after changes were introduced to the common application form (CAF) framework and PAN application process for FPIs from April 1.

Under the revised framework, representatives of offshore funds, including custodians and intermediaries acting on behalf of FPIs, were required to furnish additional details while applying for PAN allotment for clients.

LIABILITY CONCERNS

This raised concerns among banks, brokers and other intermediaries over whether they could face potential tax liability for offshore funds they represented.

As a result, FPIs found it difficult to identify domestic representative assessees willing to take up the role, slowing onboarding and delaying fresh fund launches.

PAN issuance for new FPIs had been impacted over the past month, with at least 20 newly registered FPIs currently awaiting PAN allotment despite completing registration formalities, according to sources.

An email sent to the regulator did not elicit a response.

Following consultations with the Income Tax Department, SEBI is understood to have clarified via email on Wednesday that banks and brokers acting as representatives for offshore funds would not be exposed to tax liability on behalf of their clients.

The clarification is expected to help ease the current bottleneck in FPI onboarding and PAN issuance, market participants said.

Rashmi Saluja found guilty in Religare deal, ordered to pay back ₹2 crore

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Markets regulator SEBI on Wednesday imposed a penalty of ₹40 lakh on Rashmi Saluja, former Executive Chairperson of Religare Enterprises, and ordered her to disgorge wrongful gains in the form of losses averted of around ₹2 crore by selling the shares of the financial firm on the basis of "unpublished price sensitive information".

The case pertains to Saluja's sale of shares while in possession of unpublished price-sensitive information (UPSI) regarding the Burman Group's impending open offer to REL's public shareholders.

Rashmi Saluja, former Executive Chairperson, Religare Enterprises

'INSIDER TRADING'

In its final order, SEBI noted that Saluja, based on information regarding the Burman Group's impending open offer in the REL scrip, sold REL shares and avoided a loss of ₹1.99 crore.

She engaged in insider trading regarding the sale of shares in the scrip of REL after September 20, 2023, but before September 25, 2023 — the date on which the UPSI concerning the open offer was made public.

Accordingly, SEBI directed Saluja to "disgorge the amount of wrongful gain in the form of losses averted of ₹1.99 crore ... along with simple interest @12 per cent per annum from the date of sell till the date of deposit". Also, the regulator levied a penalty of ₹40 lakh on her.

SEBI examines special distributors framework to deepen bond trading

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is examining a proposal to introduce a specialised category of distributors aimed at expanding the reach of debt products and increasing retail participation in bond investments.

Speaking at the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry Private Distribution Summit, Amarjeet Singh, Whole-Time Member at SEBI, said, "One area which we picked up recently is, we are examining a proposal to introduce a specialised category of distributors to increase the reach of debt products."

BOND RETAILISATION

The regulator is looking at replicating the success of mutual fund distribution across other segments of the financial system and is exploring how we can use this specialised category of distributors to expand the investor base and promote the

Amarjeet Singh, Whole-Time Member, SEBI

retailisation of bonds. The proposed framework would operate on lines similar to mutual fund distributors and help simplify bond investments for retail investors.

"Much like mutual fund distributors, it is envisaged they will simplify the investment process for retail investors by assisting with KYC formalities, documentation and initiating transactions," Singh said.

Singh said that nearly 54 per cent of the mutual fund industry's assets under management were mobilised through regular plans as of March-end 2026. "For many retail investors, particularly first-time investors, distributors remain the first point of engagement with financial markets," he said.

"Excessive focus on short-term performance, rapid customer acquisition or distribution volumes can actually create risks of mis-selling, unsuitable recommendations or product pushing."

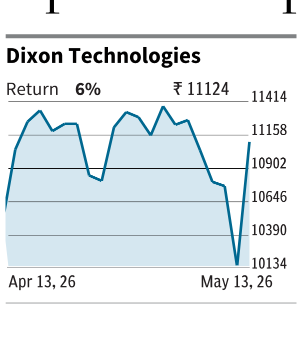
He added that mis-selling often remains undetected as investors may realise much later that unsuitable products had been sold to them. He also urged the industry to maintain transparency and suitability standards across digital platforms. While digital channels improve awareness and outreach, they can equally amplify misinformation, speculative behaviour, and short-termism, he said.

"Market participation should be driven by informed decision-making and long-term reasoning, not driven by momentum or social media trends," he said.

Stressing on the need for ethical distribution practices, Singh said distributors play a critical role in the financial ecosystem.

Dixon Tech jumps 10% despite weak Q4

Our Bureau
Chennai



Shares of Dixon Technologies surged nearly 10 per cent on Wednesday despite the company posting a 36 per cent fall in net profit to ₹256 crore in the quarter ended March 31, from ₹401 crore in the year-ago period.

Notwithstanding the fall in net profit for the first time in 17 quarters, most analysts said the performance was better than expected.

For the quarter, its revenue increased to ₹10,510.51 crore (₹10,292.54 crore) and it recommended a final dividend of ₹10 a share for FY26. During the day, the stock surged to a high of ₹11,229.90 on the BSE, but closed a tad lower at ₹11,124.95.

'BETTER SHOW'

According to Kotak Institutional Equities, Dixon Q4 came in 22 per cent ahead of modest expectation, driven by strong performance in the consumer electronics segment and higher ASP in the mobile segment due to a memory price increase. The domestic brokerage retained its 'Buy' rating with a target price of ₹15,200.

Dixon, according to Equirus Securities, generated robust operating cash flow (OCF) of ₹1,780 crore in FY26, with pre-tax OCF/EBITDA conversion at 118 per cent. Despite FY26 capex of about ₹1,060 crore, the company delivered FCF of ₹720 crore and ended FY26 with cash and cash equivalents of ₹1,240 crore. The brokerage, however, revised its rating to 'Add' from 'Long' with a target price of ₹11,000 (against earlier ₹10,510).

CAUTION ADVISED

However, most foreign brokerages remained cautious on the stock and retained their Hold rating.

CLSA, which cut the target price to ₹10,400 (₹12,100) and has 'Neutral' rating, said Dixon's near-term earnings were vulnerable to a sustained escalation in global memory prices.

Jefferies also lowered its target price to ₹10,280 (₹10,330) with a 'Hold' rating. HSBC said Q4 results were largely in line with consensus estimates while keeping 'Hold' rating with a target price of ₹12,000. However, Macquarie retained its 'Outperformer' rating and a target price of ₹15,000.

BROKER'S CALL.

Choice Institutional

NAZARA TECH (BUY)
Target: ₹400
CMP: ₹266.95

Nazara Technologies is increasingly transitioning into a globally diversified, gaming-first platform with improving earnings quality, strong cash conversion and rising operating leverage. Following portfolio rationalisation over the last two quarters, the business now operates on a structurally cleaner and higher-margin base, with gaming accounting for about 90 per cent of FY26 EBITDA.

Looking ahead, the proposed Bluetile and BestPlay acquisition (Nazara's largest M&A to date) materially strengthens FY27 growth visibility, adding a scaled up casual gaming portfolio, AI-native development capabilities and about 22 million MAUs. Combined with improving profitability across core gaming IPs, scaling up narrative franchises at Fusebox and Smaaash 2.0 rollout, we see scope for sustained revenue acceleration in FY27 & FY28.

Further, FY26 also marks an important transition in operating structure with Centres of Excellence across User Acquisition, Data Analytics, AI, Growth and Product increasingly embedded across the gaming lifecycle. These capabilities are driving improving monetisation, lower acquisition cost and stronger player retention across portfolio companies.

We value Nazara on a SOTP basis arriving at a target price of ₹400 and retain our Buy rating. We believe current valuation do not fully capture the platform's improving profitability profile and longterm compounding potential.

SBI Securities

KPI GREEN (BUY)
Target: ₹562
CMP: ₹435.20

KPI Green Energy has delivered a strong performance in Q4-FY26 and FY26, exceeding our estimates despite delays in power evacuation for the recently commissioned 376 MW GUVNL IPP project at Khavda, Gujarat. For FY26, revenue/EBITDA/PAT grew 55.3/70/49 per cent y-o-y to ₹2,696 crore/₹958 crore/₹476 crore, respectively.

Growth was mainly driven by the CPP vertical, which grew 61.2 per cent y-o-y on the back of strong execution. The company energised 447 MW in Q4-FY26, taking total operational capacity to 975 MW. Units generated rose 64.5 per cent y-o-y to 41 crore units, though it remained below the internal target due to project commercialisation delays.

We have revised upward our FY27 and FY28 estimates across Revenue, EBITDA and PAT by 10–24 per cent, supported by a strong FY26 performance and increasing contribution from the high-margin IPP business, which carries EBITDA margins of around 85–90 per cent. The BESS capacity, expected to become fully operational by FY27, is likely to start contributing to revenue from FY28 onwards. The EPS growth is expected to be marginally impacted by the recent warrant issuance to promoters, resulting in around 5 per cent equity dilution.

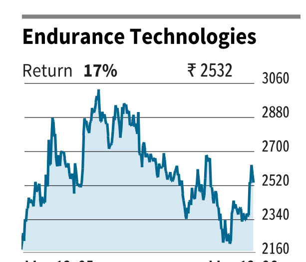
Given strong execution momentum, robust order book and rising contribution from the high-margin IPP business, we maintain our Buy rating with a target price of ₹562, valuing the stock at 18x FY27E EPS of ₹31.2.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Endurance Technologies (₹2,532.15): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



The stock of Endurance Technologies has been in an uptrend for over a month now. It bounced off the support at ₹2,200 in early April, moved up and broke out of a resistance band of ₹2,500-2,520 early this week.

A falling trendline also coincides at this level and so, a rally past this price region indicates a potential shift in trend. While there is a chance for a corrective decline, possibly to ₹2,500, we expect the stock to eventually resume the rally. The stock can touch ₹2,975 before the end of this year and this can be considered for swing trading. Buy now at ₹2,532 and ₹2,500. Place stop-loss at ₹2,380. When the price goes up to ₹2,780 and ₹2,880, raise the stop-loss to ₹2,680 and ₹2,780 respectively. Book profits at ₹2,975.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23481 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23325	23100	23600	23800	Go short on the contract at 23600; stop-loss can be at 23800.

₹749 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
748	740	760	770	Go short when the stock rises to 760; place stop-loss at 775.

₹1123 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1120	1100	1150	1165	Short the stock now and at 1145; stop-loss can be at 1170.

₹304 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
300	295	305	308	Sell the stock as it is trading near a barrier; stop-loss at 308.

₹297 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
295	290	300	308	Go long on the stock if the price dips to 295; stop-loss at 288.

₹1359 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1340	1310	1390	1405	Go short on the stock if it rises to 1390; place stop-loss at 1415.

₹970 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
962	945	985	1000	Might resume the decline; initiate short with stop-loss at 990.

₹2272 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2250	2225	2300	2340	Go short on the stock if it rises to 2300; place stop-loss at 2340.

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 33.05 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Bharti Airtel	1789.20	21.68	29.42	5.11
L&T	3915.80	15.18	28.42	4.28
Tata Steel	219.62	13.73	30.06	1.69
Asian Paints	2617.60	11.05	64.21	1.10
Hindalco	1073.10	10.00	15.00	1.45
Bharat Elec	428.25	9.18	52.50	1.43
Adani Ports	1737.80	7.98	31.32	1.19
ITC	304.45	7.88	18.42	2.73
Adani Enter	2498.00	5.80	32.43	0.67
JSW Steel	1274.90	4.62	40.15	1.11
Cipla	1327.60	4.33	23.66	0.70
Grasim Ind	2945.60	3.54	21.16	1.04
Titan	4090.70	3.19	71.57	1.57
IntGlobeAvi	4255.80	2.67	51.24	0.90
Kotak Bank	377.65	2.65	19.47	2.59
ONGC	297.15	2.24	8.31	1.07
Trent Ltd.	4084.50	1.64	84.35	0.84
UltraTech Cement	11573.00	1.47	41.65	1.28
Max Healthcare	1026.10	1.36	70.36	0.71
Hind Unilever	2267.30	1.03	50.34	1.87
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	231.45	0.70	94.20	0.71
SBI Life	1837.50	0.35	74.61	0.77
HDFC Life	602.80	0.23	68.01	0.60
NestleIndia	1468.90	0.05	80.95	0.98
Tata Motors PV	336.85	0.00	45.81	0.66
Apollo Hosp	8004.50	-0.40	61.69	0.77
Coal India	462.25	-0.40	9.17	0.98
HCL Tech	1143.20	-0.60	18.63	1.12
Dr Reddys Lab	1265.30	-0.62	19.12	0.72
Wipro	187.80	-1.10	14.85	0.50
Maruti Suzuki	13103.00	-1.97	28.06	1.60
Bajaj Finserv	1728.90	-2.00	14.07	0.93
NTPC	390.45	-2.33	15.25	1.72
Tech Mahindra	1375.00	-2.48	28.03	0.81
TataConsumerProduct	1235.00	-2.56	79.01	0.75
Axis Bank	1255.70	-2.75	14.70	3.36
HDFC Bank	749.60	-2.84	14.56	10.68
Shriram Finance Ltd.	920.55	-3.02	21.60	1.20
Bajaj Auto	10262.00	-3.26	27.12	1.06
Eternal Ltd.	237.82	-3.39	627.06	1.60
State Bank	970.10	-4.07	10.33	3.75
Eicher Motors	6971.50	-4.64	35.70	0.89
Bajaj Finance	896.15	-4.70	28.84	2.23
PowerGrid Corp	301.50	-4.74	18.06	1.27
Sun Pharma	1824.80	-4.83	39.97	1.80
TCS	2272.80	-6.12	16.63	2.16
ICICI Bank	1235.60	-7.33	15.27	8.23
Reliance Ind	1358.80	-7.66	19.20	8.55
M&M	3111.80	-12.51	20.78	2.59
Infosys	1123.10	-13.15	15.45	3.67

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 579.85 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Vedanta	323.35	87.78	7.97	2.24
Adanigreenenergy	1366.70	55.55	113.30	1.87
Divis Lab	6796.00	54.53	72.78	3.52
Bpcl	297.10	52.92	5.24	2.46
Adani Power .	213.87	49.51	31.80	3.61
Muthootfin	3506.40	46.32	16.27	1.53
Indian Oilcorp	141.69	42.61	5.43	2.16
Adani Energy Solutions .	1318.20	33.20	66.18	1.87
Hindus Zinc	667.10	30.84	20.38	1.18
Jindal Steel	1242.90	29.90	37.72	1.88
Cg Power & Ind Sol	847.05	25.86	111.47	2.37
Samvardmothersoninternatl	126.32	25.74	36.63	2.28
Hindustanaeronautics	4618.50	24.64	34.72	3.58
Gail (India)	163.31	22.54	12.48	1.80
Power Finance	446.00	21.79	4.41	2.65
Cummins Inida	5212.00	19.83	64.45	2.87
Ambuja Cements	438.40	19.71	19.72	1.09
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1574.60	16.44	25.63	2.75
Mazagoan Dock	2518.50	16.02	36.87	0.78
Siemens Energy India .	3112.60	14.23	93.83	1.12
Solar Industries	15787.00	13.89	93.57	1.57
Indian Railway Finance Corp	101.48	12.04	18.93	0.83
Hdfc Amc	2652.30	11.21	39.76	2.21
Dlf	574.15	8.96	32.09	1.50
Bank Of Baroda	261.65	8.90	6.74	1.98
Rural Elec	346.55	7.76	5.60	1.77
Indian Hotels Co. .	637.40	7.44	40.37	2.28
United Spirits .	1256.40	7.42	53.13	1.51
Zyduslifesciences	939.25	6.07	18.80	0.96
Shree Cement	24995.00	5.10	51.57	1.36
Varun Beverages .	489.15	3.09	51.55	2.73
Union Bank	162.46	1.47	6.38	1.28
Avenuesuper	4334.70	1.25	94.98	2.60
Britannia Ind	5336.00	0.67	50.66	2.57
Godrej Consumer	1030.50	0.34	56.65	1.69
Punjab Natl Bank	102.77	-0.10	6.40	1.45
Abb India	6305.00	-3.48	84.55	1.35
Macrotech Developers .	874.00	-4.25	25.45	1.00
Bosch	36315.00	-4.77	38.85	1.29
Tata Capital	305.35	-5.00	26.50	0.54
Pidilitind	1445.60	-6.48	59.55	1.83
Canara Bank	129.26	-7.14	6.56	1.78
Bajaj Holdings	10025.00	-8.80	11.40	1.77
Hyundai Motor India .	1853.40	-9.86	27.73	1.08
Siemens	3532.20	-10.53	79.34	1.27
Ltimindtree	4086.40	-15.03	24.32	1.55
Tata Motors Cv	384.25	-16.52	85.93	3.28
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3527.20	-22.41	54.88	3.38
Torrent Pharma	4295.80	-25.42	63.99	1.83
Tata Power	404.45	-65.93	25.81	2.76

Pts: Impact on index movement

HDFC Life Insurance Company Limited

Registered office: 13th Floor, Lodha Excelus, Apollo Mills Compound, N. M. Joshi Marg, Mahalaxmi, Mumbai - 400 011. • CIN: L65110MH2000PLC128245, IRDAI Reg. No. 101

AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026

FORM L-1A-A-RA Revenue Account - Policyholders' Account (Technical Account) (₹ in Lakh)

Particulars	For the year ended March, 2026 (Audited)							For the year ended March, 2025 (Audited)						
	Total	Non-linked			Linked			Total	Non-linked			Linked		
		Individual		Group	Individual		Group		Individual		Group	Individual		Group
		Life	Pension		Life	Pension			Life	Pension		Life	Pension	
PREMIUMS EARNED - NET														
(a) Premium	79,38,707	35,44,291	5,97,320	13,76,148	18,62,999	1,12,051	4,45,898	71,04,491	33,88,654	4,36,850	13,04,852	15,21,336	79,143	3,73,656
(b) Reinsurance ceded	(2,07,185)	(78,303)	-	(1,18,566)	(10,316)	-	-	(1,42,877)	(65,279)	-	(72,427)	(5,171)	-	-
(c) Reinsurance accepted	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Sub-Total	**77,31,522**	**34,65,988**	**5,97,320**	**12,57,582**	**18,52,683**	**1,12,051**	**4,45,898**	**69,61,614**	**33,23,375**	**4,36,850**	**12,32,425**	**15,16,165**	**79,143**	**3,73,656**
INCOME FROM INVESTMENTS														
(a) Interest, dividend & rent - gross	13,40,397	6,99,417	2,03,806	2,09,220	1,24,403	14,730	88,821	11,66,561	5,76,174	2,36,440	1,38,565	1,29,345	16,018	70,019
(b) Profit on sale / redemption of investments	9,88,101	1,52,367	4,011	1,047	7,42,032	53,368	35,276	12,53,702	1,32,221	7,157	3,076	9,98,118	64,403	48,727
(c) (Loss on sale / redemption of investments)	(1,38,741)	(20,285)	(707)	(553)	(71,771)	(6,548)	(38,877)	(91,858)	(30,665)	(595)	(4,671)	(45,978)	(2,456)	(7,493)
(d) Transfer / gain on revaluation/ change in fair value	(9,51,750)	(31,137)	(1,853)	-	(7,82,835)	(65,531)	(70,394)	(4,14,644)	16,620	1,931	-	(3,96,254)	(32,219)	(4,722)
(e) Amortisation of (premium) / discount on investments	7,79,510	6,94,133	33,938	14,712	33,989	827	1,911	6,80,768	6,03,118	28,189	16,140	30,825	744	1,752
Sub-Total	**20,17,517**	**14,94,495**	**2,39,195**	**2,24,426**	**45,818**	**(3,154)**	**16,737**	**25,94,529**	**12,97,468**	**2,73,122**	**1,53,110**	**7,16,056**	**46,490**	**1,08,283**
OTHER INCOME														
(i) Income on Unclaimed amount of Policyholders	170	-	-	-	170	-	-	981	-	-	-	981	-	-
(ii) Others	34,563	33,523	769	43	209	8	11	27,319	26,637	473	38	145	18	8
Contribution from Shareholders Account :														
(a) Towards Excess Expenses of Management	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
(b) Towards remuneration of MD/CEOs/WTD/Other KMPs	1,388	739	124	204	291	22	8	981	745	70	27	128	11	-
(c) Others	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Sub-Total	**36,121**	**34,262**	**893**	**247**	**670**	**30**	**19**	**29,281**	**27,382**	**543**	**65**	**1,254**	**29**	**8**
TOTAL (A)	**97,85,160**	**49,94,745**	**8,37,408**	**14,82,255**	**18,99,171**	**1,08,927**	**4,62,654**	**95,85,424**	**46,48,225**	**7,10,515**	**13,85,600**	**22,33,475**	**1,25,662**	**4,81,947**
Commission	9,12,692	3,49,345	67,419	3,08,834	1,72,573	14,289	232	7,83,529	5,03,867	26,319	1,39,614	1,10,096	3,497	136
Operating expenses related to insurance business	7,69,091	4,20,961	64,296	1,09,084	1,59,289	11,436	4,025	6,22,178	4,72,364	31,107	30,578	81,139	6,727	263
Provision for doubtful debts	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Bad debts written off	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Provision for tax	9,411	(7,539)	-	16,880	-	-	70	(58,820)	(79,722)	-	39,501	(18,968)	-	369
Provisions (other than taxation):														
(a) For diminution in the value of investments (net)	1,047	1,599	140	-	(531)	(62)	(99)	7,918	7,982	(64)	-	-	-	-
(b) Others - Provision for standard and non-standard assets	230	235	(1)	-	(4)	-	-	316	129	1	-	36	75	75
Goods and Services Tax on ULIP charges	26,305	-	8	-	22,020	1,188	3,089	48,920	-	26	-	44,705	1,864	2,325
TOTAL (B)	**17,18,776**	**7,64,601**	**1,31,862**	**4,34,798**	**3,53,347**	**26,851**	**7,317**	**14,04,041**	**9,04,620**	**57,389**	**2,09,693**	**2,17,008**	**12,163**	**3,168**
Benefits paid (net)	34,69,145	6,90,149	2,69,864	7,40,087	15,43,886	1,08,042	1,17,117	36,24,655	6,81,642	2,59,159	7,49,727	16,47,770	1,21,158	1,65,199
Interim bonuses paid	2,96,455	2,95,770	685	-	-	-	-	2,43,500	2,42,864	636	-	-	-	-
Terminal bonuses paid	66,737	56,876	9,861	-	-	-	-	66,438	58,114	8,324	-	-	-	-
Change in valuation of liability in respect of life policies:														
(a) Gross	39,18,715	32,48,957	4,60,138	2,22,589	(13,023)	174	(120)	37,23,609	30,98,790	3,27,788	2,55,820	41,222	112	(123)
(b) Amount ceded in reinsurance	(31,714)	(19,001)	-	(12,576)	(137)	-	-	(1,80,705)	(1,75,788)	-	(4,920)	3	-	-
(c) Amount accepted in reinsurance	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
(d) Fund reserve for Linked Policies	2,60,618	-	-	-	(59,486)	(16,972)	3,37,076	5,62,884	-	-	-	2,63,052	(8,919)	3,08,751
(e) Funds for Discontinued Policies	95,730	-	-	-	91,782	3,948	-	45,767	-	-	-	45,429	338	-
TOTAL (C)	**80,75,686**	**42,72,751**	**7,40,548**	**9,50,100**	**15,63,022**	**95,192**	**4,54,073**	**80,86,148**	**39,05,622**	**5,95,907**	**10,00,627**	**19,97,476**	**1,12,689**	**4,73,827**
SURPLUS/ (DEFICIT) (D) = (A) - (B) - (C)	**(9,302)**	**(42,607)**	**(35,002)**	**97,357**	**(17,198)**	**(13,116)**	**1,264**	**95,235**	**(1,62,017)**	**57,219**	**1,75,280**	**18,991**	**810**	**4,952**
Amount transferred from Shareholders' Account (Non-Technical Account)	43,485	1,313	10,853	-	18,158	13,161	-	9,060	-	9,060	-	-	-	-
Amount Available for Appropriation	**34,183**	**(41,294)**	**(24,149)**	**97,357**	**960**	**45**	**1,264**	**1,04,295**	**(1,62,017)**	**66,279**	**1,75,280**	**18,991**	**810**	**4,952**
APPROPRIATIONS														
(a) Transfer to Shareholders' Account	1,19,311	1,628	19,062	97,357	-	-	1,264	99,678	(1,62,371)	65,216	1,75,280	15,809	792	4,952
(b) Transfer to other reserves	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
(c) Balance being Funds for Future Appropriations	(86,133)	(42,922)	(43,211)	-	-	-	-	1,417	354	1,063	-	-	-	-
(d) Funds for future appropriation -Provision for lapsed policies unlikely to be revived	1,005	-	-	-	960	45	-	3,200	-	-	-	3,182	18	-
Total (D)	**34,183**	**(41,294)**	**(24,149)**	**97,357**	**960**	**45**	**1,264**	**1,04,295**	**(1,62,017)**	**66,279**	**1,75,280**	**18,991**	**810**	**4,952**

Form L-2A-A-P&L
Profit and Loss Account -for the year ended March 31, 2026
Shareholders' Account (Non-technical Account) (₹ in Lakh)

Particulars	For the year ended March 31, 2026 (Audited)	For the year ended March 31, 2025 (Audited)
Amounts transferred from the Policyholders' Account (Technical Account)	1,19,311	99,678
Income from investments:		
(a) Interest, dividends & rent – gross	1,18,406	1,01,604
(b) Profit on sale / redemption of investments	29,277	15,976
(c) (Loss on sale / redemption of investments)	(589)	(1,357)
(d) Amortisation of (premium) /Discount on investments	669	(3,714)
Sub-Total	**1,47,763**	**1,12,509**
Other income	16	14
TOTAL (A)	**2,67,090**	**2,12,201**
Expense other than those directly related to the insurance business	2,074	1,278
Contribution to Policyholders' A/c		
(a) Towards Excess Expenses of Management	-	-
(b) Towards remuneration of MD/CEOs/ WTD/Other KMPs	1,388	981
		-
(c) Others	-	
Interest on subordinated debt	22,000	11,716
Expenses towards CSR activities	1,167	1,100
Penalties	-	200
Bad debts written off	-	-
Amount Transferred to Policyholders' Account	43,485	9,060
Provisions (Other than taxation)		
(a) For diminution in the value of investments (net)	1,472	1,330
(b) Provision for doubtful debts	-	-
(c) Others - Provision for standard and non-standard assets	-	(72)
TOTAL (B)	**71,586**	**25,593**
Profit before tax	1,95,504	1,86,608
Provision for taxation	4,505	6,396
Profit after tax	**1,90,999**	**1,80,212**
APPROPRIATIONS		
(a) Balance at the beginning of the year	9,63,048	8,25,856
(b) Interim dividends paid	-	-
(c) Final dividend paid	(45,249)	(43,020)
(d) Transfer to reserves/ other accounts	-	-
Profit carried forward to the Balance Sheet	**11,08,798**	**9,63,048**
Earnings per equity share		
Basic earnings per equity share (₹)	8.86	8.37
Diluted earnings per equity share (₹)	8.85	8.37
Nominal value per equity share (₹)	10.00	10.00

Form L-3A-A-BS
Balance Sheet as at March 31, 2026 (₹ in Lakh)

Particulars	As at March 31, 2026 (Audited)	As at March 31, 2025 (Audited)
SOURCES OF FUNDS		
SHAREHOLDERS' FUNDS:		
Share capital	2,15,782	2,15,299
Share application money received pending allotment	98	64
Reserve and surplus	15,24,828	13,52,599
Credit / [Debit] Fair value change account	28,899	44,598
Sub-Total	**17,69,607**	**16,12,560**
BORROWINGS	3,09,900	2,95,000
POLICYHOLDERS' FUNDS:		
Credit / [Debit] Fair value change account	2,96,092	6,79,498
Policy liabilities	2,49,64,780	2,10,77,779
Funds for discontinued policies		
i) Discontinued on account of non-payment of premium	4,83,118	3,87,802
ii) Others	1,090	676
Insurance reserves	-	-
Provision for linked liabilities	85,37,155	73,57,779
Add: Fair value change	14,97,800	24,16,558
Total Provision for linked liabilities	**1,00,34,955**	**97,74,337**
Sub-Total	**3,57,80,035**	**3,19,20,092**
Funds for Future Appropriations		
Linked	4,205	3,200
Non-Linked (Non-PAR)	-	-
Non-Linked (PAR)	36,431	1,22,564
Deferred Tax Liabilities (Net)	-	-
TOTAL	**3,79,00,178**	**3,39,53,416**
APPLICATION OF FUNDS		
INVESTMENTS		
Shareholders'	20,05,485	18,38,633
Policyholders'	2,49,95,144	2,16,26,705
Assets held to cover linked liabilities	1,05,19,163	1,01,62,815
LOANS	2,82,745	2,37,830
FIXED ASSETS	73,678	60,107
Deferred Tax Assets (Net)	-	-
CURRENT ASSETS		
Cash and bank balances	1,92,312	1,76,970
Advances and other assets	9,33,362	8,10,274
Sub-Total (A)	**11,25,674**	**9,87,244**
CURRENT LIABILITIES	10,80,626	9,48,424
PROVISIONS	21,085	11,494
Sub-Total (B)	**11,01,711**	**9,59,918**
NET CURRENT ASSETS / (LIABILITIES) (C) = (A – B)	**23,963**	**27,326**
MISCELLANEOUS EXPENDITURE (to the extent not written off or adjusted)	-	-
DEBIT BALANCE IN PROFIT & LOSS ACCOUNT (Shareholders' Account)	-	-
DEFICIT IN THE REVENUE ACCOUNT (Policyholders' Account)	-	-
TOTAL	**3,79,00,178**	**3,39,53,416**

Form L-22A - Analytical Ratios
Analytical Ratios for Life Companies

Sl. No.	Particulars	For the year ended March 31, 2026 (Audited)	For the year ended March 31, 2025 (Audited)
1	**New business premium income growth rate**		
	(i) Linked Business	20.83%	56.43%
	(ii) Non-Linked Business		
	Participating	37.20%	-3.04%
	Non Participating	-1.18%	1.48%
2	Percentage of Single Premium (Individual Business) to Total New Business Premium (Individual Business)	25.18%	24.07%
3	Percentage of Linked New Business Premium (Individual Business) to Total New Business Premium (Individual Business)	39.92%	35.44%
4	Net Retention ratio	97.39%	97.99%
5	**Conservation ratio**		
	(i) Linked Business	83.33%	81.05%
	(ii) Non-Linked Business		
	Participating	84.52%	84.99%
	Non Participating	87.54%	86.58%
6	Expense of Management to Gross Direct Premium ratio	21.18%	19.79%
7	Commission ratio (Gross Commission and Rewards paid to Gross Premium)	11.50%	11.03%
8	Ratio of Policyholder's fund to Shareholder's Funds	2024.22%	1987.27%
9	Change in Net worth (₹ in Lakh)	1,57,047	1,47,386
10	Growth in Networth	9.74%	10.06%
11	Ratio of surplus to Policyholders' fund	0.10%	0.33%
12	Profit after tax / Total income	1.92%	1.86%
13	(Total real estate + loans) / (Cash & invested assets)	1.38%	1.27%
14	Total investments/(Capital + Reserves and Surplus)	21.56	21.45
15	Total affiliated investments/(Capital+ Reserves and Surplus)	0.50	0.66
16	**Investment yield (gross and net)**		
	A. Without unrealised Gains		
	Shareholders' Funds	8.04%	7.22%
	Policyholders' Funds		
	Non Linked		
	Participating	8.21%	8.23%
	Non Participating	9.45%	9.69%
	Linked		
	Non Participating	10.56%	17.73%
	B. With unrealised gains		
	Shareholders' Funds	4.99%	8.94%
	Policyholders' Funds		
	Non Linked		
	Participating	0.97%	8.91%
	Non Participating	-3.86%	10.80%
	Linked		
	Non Participating	-0.93%	7.68%
17	**Persistency Ratio - Premium Basis (Regular Premium / Limited Premium Payment under Individual category)***		
	for 13th month	84.85%	86.90%
	for 25th month	77.15%	78.08%
	for 37th month	72.65%	73.63%
	for 49th Month	70.92%	70.17%
	for 61st month	64.36%	63.46%
	Persistency Ratio - Number of Policy Basis (Regular Premium / Limited Premium Payment under Individual category)*		
	For 13th month	82.25%	81.25%
	For 25th month	71.73%	70.56%
	For 37th month	64.82%	67.67%
	For 49th Month	64.64%	61.13%
	for 61st month	55.64%	52.42%
18	**NPA ratio**		
	A. Policyholders' Funds		
	Gross NPA ratio		
	Non Linked		
	Participating	0.01%	0.01%
	Non Participating	0.005%	0.01%
	Linked		
	Non Participating	0.06%	0.06%
	Net NPA ratio		
	Non Linked		
	Participating	NIL	NIL
	Non Participating	NIL	NIL
	Linked		
	Non Participating	NIL	NIL
	B. Shareholders' Funds		
	Gross NPA ratio	0.07%	0.07%
	Net NPA ratio	NIL	NIL
19	Solvency Ratio	177%	194%
20	Debt Equity Ratio	0.18	0.18
21	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	25.88	18.65
22	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	25.88	18.65
23	Average ticket size in ₹ - Individual premium (Non-Single)	92,496	90,212

*The persistency ratios are calculated in accordance with the IRDAI circular no. IRDAI/F&A/CIR/MISC/256/09/2021 dated September 30, 2021

Notes:
1) The above public disclosure is made in accordance with Insurance Regulatory And Development Authority of India (IRDAI) Master Circular no. IRDA/F&A/Cir/MISC/256/09/2021 dated September 30, 2021.
2) During the year ended March 31, 2026, the Company had filed state wise appeals before the GST Appellate Authorities contesting the issues raised in the orders received from the GST Adjudicating Authority confirming the tax demand of ₹ 104,134 lakh plus penalty at 100% and interest as applicable. These tax demands relate to show cause cum demand notices raised by the Directorate General of GST Intelligence (DGGI) on account of disputed input tax credit (ITC) availed and utilised by the Company in respect of certain services. The Company has utilised ₹ 2,420 lakh for payment of pre-deposit for appeals filing, out of ₹ 25,600 lakh deposited under protest with the GST Authority in these matters, and filed a refund application for the balance amount of ₹ 23,180 lakh. Post passing of the order of refund of ₹ 2,000 lakh, the Company has filed an appeal for the balance amount of ₹ 21,180 lakh against the said order. The Company continues to disclose such amounts of tax demand (excluding interest and penalty) as contingent liabilities.
3) During the year ended March 31, 2026, the company had exercised call option and redeemed in full, 6,000 unsecured, rated, listed, redeemable, fully paid-up, subordinated, non-convertible debentures (NCDs) aggregating up to ₹ 60,000 lakh on July 29, 2025. Also the Company had issued unsecured, subordinated, fully-paid, rated, listed, redeemable non-convertible debentures (NCDs) in the nature of 'Subordinated Debt' as per the IRDAI (Registration, Capital Structure, Transfer of Shares and Amalgamation of Insurers) Regulations, 2024 amounting to ₹ 74,900 lakh at a coupon rate of 7.63% per annum.The said NCDs were allotted on December 15, 2025 and are redeemable at the end of 10 years from the date of allotment with a call option to the Company to redeem the NCDs post the completion of 5 years from the date of allotment and annually thereafter.
4) Figures for the previous period have been re-grouped wherever necessary, to conform to current period's classification.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Vibha Padalkar
Managing Director & CEO
(DIN: 01682810)

CHENNAI
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THURSDAY · MAY 14 · 2026

Defence Ministry pushes TReDS to accelerate payments to MSMEs

EASE OF DOING BIZ. Secretary is monitoring developments to address working capital access to MSMEs

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Ministry of Defence (MoD) is at a fairly advanced stage of implementing the Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) to improve sluggish procurement payment cycles and address working capital access to the MSMEs and start-ups, with Defence Secretary RK Singh convening a meeting on Thursday to “iron out” certain issues for smooth transition to digital trade financing.

TReDS, the Reserve Bank of India regulated platform, allows MSMEs and start-ups to upload invoices approved by buyers, which in case of defence sector is mostly government. After that, banks and NBFCs convert invoices into cash. The Ministries of Commerce and MSMEs have already rolled out this mode of payment for ease of doing business.


Defence Secretary RK Singh

DIGITAL PLATFORM

Sources said the MoD has already had a series of interactions with Government e Marketplace (GeM), the digital platform for procurement of goods and services, for integration of TReDS for easier and quicker payment to MSMEs.

The MoD is one of the largest buyers on the platform, with over ₹1 lakh crore in total cumulative order value being sourced in the last financial year. The MoD is also coordinating with the Ministries of Commerce and MSME and Finance, as the tri-services — the Army, the Air Force and the Navy — and defence PSUs are set to be onboarded onto the platform to ensure wider adoption and enforcement of this payment mechanism.

EXPANSION PLAN

Speaking at the CII Annual Business Summit 2026 on Wednesday, Singh expressed confidence that TReDS will be expanded to the defence sector soon. “I had actually given a deadline of April 1, but there are issues to be ironed out, and incidentally, this is something I review almost every week, and I have the next meeting on May 14,” the Defence Secretary said to a poser on the subject from the audience gathered for the plenary session.

“We will make it happen not only for the defence PSU but also for the services and procurement through GeM portal,” Singh remarked, acknowledging that he had promised to roll out new digitised payment earlier.

The push for TReDS is being viewed as part of the government’s larger strategy to deepen the domestic defence manufacturing base by improving liquidity across the sector’s supply chain.

For MSMEs supplying to defence projects, faster settlement of dues is particularly important because of the industry’s high capital requirements and lengthy procurement timelines.

The defence sector engages an estimated 16,000 MSMEs, which are linked to defence manufacturing and supply chains, as per industry and government-backed assessments.

The initiative also dovetails with the Centre’s broader policy thrust on easing business operations and expanding formal credit access for small and medium enterprises.

Banks’ credit offtake, deposit growth surged in second fortnight of April

Our Bureau
Mumbai

After a substantial decline in the first fortnight of the current financial year (FY27), banks’ credit offtake and deposit accretion gathered pace in the second fortnight of April.

Credit growth of all scheduled banks jumped by ₹2,95,164 crore in the reporting fortnight ended April 30, against a decline of ₹4,56,208 crore in the preceding fortnight.

Further, deposit accumulation was robust at ₹2,12,302 crore against a decline of ₹5,95,607 crore, per RBI data.

Outstanding bank credit and deposits in the first fortnight typically tends to decline as short-term business contracted in the run up to the financial year end winds down.

In fact, credit offtake and deposit accretion in the reporting quarter is higher than the year-ago fortnight’s ₹96,509 crore and ₹1,68,845 crore, respectively.

In a recent report, ICRA noted that with India’s real GDP growth expected to grow at a slower clip of 6.5 per cent in FY27 against an estimated 7.5 per cent for FY26, ICRA sees bank credit to moderate and slippage rate to rise in the current financial year amid heightened geopolitical uncertainties and evolving interest rate dynamics.

The rating agency expects credit growth to moderate to sub-12 per cent in FY27 (at 11.0-11.7 per cent, surpassing the growth rate of 10.9 per cent in FY25) from the significantly high level of 15.9 per cent in FY26.

AERA defers 15% revenue recovery to moderate Noida airport charges

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The Airports Economic Regulatory Authority (AERA) has deferred 15.02 per cent of the aggregate revenue requirement (ARR) in the final tariff order for the first control period between 2026 and 2031 for Noida International Airport.

On Monday, *businessline*, in a conversation with AERA Chairperson SKG Rahate, had reported that the authority had significantly rationalised the ARR proposed by the airport operator.

Accordingly, the ARR has been deferred to the next tariff cycle to moderate airport charges during the initial years of operation.

The regulator said the move was aimed at reducing the tariff burden on passengers and airlines at the upcoming greenfield airport, which is scheduled to commence commercial operations from June 15.

DISTRIBUTING TARIFF. AERA fixed the user development fee for departing domestic passengers at ₹490 per passenger for 2026-27 against the proposed ₹653 REUTERS

TARIFF PROPOSAL

Notably, AERA said Yamuna International Airport Private Ltd (YIAPL), the airport operator, had submitted an ARR of around ₹6,847 crore for the first control period under its multi-year tariff proposal.

However, after carrying out analysis, prudence checks and stakeholder consultations, AERA said it rationalised the proposed revenue requirement and allowed around ₹5,308 crore.

“Keeping in mind the fact that Noida Airport is a greenfield airport with significant upfront capital investment and a comparatively lower initial traffic base resulting in higher airport charges, AERA has deferred (carried forward) a substantial portion (15.02 per cent) of the ARR to the next tariff cycle (2nd control period) so as to moderate the airport charges in the interests of passengers and airlines,” the regulator said.

USER DEVELOPMENT FEE

Consequently, AERA fixed the user development fee (UDF) for departing domestic passengers at ₹490 per passenger for 2026-27 against ₹653 proposed by the airport operator.

For departing international passengers, the regulator fixed a UDF rate of ₹980 against the proposed ₹1,200.

These charges are unchanged from the *ad hoc* tariff order issued by the regulator in August 2025.

Besides, the domestic landing charge was fixed at ₹725 per tonne compared to the ₹760 proposed by the airport operator.

Furthermore, AERA said the UDF approved for the airport remains comparable with the national average at major airports and within the range currently levied at non-major airports.

Similarly, the regulator pointed out that UDF has been determined for both embarking and disembarking passengers as airport infrastructure such as aero bridges, travelators, conveyor belts, and terminal facilities are utilised by both categories of passengers.

Meanwhile, AERA said distributing the tariff burden between departing and arriving passengers would ensure a more equitable recovery of airport infrastructure costs.

VARIABLE TARIFF PLAN

The regulator further approved a Variable Tariff Plan for the airport in order to encourage airlines to start new routes, increase flight frequencies, and expand network operations during the initial years of traffic ramp-up.

According to AERA, the variable tariff plan will primarily apply to landing and parking charges and is expected to support airlines in gradually building passenger traffic from the airport.

In addition, AERA reiterated that airport charges at Noida International Airport cannot be directly compared with those at Delhi airport due to structural differences between greenfield and brownfield airports.

Speaking to *businessline* a day earlier, AERA Chairperson Rahate said Delhi airport is an established brownfield airport with depreciated assets and high passenger traffic, whereas Noida International Airport is a newly-operational greenfield airport built with substantial upfront investments and lower initial traffic volumes.

IDENTICAL FARES

Presently, Noida International Airport’s fares are nearly identical to those from Delhi airport on several domestic routes despite Uttar Pradesh levying only 1 per cent value added tax on ATF compared to nearly 25 per cent in Delhi.

These fares have led some industry executives to state that higher aeronautical charges and UDF at the airport are offsetting gains arising from lower fuel taxation.

Nonetheless, sectoral experts aware of the tariff structure said these charges account for only a small portion of airline operating costs, while airlines continue to derive significant benefits from lower ATF taxation in Uttar Pradesh.

GIC Re named manager of $1.4 billion Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool

Our Bureau
Mumbai

General Insurance Corporation of India (GIC Re) said it has been appointed by the government as the manager of the $1.4 billion Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool.

This sovereign-backed maritime insurance pool, launched by the Union Cabinet last month, will safeguard Indian-flagged vessels, India-controlled ships and India-bound cargo navigating volatile maritime corridors, per a GIC Re statement.

With nearly 95 per cent of India’s trade by value moving through maritime corridors, BMIP is expected to lower insurance costs for Indian shipowners significantly and reduce forex outflows to overseas insurance hubs, it added. Under the framework, GIC Re will operationalise dedicated solutions, including war risks in high-risk zones, for cargo, hull and machinery, and all risks for protection and indemnity (P&I) for Indian shipowners.

Together, these will deliver coverage of up to $1.5 billion per loss. BMIP will commence operations with an initial underwriting capacity of ₹927.10 crore, with GIC Re contributing ₹400 crore and the balance subscribed by public and private sector insurers.

Beyond this pool capacity, the government has provided a sovereign guarantee as a backstop of $1.4 billion. The pool with sovereign guarantee has been set up for an initial period of 10 years, extendable by another five.

Hitesh Rameshchandra Joshi, Executive Director, Additional Charge of Chairman-cum-Managing Director, GIC Re, said: “The Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool is a defining moment for India’s insurance and maritime sectors. As its manager, GIC Re is privileged to operationalise a sovereign-backed framework that secures Indian vessels and cargo against geopolitical uncertainty and global market volatility.”

WazirX launches crypto futures trading

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

WazirX on Wednesday announced crypto futures trading on its platform on an affordable fee structure for professional-grade trading, observing a greater “futures wave” in the country.

“Trading volumes are generated by daily traders, and they have all moved to futures, which is growing rapidly in India and globally. However, India’s growth is far greater than the global wave of futures. That’s why we are getting into futures,” said Nischal Shetty, Founder, WazirX, speaking to *businessline*.

WazirX Futures will have a maker fee of 0.02 per cent and a taker fee of 0.04 per cent, with no volume threshold.

Users can access futures directly with the rupee, without converting to USDT before opening a position, making derivatives trading easier for Indian retail traders.

Stating that futures trading in India translated to high fees, Shetty said the exchange had changed that baseline by ensuring that a trader starting out on WazirX Futures gets the same fee rate as an institutional trader on most other platforms.


Nischal Shetty, Founder, WazirX

35 CRYPTO ASSETS

The company currently has about 35 crypto assets at launch and plans to reach over 100 in the next few weeks. Further, it will start with 10 times the leverage to encourage spot traders to enter futures as well.

“It’s made it very hard and expensive and loss-making for people to trade in spot on a regular basis,” said Shetty.

QUICKLY.

RBI eases rules for outward remittances

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Wednesday removed the prior approval requirement for non-bank entities to form tie-up arrangements for facilitating outward remittance services through banks in India. "Authorised dealers are advised to comply with instructions ... while facilitating cross-border outward remittance of funds for non-trade current account transactions using a third-party entity in online mode," the central bank said. PTI

Sri Lanka seeks to strengthen India FTA

Mumbai: Sri Lanka is seeking strengthening of free trade agreement with India to drive deeper economic engagement between the two countries. "India-Sri Lanka free trade agreement has been in force for over two decades. This is a foundation which can be strengthened and modernised now for the next phase of economic engagement between the two countries," Sri Lanka's High Commissioner Mahishini Colonne said on Wednesday. Sri Lanka has overcome financial crisis and demonstrated significant economic recovery. OUR BUREAU

$1 trillion exports target for this year: Goyal

New Delhi: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Wednesday asked for taking the country's goods and services exports to $1 trillion this fiscal year. In 2025-26, exports reached an all-time high of $863.11 billion, registering an increase of 4.6 per cent year-on-year, despite global economic uncertainties, he said. PTI

Cipla vows to ensure drug supply amid falling profit, rising costs

CRUCIAL MEASURES. The firm is taking proactive steps to secure supplies hit by the ongoing war in West Asia

Our Bureau
Mumbai

DOWNWARD SPIRAL. The company's net profit at ₹555 crore for the quarter under review was down 55 per cent

Cipla is working to ensure consistent drug supplies, even as freight and fuel costs, for example, increase due to a prolonged war in West Asia, a top official with the drugmaker said, after it announced its financial performance for the fourth quarter and year ended March 31, 2026.

The company's net profit at ₹555 crore for the quarter under review was down 55 per cent from ₹1,222 crore in the same period last year. The company's total income from operations stood at ₹6,541 crore for the period under review, down 2.8 per cent from ₹6,730 crore in the same period, last year.

Achin Gupta, Cipla's Managing Director and Global Chief Executive Officer, told *businessline* that the quarter was impacted by a combination of factors including an increase in its research and development expenditure, not having Lanreotide (affected by US regulatory action on a manufacturer in Greece), besides a smaller impact from the war.

As the war prolongs, he said, there is an increase across raw materials, fuel, solvents. "We try and maintain enough inventory of, all the input materials that we can, and then we will work with... whatever guidance we receive from the government. There is an active dialogue," said Gupta, as pharmaceuticals is a critical industry.

US TARGETS $ 1 BILLION

"We are trying to ensure as much of supply security as possible, and absorbing some of the cost but, at some point, there is a dialogue to be had with customers and with all the players on the cost side as well," said Gupta, who took charge as MD, last month.

On the FY26 performance, he said, "we recorded our highest-ever yearly revenue of ₹28,163 crore, reflecting the strength of our core businesses despite certain markets facing near-term challenges. Our One-India business surpassed the ₹12,500 crore annual revenue milestone. Key therapies in branded prescription business delivered robust double-digit growth, trade generics business sustained the strong growth momentum and anchor brands of consumer health business maintained leadership position."

Giving an overview of the business, he said, "the US business posted an annual revenue of $780 million supported by demand in our differentiated portfolio and a steady base business." The management expects US to cross $ 1 billion by the end of FY27.

STRONG PIPELINE

The future would see investments in R&D, especially for the developed markets, with a very strong pipeline across respiratory, peptides and complex generics, biosimilars and other complex products, he said.

Cipla's net cash position stood at ₹10,526 crore, and its debt primarily included lease liabilities working capital requirements, it said.

The company could look at acquisitions, he said, strategic opportunities in the US or Europe that would give the company a differentiated play.

Zydus to buy US-based Assertio for ₹1,592 crore

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Zydus Lifesciences, through its subsidiary Zydus Worldwide DMCC, will acquire US-based pharmaceutical company Assertio Holdings Inc in an all-cash deal valued at $166.4 million (around ₹1,592 crore), the companies announced on Wednesday.

Under the agreement, Zydus will acquire all outstanding shares of Nasdaq-listed Assertio for $23.50 per share in cash. Assertio's board approved the transaction after determining that Zydus' proposal constituted a 'superior proposal' under its revised merger agreement with Garda Therapeutics.

The board has also authorised termination of the earlier Garda deal to proceed with the Zydus transaction.

"In making its determination that the Zydus offer represented a superior proposal, the board considered Zydus' strong execution profile, including that the Zydus offer has no financing contingencies, requires no third-party financing, and is fully-guaranteed by a creditworthy Zydus entity, providing Assertio with direct recourse in the event of a breach or failure to close," Assertio said on the company's website.

The acquisition gives Zydus an established specialty oncology commercial platform in the US, anchored by Assertio's oncology supportive-care portfolio. Assertio's key product includes Rolvedon, a long-acting G-CSF biologic approved by the US Food and Drug Administration for prevention of febrile neutropenia in adult cancer patients undergoing myelosuppressive chemotherapy.

ONCOLOGY FOOTPRINT

"This transaction represents a strategic step in strengthening our specialty and oncology footprint in the US," said Dr Sharvil Patel, Managing Director, Zydus Lifesciences. "Assertio brings a focused commercial platform and an approved oncology asset that aligns well with our long-term strategy of building differentiated, durable specialty businesses globally," he added.

TENDER OFFER

The acquisition will be executed through a tender offer, following which Zydus will acquire the remaining shares through a second-step merger at the same price. Upon completion, Assertio will be delisted from Nasdaq.

Illinois-based Assertio Holdings is a company with branded prescription products spanning neurology, oncology, hospital care, pain and inflammation. The company has expanded through licensing, mergers and acquisitions across therapeutic segments.

The transaction is expected to close in the second quarter of calendar 2026, subject to customary closing conditions, including tender of a majority of outstanding shares. The firm said no regulatory approvals are expected to be required.

Assertio Board Chair Heather Mason said the company's strategic review process concluded that Zydus' offer provided the best combination of value certainty and execution capability for shareholders.

STRATEGIC MOVE

- Zydus will acquire all outstanding shares of Nasdaq-listed Assertio for $23.5 per share in cash
- The acquisition gives Zydus an established specialty oncology commercial platform in the US
- Upon completion, Assertio will be delisted from Nasdaq

Tredence bets big on India, eyes 1,500 hires in 18 months

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Tredence, a global data science and AI solutions company, is ramping up its India expansion plans, with the company looking to grow both its domestic market presence and workforce.

"We have 4,200 employees globally, of which roughly 3,500 are in India. We are looking at significant growth here. We're looking at actually expanding our employee footprint in India, primarily through campus. I expect another 1,500 people to be added in the next 18 months," said Sumit Mehra, Co-founder and Chief Technology Officer, Tredence.

The company began its India journey in Bengaluru and has steadily expanded its footprint since then. In January, it inaugurated a new office in Kolkata, followed by the launch of a delivery and innovation centre in Hyderabad in February. It is also planning to expand into Gujarat soon.

WIDENING HORIZON

At the same time, the firm is setting up offices in tier-2 and tier-3 cities to tap into emerging talent pools.

Alongside its India expansion, it is also looking to strengthen its global footprint. "The expansion of our delivery centres is not limited to India. We are looking at establishing delivery centres in Latin America, Europe and Eastern Europe. The goal is a tuck-in M&A that gives us a foothold in these geographies. These acquisitions would be primarily focused towards delivering value to our near-shore customers in Europe and North America, and also opening up new lines of business like platform engineering," Mehra said.

Sumit Mehra, Co-founder & Chief Technology Officer, Tredence

He said the company's M&A strategy is focused on filling capability gaps in areas where it sees strong market potential but lacks a meaningful presence. Last year, Tredence acquired Further Advisory, a management consulting firm focused on the banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI) sector, to strengthen its advisory practice and expand its presence in the industry.

Going forward, the company is looking to strengthen its capabilities in the healthcare, life sciences and telecom-media-tech verticals through acquisitions.

SMALL PRESENCE

"These are two industries in which we have a small presence. So, we intend to grow through acquisitions. The goal is not revenue-oriented but to get capabilities, people, and customers," the CTO highlighted. "Going forward, we'll look at acquiring business lines we want to expand into."

North America is Tredence's largest market, while Europe is growing faster than the company overall. It also has a presence in West Asia. While India has largely served as a delivery centre so far, Tredence is now focusing on the domestic market, particularly GCCs and Indian enterprises. Mehra said 2026 will be a crucial year for its India market strategy, with the company aiming to build a sizable presence in the country by 2027.

Tredence has grown from $32 million in revenue in 2021 and is targeting more than $325 million this year, marking nearly 10x growth in about five years.

"We're looking at 40-50 per cent growth year over year. We've grown 10x in revenue, 6x in profitability, and about 8x in employee base. These were the last five years when the demand was mostly in analytics and cloud-based analytics. With AI coming in, we expect faster growth," he said.

Wipro Consumer Care Ventures invests in Moi Soi from its Fund II

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

The venture arm of Wipro Consumer Care and Lighting, Wipro Consumer Care Ventures, has announced an investment in Moi Soi, a premium pan Asian foods and beverages brand from Ceres Foods Pvt Ltd.

This is a co-investment alongside GVFL and it represents Wipro Consumer Venture's 16th investment to date. It marks the first investment from its Fund II, which started at ₹250 crore, while Fund I was sized at ₹200 crore.

The parent entity, Wipro Consumer Care, crossed an annual turnover of ₹10,000 crore in FY23 and is showing growth prospects.

Moi Soi was founded in October 2021 and focuses on offering over 32 product portfolios spanning sauces, chilli oils, noodles, rice papers, ready-to-eat curries and Asian beverages.

Before securing its latest undisclosed first institutional round on May 13, 2026, from Wipro Consumer Care Ventures and GVFL, Moi Soi, which was under Ceres Foods, raised capital through early-stage start-up channels, tracking back to an accelerator/incubator stage in June 2021. Following this inception phase, the brand secured an early stage VC round of $738,000 in February 2022, which funded its transition into early retail and quick commerce distribution.

DEEPEN DISTRIBUTION

Currently, the company delivers to over 2,000 pin codes across 250 cities in India, dispatching over 6 lakh products every month. The brand is creating the new modern Asian foods and beverages category in India. The fresh capital will deepen distribution across modern trade and quick commerce, expand the portfolio with innovative flavours, and build the brand.

Commenting on the investment, Sumit Keshan, Managing Director of Wipro Consumer Ventures, said Moi Soi has built a strong position in the premium, ready-to-cook space demonstrating an impressive ability to scale with a clear focus on authentic, high-quality products in the Asian cuisine segment delivered with convenience and that the company sees a strong potential for scale in this category.

With GVFL and Wipro Consumer Ventures alongside us, we will build the new modern Asian foods and beverages category in India and make Moi Soi a pantry essential in every Indian household, said Deb Mukherjee, Founder of Moi Soi.

Ixigo unveils AI-powered travel app Tara, adds voice bookings, real-time travel assistance

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Want to book flights and hotel tickets with minimum effort? Meet Tara, the AI-voice assistant at Ixigo's refreshed app that can plan and book your trip in a jiffy, finding best possible options to suit your needs.

The Gurgaon-based OTA launched the AI transformed app on Wednesday showcasing the future of travel bookings, where AI agents proactively assist travellers in the background in real time.

TRAVEL MADE EASY

Co-founders and Co-CEOs Aloke Bajpai and Rajnish Kumar revealed how they have rebuilt the ixigoNext app ground up to make it an AI-native one, and personalised the entire user experience.

Rajnish Kumar, Ixigo Co-founder, giving a demo of the AI-native app

Through a demo, they showcased how Tara responded to commands in both Hindi and English as well as Hinglish presenting users with best options for a trip, incorporating every possible request (near a beach, near a market, sea facing rooms and so on). More language options will be introduced soon.

The redesigned app also introduced Trip Mode, a new built-in travel companion designed to assist users throughout their journey. Trip Mode consolidates all booking information — from ticket to boarding passes to gate details and baggage updates — in one single view and also sends alerts to the traveller.

Bajpai said they have rebuilt the ixigo app on the insight that travellers want peace of mind and solutions to every possible problem that can crop up. While Wednesday's launch was for the flight and hotels app, the same experience will be available on the trains and bus bookings app later, he said.

AI agents send boarding passes directly to travellers on WhatsApp, while also giving them the option to add them to Apple Wallet and Google Wallet, and share them with Digi Yatra. Beyond flights, ixigo's AI agents also proactively assist hotel travellers by coordinating with hotels ahead of check-in to verify room readiness and help ensure a smoother stay experience.

FLIGHT SCHEDULES

There are AI agents that also monitor flight schedules in real time, alert users to delays or schedule changes, and helps manage refund flows in case of cancellations. Many of these agentic features are permission-based and opt-in, ensuring users remain fully in control, with more agentic flows set to be introduced in the future.

QUICKLY.

Gold slips as inflation weighs on rate cut bets

Gold prices slipped for a second consecutive session on Wednesday as war-led inflation concerns weighed on expectations for interest rate cuts. Spot gold was down 0.6 per cent to $4,686.99 per ounce at 1305 GMT. US gold futures gained 0.2 per cent to $4,694.70. Silver lost 0.2 per cent to $86.70. REUTERS

Crude oil remains flat as Trump heads to China

London: Crude oil prices were little changed as investors monitored a fragile Middle East ceasefire and awaited a summit in Beijing between US President Donald Trump and China's Xi Jinping. Brent crude futures were down 14 cents to $107.63 a barrel at 1328 GMT. US WTI edged up 44 cents to $102.62. REUTERS

Aluminium near 4-year high, copper rallies

London: Copper prices rose for an eighth session reaching the highest since January 29 due to the bullish technical signals and outperforming prices in the US, while aluminium traded near four-year high due to worries about market deficit. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME gained 1 per cent to $14,155 a tonne by 1407 GMT. Aluminium rose 2.5 per cent to $3,652. REUTERS

Govt hikes minimum support price for kharif crops, raises paddy rate by 3%

HIGHER OUTGO. Centre estimates the total payout to farmers at ₹2.6 lakh crore after the price revision

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

In an apparent move to correct price distortions in certain crops as flagged by the Economic Survey, the Union government announced a ₹10/quintal hike in minimum support price (MSP) of maize and a modest 3 per cent rise in paddy MSP for kharif 2026. The MSP for pulses (except moong), oilseeds and nutri-cereal crops has been increased by 4-9 per cent compared with a year ago.

Announcing the new MSPs for the ensuing kharif season after the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the price recommendations of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP), Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the MSPs had been fixed to ensure remunerative prices for farmers and are at least 50 per cent above the cost of production (A2+FL formula) across all the 14 crops.

The government estimates the total payout to farmers at ₹2.6 lakh crore after the revision in MSP, he said, adding that the annual procurement is estimated to be 824 lakh tonnes.

ETHANOL PROGRAMME

The MSP for paddy has been increased by ₹72/quintal to ₹2,461, that of maize by 0.4 per cent to ₹2,410 and moong by 0.1 per cent to ₹8,780. The common grade paddy MSP has also been raised by ₹72 to ₹2,441/quintal.

On the other hand, tur (arhar) MSP has been hiked by ₹450 to ₹8,450/quintal and urad by ₹400 to ₹8,200 per quintal. Similarly, soybean has been given a rise of ₹380 by fixing its MSP at ₹5,708/quintal, and groundnut has raised by ₹254 to ₹7,517 per quintal.

Even sunflower seed MSP is up by ₹622 to ₹8,343/quintal, that of niger by ₹515 to ₹10,052/quintal and sesamum by ₹500 to ₹10,346/quintal.

The Economic Survey, presented by the government in January 2026, had blamed the rise in the maize crop to the ethanol programme at the cost of oilseeds and pulses, while the paddy area also grew.

In 2025-26, the MSP of maize was raised 8 per cent; as a result, the acreage rose to 120.91 lakh hectare (lh) from 112.41 lh and its production, too, surged to 434 lakh tonnes (lt) from 377 lt.

Farmers further expanded the area to 138 lh in 2025-26 despite maize prices ruling 27 per cent below MSP at an average ₹1,739/quintal between October 2025 and April 2026.

PLEA TO RECONSIDER

The MSP for cotton (long staple), as preferred by most farmers, is up by ₹557 to ₹8,667/quintal. The MSP for medium staple cotton, too, has been increased by the same ₹557 to ₹8,267/quintal.

The MSP of jowar (sorghum) has been given the maximum hike of 8.8 per cent among all the 14 crops and will now command ₹4,023/quintal.

Revised prices for 2026-27 kharif crops (₹/quintal)

	2025-26	2026-27	% Change
Paddy (Grade A)	2,389	2,461	3.0
Jowar	3,699	4,023	8.8
Bajra	2,775	2,900	4.5
Ragi	4,886	5,205	6.5
Maize	2,400	2,410	0.4
Tur	8,000	8,450	5.6
Moong	8,768	8,780	0.1
Urad	7,800	8,200	5.1
Groundnut	7,263	7,517	3.5
Sunflower	7,721	8,343	8.1
Soybean	5,328	5,708	7.1
Sesamum	9,846	10,346	5.1
Nigerseed	9,537	10,052	5.4
Cotton (Long Staple)	8,110	8,667	6.9

Wheat buys top 30 mt, heading towards 34.5 mt

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Wheat procurement this season has crossed the 30 million tonne-mark and is moving towards the Centre's target of 34.5 mt.

For the first time this year, total procurement has overtaken year-ago levels after trailing continuously for the first 40 days of the season, which began on April 1.

The Centre procured 30.15 million tonnes (mt) of wheat till May 12, up 3 per cent from 29.17 mt a year ago. Procurement was still lagging by 3 per cent until May 7.

Officials said the shortfall in Madhya Pradesh is expected to narrow further in the coming days as procurement will continue until June 30, while last year's numbers have already stabilised. The decline of around 0.7 mt in Madhya Pradesh has so far been offset by nearly 1.5 mt higher procurement in Haryana, officials added.

According to the latest data, procurement in Punjab reached 12.16 mt, compared with 11.79 mt a year ago, an increase of 3 per cent.

The Centre had set a procurement target of 12.2 mt for Punjab in 2026-27, against 11.92 mt bought in 2025-26.

Notably, almost the entire procurement in Punjab this season was made under relaxed quality specifications due to widespread lustre loss caused by unseasonal rain and hailstorms in several districts.

In Haryana, wheat procurement touched nearly 8.46 mt, surpassing the target of 7.2 mt and rising 20 per cent from 7.05 mt a year ago. The Centre had procured 7.14 mt from the State in 2025-26.

M.P. NARROWS GAP

Madhya Pradesh has seen a sharp recovery this month, reducing the procurement decline from 59 per cent at the end of April to just 9 per cent as of May 12.

Procurement in the State reached 7.04 mt, compared with 7.77 mt a year ago.

The Centre had raised Madhya Pradesh's procurement target from the initial 7.8 mt to 10 mt in late April. In 2025-26, the State contributed 7.77 mt to the central pool. Procurement in Uttar Pradesh rose to 1.17 mt from 0.98 mt a year ago, while Rajasthan recorded 1.61 mt against 1.55 mt last year. In Bihar, procurement jumped 76 per cent to 29,249 tonnes from 16,655 tonnes a year ago.

The Centre has also revised procurement targets upward in several States — Uttar Pradesh to 2.5 mt from 1 mt, Rajasthan to 2.35 mt from 2.1 mt and Bihar to 0.18 mt from 18,000 tonnes.

ARRIVALS DECLINE

Daily arrivals across the country stood at 0.67 mt on May 12, sharply higher than 0.13 mt a year ago but lower than 1.08 mt recorded on April 30. Arrivals have declined substantially in most States, except Madhya Pradesh, where arrivals remained close to 0.5 mt on May 12.

State procurement agencies have been directed to separately store and account for wheat procured under relaxed quality specifications. Unseasonal rain in March and April led to higher moisture content, shrinkage and loss of lustre in grains.

Geopolitical crisis, weather may help India export 2 mt wheat: USDA

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

India will likely export at least two million tonnes (mt) of wheat, given the current developments in the global grains market, including the geopolitical crisis and weather, with the US production of the cereal estimated at a 57-year low.

"With hefty supplies, the (Indian) government has recently removed the wheat export ban in place since May 2023, and the country is forecast to become a net exporter, albeit small relative to global trade," said the US Department of Agriculture (USDA).

In its *Grain: World Market and Trade* report released on Tuesday night, the USDA raised its export projections of Indian wheat by 1.75 mt to 2 mt from 0.25 mt last month. The projection comes on the heels of global wheat production for 2026-27 being pegged at 819.1 mt, down 24.8 mt from the record 2025-26 crop.

SIGNIFICANT CUTS

"The cuts are most significant among major exporters, such as the United States (-11.5 mt, -21 per cent), the EU (-9.1 mt, -6 per cent), Argentina (-6.9 mt, -25 per cent), Australia (-6 mt, -17 per cent), Canada (-5 mt, -12 per cent), Kazakhstan (-4.3 mt, -22 per cent) and Russia (-4.3 mt, -5 per cent)," said the USDA.

In India, feed and residual consumption is projected to increase while declining in China, the EU, Russia and Kazakhstan. "The geopolitical crisis, particularly the Iran war, has resulted in crude oil and fertilizer prices rising. The agri-commodity outlook is bullish for the second half of the year. It could be the year of agri commodities," said Delhi-based exporter Rajesh Paharia Jain.

At $6.60 a bushel, wheat prices are currently hovering at a 23-month high.

As wheat production is projected to decline below offtake, prices will rise. "US wheat prices have gained roughly $17/tonne recently due to drought conditions," said an analyst.

Earlier, India was expected to export below 3 lakh tonnes. However, fertilizer shortage in Australia, the US, and Canada, besides a prolonged dry weather, have changed the global trade scenario. Projections for Indian exports come at a time when there is uncertainty over production this year.

The Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare has projected a record high of 120 mt of production. However, a survey carried out by the Roller Flour Millers Federation of India predicted at least 5 mt of production lower than the government's estimates.

PRICES BELOW MSP

The government has fixed the MSP at ₹2,585 per quintal this year. Currently, prices in the agricultural produce marketing committee yards are ruling at ₹2,450. The market is poised to rise following the USDA projections.

Currently, US soft red winter wheat is quoting at $260 a tonne, while European wheat is offered at $230. In comparison, Indian wheat is quoted at $270-275.

IVPA welcomes govt's decision to increase MSP for oilseeds

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The Indian Vegetable Oil Producers' Association (IVPA) has welcomed the government's decision to increase the minimum support price (MSP) for kharif crops for the marketing season 2026-27, particularly the significant hikes announced for oilseeds such as sunflower, soybean, sesamum and groundnut.

Quoting Sudhakar Desai, President of IVPA, a media statement said, "A sustainable edible oil economy requires a balanced approach that protects farmer remuneration while also safeguarding consumer affordability. MSP support plays a critical role in strengthening farmer confidence and encouraging crop diversification towards oilseeds."

Sudhakar Desai, President, IVPA

The association noted that higher MSP support for oilseeds is aligned with the country's long-term objective of reducing import dependence and strengthening domestic oilseed productivity and value addition.

GLOBAL CYCLES

The continued upward revision in MSP reflects the government's commitment towards ensuring remunerative returns to farmers and encouraging higher domestic oilseed cultivation at a time when the global agricultural markets remain volatile, it said.

The IVPA believes India needs a more stable and dynamic import policy framework that can respond to changing global price cycles, domestic crop economics and inflationary trends. A calibrated policy mechanism can help maintain equilibrium between farmer interests, industry viability and consumer price stability, the statement said.

Edible oil import bill jumps 19% during oil year H1

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The edible oil sector continued to import more in the first six months of the 2025-26 (November-October) oil year, leading to a 13.66 per cent increase in volume and 19 per cent increase in value.

Data compiled by the Solvent Extractors' Association of India (SEA) showed that the country imported 78.15 lakh tonnes (lt) of edible oils during November 25-April 26 against 68.76 lt in the corresponding period of the previous oil year, registering a growth of 13.66 per cent.

BV Mehta, SEA Executive Director, said the value of imported edible oils increased to around ₹87,000 crore during the first six months of the oil year 2025-26 from ₹73,000 crore in the corresponding period of 2024-25, a growth of 19 per cent.

PALM OIL IMPORTS

Though imports increased to 13.07 lt in April from 11.73 lt in March, palm oil imports declined during April. India imported 5.1 lt of crude palm oil (CPO) in April against 6.73 lt in March, a decline of 24.21 per cent. RBD palmolein imports witnessed a sharp decline of 88.62 per cent from 13,498 tonnes in March to 1,536 tonnes in April.

Mehta attributed this decline to weak demand and higher prices, marking a shift in purchasing patterns. Sunflower oil imports more than doubled, and soybean oil imports rose 25 per cent month-on-month as refiners shifted to alternatives. A price rally in palm oil reduced its discount to rival oils, reducing its appeal to refiners, he said.

OIL SURGE. The value of imported cooking oils rose to nearly ₹87,000 crore from ₹73,000 crore a year ago, while import volumes increased to 78.15 lakh tonnes from 68.76 lakh tonnes

Sunflower oil imports increased to 4.34 lt in April from 1.96 lt in March. The country imported 3.6 lt of soybean oil in April against 2.87 lt in March.

LOW INVENTORY

"While current supplies remain sufficient due to high domestic mustard seed crushing, low inventory levels may prompt increased imports in the coming months," he said.

However, overall palm oil imports (including CPO and RBD palmolein) increased to 39.67 lt during November-April 2025-26 from 27.44 lt in the corresponding period of the previous oil year. During the first half of the oil year 2025-26, India imported 15.5 lt of sunflower oil (15.29 lt in November-April 2024-25), and 22.91 lt of soybean oil (26 lt).

Mehta said the import price of palm oil increased by 14-15 per cent in April 2026 when compared to the April 2025 levels, and the price of soybean and sunflower oils increased by 17-22 per cent.

KEY SUPPLIERS

Indonesia supplied 16.3 lt, and Malaysia 15.2 lt of palm oil to India during the first six months of the oil year 2025-26. India imported 13.32 lt of soybean oil from Argentina, followed by Brazil at 4.25 lt.

During the period, Russia and Ukraine exported 8.1 lt and 2.74 lt of sunflower oil, respectively, to India.

Nepal exported around 2.17 lt of refined oils during November-February 2025-26.

Agrizy launches GenAI-powered formulation platform

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Agrizy, a tech-led contract research, development and manufacturing organisation (CRDMO) for global food, beverage and wellness brands, has launched a proprietary GenAI-powered formulation platform to streamline internal product development workflows.

A company statement said the platform can convert product concepts into manufacturing-ready formulations within minutes, reducing new product development (NPD) timelines and costs by up to 40 per cent.

The platform generates ranked formulation options with ingredient quantities, cost estimates, nutritional and allergen analysis, compliance checks and export-ready lab documentation, helping NPD teams accelerate product development.

Teams can input parameters such as product category, packaging, target cost, shelf life, formulation preferences, marketing claims, ingredient restrictions and sensory or performance profiles to receive actionable formulation outputs within minutes.

The platform also features an integrated AI copilot that supports continuous optimisation across ingredients, costing, compliance, nutrition profiles and end-use performance, making development faster, smarter and more iterative.

3 KEY AREAS

Approved formulations are routed to Agrizy's in-house labs, where bench trial data — including yield, stability, sensory results and quality metrics — continuously refine the recommendations.

According to the company, the platform's edge lies in three areas: an India-specific ingredient ontology tagged with FSSAI, FDA and EFSA regulatory status; formulation memory that learns from failed combinations as well as successful ones; and built-in constraint guardrails.

Quoting Arun Markish, Co-Founder and CTO of Agrizy, the statement said, "We engineered the system to solve core inefficiencies by unifying ingredient ontology, formulation logic, regulatory constraints and feedback into a single intelligence layer that continuously improves with every iteration. This allows R&D and product teams to simulate, refine and validate formulations with greater accuracy before physical trials, significantly improving development efficiency, scalability and speed to market."

Buy copper futures if the price drops to ₹1,380

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Copper futures (₹1,400/kg) have been in an uptrend since the final week of March. Particularly, the May contract rebounded from the support at ₹1,100 on March 23 and since then, it has stayed bullish. After some consolidation recently between ₹1,270 and ₹1,300, copper futures (May) broke out of the range on May 6 and have moved up to the current level of ₹1,400.

COMMODITY CALL.

The breakout last week confirmed a bullish flag pattern, according to which copper futures could hit ₹1,520 soon. As long as the contract stays above the 21-day moving average, which is now at ₹1,300, the trend will be bullish and price correction, if any, could be seen as buying opportunities.

If the price slips below ₹1,300, the outlook could turn weak. Notable support levels below ₹1,300 are at ₹1,270 and ₹1,225.

Though the trend is positive, traders are advised to wait for a correction for a better risk-reward ratio, instead of going long now.

TRADE STRATEGY

Buy if the price drops to ₹1,380. Place stop-loss at ₹1,355. When the contract rises to ₹1,450, alter the stop-loss to ₹1,420. Book profits at ₹1,500.

ITC's agritech platform helps farmers detect diseases across 70 crops

Our Bureau
Kolkata

ITC Ltd's crop-agnostic full-stack agritech platform, ITCMAARS, said its hyper-local and customised AI solution "Crop Doctor" helped farmers improve plant health across 70 crops.

Powered by AI and machine learning, Crop Doctor enables real-time detection of diseases and pest infestations, while delivering tailored remedial guidance to farmers.

The development comes as this year's International Day of Plant Health theme — "Plant Biosecurity for Food Security", championed by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations and the International Plant Protection Convention (IPPC) — highlights the need to strengthen protection against pests and diseases to safeguard food supplies and livelihoods.

DISEASE DETECTION

Integrated into the ITCMAARS superapp, Crop Doctor uses AI-based image analytics to instantly diagnose crop diseases and pest attacks. The tool recommends customised remedial measures spanning chemical, biological and mechanical crop management practices. Recommendations are available in vernacular text and audio formats for easier access.

Launched in 2022, ITCMAARS has benefited nearly 2.5 million farmers and 2,180 farmer producer organisations across 11 States.

FARM INCOMES UP

According to pilot estimates, the initiative reduced fertilizer use by 10-15 per cent and improved crop yields by 15-20 per cent, leading to around 25 per cent higher farm incomes.

ITC said its agriculture-focused digital stack aims to eventually reach 10 million farmers.

"Plant health and food security are deeply interconnected, especially in the context of climate change and pest risks. Comprehensive interventions for soil health, agri inputs and weather alerts across sowing to harvesting are critical in ensuring good plant health," said S Ganesh Kumar, Chief Executive, Agri Business Division, ITC Ltd.

QUICKLY.

Central govt staff body seeks 'work from home'

New Delhi: An association of Central government employees on Wednesday asked the Centre to issue guidelines on work from home, online meetings and virtual conferencing. The move came following a call by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on cutting down avoidable expenditure due to the West Asia crisis. The forum is a representative body of CSS officers. PTI

Withdrawal of retirement funds to be automated

New Delhi: The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) will soon automate the process for settling final PF withdrawal claims, fast-tracking the money transfer to the applicant's bank accounts, a top official said on Wednesday. At present, partial or advance withdrawal claims of up to ₹5 lakh are settled through auto mode, and the deadline for the auto-settlement mode is three days from filing the claim. PTI

In expansion bid, Zoho to invest ₹70 crore in ONDC

ZOHO

Chennai: Chennai-based SaaS major Zoho Corporation has announced an investment of ₹70 crore in the Open Network for Digital Commerce. ONDC is a Government of India initiative that takes e-commerce from a platform-centric model to an open, interoperable network. Zoho's investment will help expand the network's ecosystem and accelerate adoption. OUR BUREAU

PM opts for smaller convoy amid austerity measures linked to war

LEADING BY EXAMPLE. Union ministers, CMs follow suit in response to Modi's call

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Days after giving a clarion call for adopting austerity measures, including avoiding travelling in personal vehicles, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, guarded by the elite Special Protection Group (SPG), on Wednesday was seen zipping through the streets of the National Capital in a convoy of two cars. The PM's cabinet colleagues and Chief Ministers and others too followed suit, significantly reducing their convoy to a four vehicles including SUVs carrying arms wielding commandos.

Modi, who faces a high threat perception, was travelling in an armoured Range Rover, with a Toyota Fortuner escort, filled with SPG security officials.

Traditionally, the PM's convoy has more than a dozen vehicles to accommodate security, jammers and an ambulance but the size has been significantly curtailed to set an example for VVIP protectees.

The previous convoy has been a mix of Mercedes-Maybach, Range Rover, BMWs and Toyota Fortuners.

The downsizing, however, has been done keeping in mind that the move is not out of sync with the SPG's manual on the PM's protection, sources said.

LEADING BY EXAMPLE. PM Narendra Modi's two-car convoy moving through New Delhi on Wednesday ANI

INDUCTION OF EV

After his May 10 speech in Hyderabad, where he appealed to citizens to adopt a series of austerity measures in view of West Asia crisis, which has raised global oil prices and escalated pressure on foreign exchange, Modi's convoy size was cut in his subsequent trips to Gujarat and Assam.

It is learnt that the PM also sought the induction of electric vehicles into his convoy, wherever possible, without making new purchases.

Giving into the PM's national call, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, too, reduced the number of vehicles in his retinue to four.

Sources said that he had directed his office to further reduce the size to make his travel economical. Union Home Minister Amit Shah, too, followed with significant reduction from nearly a dozen vehicles which now form part of his convoy. Officials, however, stated that all essential vehicles mandated under the Central Reserve Police Force's 'Z+' security protocol remained in place.

OTHERS FOLLOW

The directive is part of a broader effort to promote minimalism in governance and ensure better allocation of public resources.

Taking a cue, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath directed an immediate 50 per cent reduction in the fleet of vehicles accompanying the Chief Minister and Ministers, and urged the people to cut fuel consumption and avoid unnecessary gold purchases in view of the prevailing global situation.

Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav announced that he will use a minimum number of vehicles for his convoy and asked his ministerial colleagues to do the same.

TN CM Vijay wins floor test; 144 'ayes' include 25 AIADMK MLAs

Our Bureau
Chennai

The TVK-led Tamil Nadu government, headed by C Joseph Vijay, on Wednesday comfortably won the crucial floor test in the Assembly, securing the support of 144 members.

While 22 MLAs voted against the motion, five members remained neutral during the motion of confidence moved by Chief Minister Vijay to prove the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam's majority on the floor of the House.

The confidence motion exposed a sharp divide within the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK), with 25 rebel MLAs led by SP Velumani and CV Shanmugam backing the TVK and 22 legislators aligned with party general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami voting against the resolution.

Subsequently, on Wednesday evening, AIADMK's Palaniswami cracked the whip, and relieved members of the factions supporting Velumani and Shanmugam from party positions.

The TVK had won in 108 constituencies — since Vijay had contested from two constituencies it had 107 MLAs — falling short of the 118 mark of individual majority in the 234-member house.

Tamil Nadu CM Joseph Vijay addressing the Assembly

However, the TVK received the support of the five members of the Indian National Congress, two members each of the Communist Party of India, the Communist Party of India (Marxist), and the Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi, and an Indian Union Muslim League MLA.

The lone MLA of the Amma Makkal Munnetra Kazhagam, S Kamaraj, also extended support to the government.

DMK WALKOUT

The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam walked out ahead of the voting. The Pattali Makkal Katchi legislators and the lone BJP MLA abstained.

Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin said that voters were keenly watching the TVK government's actions and urged it to work for the welfare of the entire State.

The proceedings, telecast live for the first time, witnessed heated scenes after rebel AIADMK leader Velumani was permitted to speak immediately after Palaniswami.

Legislators backing Palaniswami objected to the Speaker allowing another member from the same party to speak after the AIADMK General Secretary had already opposed the motion.

Speaking after the vote, Vijay thanked members for supporting the motion and said his government would function with a "strong conscience" and remain secular.

Recalling TVK's electoral rise, he said the party secured 34.92 per cent vote share and over 1.72 crore votes within three years of its launch. "We are a minority government but will safeguard minorities and work for all sections of the people. This is the people's government," he said.

Labour Secy asks industry to revise payrolls to protect social security benefits

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

Labour and Employment Secretary Vandana Gurnani on Wednesday urged the industry to restructure payroll systems so that employers do not keep the basic wage artificially low, while showing very high allowances, as this practice reduces employees' social security benefits.

"There are certain establishments where the allowances are so high and the base is so low that it starts affecting the social security of the employees and the workers. So, that correction has been done through these (labour) codes and again this may require some amount of restructuring of your payrolls, etc. which I am sure you will be doing going forward," Gurnani said as the comprehensive labour reforms set in with recent gazette notifications.

The Code on Wages mandates that basic pay, dearness allowance and retaining allowance must comprise at least 50 per cent of the total CTC.

Speaking at Assocham's national seminar on 'New Labour Codes: Implementation, Compliance to Competitive Advantage & Industry Readiness', the Secretary also advised the industry to ensure transparency through wage slips, so workers clearly know how much they are being paid, and what deductions or reductions are being made.

Vandana Gurnani, Secretary, Labour and Employment BLOOMBERG

She also stated that on account of the change in wage definition, the coverage of the ESIC is going to be higher while seeking cooperation from industry, effective roll out.

The Code on Social Security, 2020, extends ESIC coverage nationwide, seeks mandatory registration for establishments with more than 10 employees and voluntary coverage for companies with strength below that threshold. The ESIC coverage includes hazardous industries (even 1 worker), gig/platform workers, offering comprehensive medical and monetary benefits.

"The government is working closely with States and industry to ensure a smooth, technology-driven implementation of the new labour codes aimed at reducing compliance burden, improving worker welfare and strengthening India's global competitiveness," she said.

TECH-ENABLED

Highlighting the government's digital-first approach, the Labour Secretary said future inspections under the labour codes would be risk-based, technology-enabled and focused on facilitation rather than intrusive enforcement.

Speaking at the seminar, Ramesh Krishnamurthi, Central Provident Fund Commissioner (CPFC) and Chief Executive Officer, Employees' Provident Fund Organisation, India, said the EPFO is introducing API-based return filing systems, automated account transfers and simplified withdrawal mechanisms to improve ease of compliance for employers and workers. "The focus is on ease of access, ease of living and building a seamless digital compliance ecosystem," he said.

Krishnamurthi, who spoke before Secretary Gurnani, added that inspections under the social security framework would increasingly rely on data analytics and web-based systems to identify high-risk non-compliance cases, ensuring greater transparency and efficiency.

Uber to set up first India data centre with Adani Group

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Uber will set up its first data centre in India in partnership with the Adani Group, marking a significant expansion of its technology infrastructure in the country.

Uber CEO Dara Khosrowshahi announced the move in a post on X.

"Great to meet @gautam_adani in Ahmedabad this morning and build on our existing partnership with the Adani group. As India fast emerges as a leading innovation hub for @Uber, we are setting up our first data center in the country with the Adani Group to test and deploy our tech. Ready later this year, this investment will help us build at scale — from India, for the world," Khosrowshahi wrote.

In January 2026, Adani Enterprises Ltd stated that the company will invest over ₹5,000 crore in a 100 MW data centre powered by renewable energy, over the coming 5-7 years.

Adani will work closely with local MSMEs and start-ups to develop a globally competent supplier base and generate 600 jobs.

US to impose visa curbs on 13 persons linked to India's online pharmacy over fentanyl

Our Bureau
New Delhi

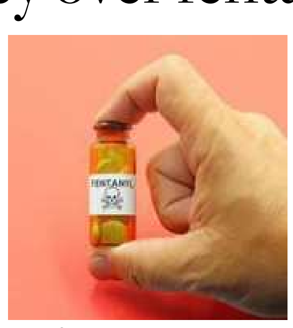
The US has moved to impose visa restrictions on 13 persons from entering the country over their ties to KS International Traders, an India-based online pharmacy accused of selling counterfeit prescription pills containing illicit fentanyl to people in the US, "harming families and communities".

"Today, the Department of State is announcing steps to impose visa restrictions on 13 individuals who are close business associates of KS International Traders and its owner. KS International Traders generated revenue through the trafficking of illicit fentanyl, which President Trump designated as a Weapon of Mass Destruction...," per a press statement issued on Tuesday by Thomas Pigott, Spokesperson, US Department of State.

Illicit fentanyl — a powerful opioid synthetic drug several times more potent than morphine — is killing too many Americans, the statement noted.

IMPACT ON FAMILIES

"Sanctioned online pharmacies like KS International Traders, based in India, have sold hundreds of thousands of counterfeit prescription pills laced with illicit fentanyl to unsuspecting victims across the United States, devastating families and communities nationwide," it said.



Illicit fentanyl is killing too many Americans, the statement noted

The company faced US sanctions last year as well. In September 2025, KS International Traders and two Indian nationals Sadiq Abbas Habib Sayyed and Khizar Mohammad Iqbal Shaikh, were sanctioned by the US Department of the Treasury's Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) for collectively supplying hundreds of thousands of counterfeit prescription pills filled with fentanyl and other illicit drugs to victims across the US.

"This action underscores the United States and India's enduring and shared commitment to dismantling illicit drug entities and disrupting trafficking networks that harm Americans. Those complicit in poisoning Americans will be denied entry to the United States," the Spokesperson underlined.

Govt's logistics index to boost exports

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, Mizoram and Delhi have been categorised as "exemplars" in the logistics performance ranking for 2025, according to a report by the Commerce and Industry Ministry on Wednesday.

The logistics index chart, released as part of LEADS (Logistics ease across different States) 2025 report, is an indicator of the efficiency of logistical services necessary for promoting exports and economic growth.

"Exemplars" represent the top-performing States and Union Territories (UTs) that demonstrate sustained excellence across policy, infrastructure, service delivery and regulatory dimensions in the logistics sector, as per the report. LEADS is the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade's (DPIIT) flagship national assessment of logistics performance across States and Union Territories and serves as an important benchmarking and reform tool for improving logistics efficiency across the country.

The report was released by Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

The report was released by Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal.

DETAILED SEGMENTS

According to the report, 11 States and UTs — Gujarat, Kerala, Maharashtra, Haryana, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Bihar, Tripura, Meghalaya, Jammu and Kashmir and Puducherry — have been categorised as "high performers".

Similarly, 18 States and UTs, including Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Goa, Karnataka, Punjab, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Assam, Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu, Chandigarh, Ladakh, and Lakshadweep, have been categorised as "accelerators".

The "growth seekers" includes West Bengal, Rajasthan, Sikkim and the Andaman & Nicobar Islands, which are at a foundational stage of logistics system development and institutional strengthening.

The report reflects the government's focus on integrated, data-driven logistics reforms under the PM GatiShakti National Master Plan and the National Logistics Policy.

Telangana to set up 600 EV charging stations in 3 years

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

The Telangana government plans to set up 600 electric vehicle (EV) charging and battery swapping stations over the next three years to reach 12,000 by 2035.

The Telangana Renewable Energy Development Corporation, the designated nodal agency for EV charging, has developed a single-window clearance mechanism for EV charging stations through which 1,244 approvals have been processed to date, according to Naveen Mittal, Special Chief Secretary, Telangana Energy Department.

4X GROWTH

The corporation has also invited expressions of interest (EoI) for the development of charging stations under the Centre's PM E-Drive initiative.

As of now, there are 1,063 operational EV charging stations in the State, including about 600 in Hyderabad.

Telangana is witnessing rapid growth in EV adoption. It had so far registered over 2.8 lakh EV vehicles, with 91,572 new registrations in FY 2025–26.

AP govt may mandate work from home

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

The Andhra Pradesh government is likely to make work-from-home mandatory in some categories of companies. This was hinted by Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu on Wednesday.

Speaking at the foundation stone laying ceremony of BISER Medical College & Skill University in Guntur district, the CM said the suggestions of the Prime Minister to adopt work from home and to cut use of fuel, among others, should be implemented by one and all.

"I have already suggested work from home even earlier. I am going to make an announcement in a day or two," Naidu said.

In new round of IAS reshuffle in Tamil Nadu, Health for Darez Ahamed

Our Bureau
Chennai

In another round of bureaucratic reshuffle announced by the new Tamil Nadu government, T Udhayachandran, IAS, formerly Additional Chief Secretary, Finance Department, is appointed Chairman and Managing Director/Additional Chief Secretary of the Tamil Nadu Industrial Investment Corporation Ltd (TIIC).

Darez Ahamed, IAS, who was the MD/CEO, Guidance TN, is now transferred and posted as Secretary, Health and Family Welfare Department, as per the order.

Ahamed succeeds P Senthilkumar, IAS, who is now Secretary to the Chief Minister. Kumar Jayant, IAS, who was the Additional Chief Secretary/Chairman and MD, TIIC, is appointed Additional Chief Secretary/Chairman and MD of Tamil Nadu Newsprint and Papers Ltd.

OTHER CHANGES

Mariam Pallavi Baldev, IAS, Special Secretary, Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce Department, is transferred and posted as Secretary, Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department.

Anu George, IAS, formerly Secretary-III to the Chief Minister, is now posted as Secretary, Animal Husbandry, Dairying, Department of Fisheries and Fishermen Welfare.

CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - MAY 14 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Eli Lilly's to roll out injection for Alzheimer's

New Delhi: Global pharmaceutical major Eli Lilly and Company will roll out in India this month its Lormalzi injection indicated for treatment of Alzheimer's disease with mild cognitive impairment or those in the mild dementia stage of disease, a senior company official said on Wednesday. The company is bringing the injectable therapy in India at a time when the number of people living with dementia, a vast majority of those with Alzheimer's disease, is expected to double by 2036 to over 19 million, Eli Lilly and Company (India) President and General Manager, Winselow Tucker said. According to Lilly, Lormalzi (donanemab, 350 mg/20 ml IV vial) is the first and only once monthly amyloid plaque targeting therapy. Amyloid plaque build-up in the brain is associated with Alzheimer's disease. PTI

FMCG giants cut advertising budgets due to slowing demand, rising costs

STRATEGIC RECALIBRATION. As firms look towards digital campaigns, pullback hits media, entertainment

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

PRUDENT SHIFT. Analysts feel subdued volume growth, particularly in rural markets, has prompted tighter control on discretionary spends like advertising

Faced with slowing demand and mounting cost pressures, leading FMCG companies are tightening their advertising budgets, marking the second consecutive quarter of cutbacks in marketing spends.

Companies such as Marico, Dabur, Godrej Consumer Products and Hindustan Unilever reported sequential declines in advertising and promotional expenditure of about 5 per cent, 10 per cent, 10 per cent and 0.8 per cent respectively during the quarter, reflecting a more cautious approach.

The pullback is also beginning to weigh on media and entertainment companies dependent on FMCG advertising. Jio Platforms, for instance, flagged pressure on television entertainment advertising revenues due to lower spending by FMCG advertisers. "FMCG ad spends in India have reduced over the last couple of quarters, driven more by strategic recalibration. Leading FMCG players have faced subdued volume growth, particularly in rural markets, prompting tighter control on discretionary spends like advertising," said Pramod Pawar, Quantitative Research—Vice President, Hansa Research Group.

For some companies, this means reintegrating their media mix for advertising.

MEDIA MIX

For example, HUL deployed a more integrated media mix using television and outdoor in rural and mass markets, while increasing targeted digital advertising.

"On social and digital platforms, we have built a strong, distinct influencer-led ecosystem. Today, we work with a network of 30,000 creators, which has almost doubled year-on-year," said Priya Nair, CEO and MD of HUL.

Further, the company is leveraging high-reach platforms such as sports and experimenting with AI-led campaigns to strengthen brands perception. Marico, too, is to direct 55 per cent of its core ad spends towards digital media.

Mohit Malhotra, Global CEO of Dabur, stressed on the impact of input cost pressures during their latest earnings call.

"When the market construct is shrinking, it's not very prudent to advertise and splurge with advertising so much... We have an endeavour of doing more advertising,"he said.

UPPING INVESTMENT

Meanwhile, Godrej fended off questions on marketing stating that while A&P expenses may seem lower, the spends are similar year-over-year. Britannia and Nestle India, which only show their ad spends in their annual reports, were among the few companies to increase advertising spends in the March ending quarter. While Nestle said increased ad spends by 50 per cent, Britannia said it is gradually "upping the investment in brand and advertising".

The pullback in FMCG advertising, which acts as a major contributor to the ad market, has had a broad but uneven impact on the ecosystem, said Pawar.

Commenting on the spending trends, Ajimon Francis, Managing Director at Brand Finance India, said, "It's completely short-term. Last time, there was enthusiasm from FMCG and durable brands, due to GST benefits. But now supply chain and raw materials are stuck."

Despite this, rebound spends are expected to shift toward targeted and performance-driven advertising, indicating a structural evolution in marketing investments, said Pawar.

Trump, Xi to discuss tariff reduction on $30 billion imports

Reuters

The US and China are expected to inch towards a managed trade mechanism for non-sensitive goods this week, with each side possibly identifying some $30 billion worth of goods on which they could reduce tariffs and sell to each other without crossing national security red lines.

The so-called 'Board of Trade' was first broached by US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer in March as a key 'deliverable' agreement for this week's summit between US President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping.

A key shift from past dialogues is clear — Washington is no longer demanding that Beijing change its state-directed, export-driven economic model to become more like the US consumer-driven, market-oriented model.

Instead, the effort is focused on numerical trading targets in non-strategic sectors while keeping in place broad tariffs and export controls on national security-sensitive technologies.

'ADAPTER' MECHANISM

Greer likened the mechanism to a plug 'adapter' that can help connect two incompatible economic systems.

US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Chinese Vice Premier He Lifeng met on Wednesday for three hours in Incheon, South Korea to lay final groundwork on economic proposals for Trump and Xi to discuss in Beijing. But the two top economic officials did not issue any statements.

Four people familiar with the Trump administration's objectives said they expected a $30 billion-for-$30 billion trade-barrier reduction framework arrangement. But it's unclear whether any specific goods will be defined by Trump and Xi.

Wendy Cutler, a former USTR negotiator who heads the Asia Society Policy Center in Washington, said both sides "are coalescing around" a $30 to $50 billion basket of goods for reduced tariffs or other barriers.

US-China two-way goods trade shrank by 29 per cent to $415 billion from $582 billion in 2024, with the US trade deficit falling nearly 32 per cent to $202 billion in 2025, its lowest in two decades, according to US Census Bureau data.

China has refrained from using the Board of Trade moniker, and said earlier the two sides had "agreed to explore the establishment of working mechanisms to expand economic and trade cooperation".

DISRUPTIVE TARIFFS

With the US aiming to increase sales of energy and agricultural products to China, Beijing's disruptive tariffs on these commodities are one possibility. China maintains a general extra 10 per cent tariff on all US imports, matching the current 10 per cent US temporary tariff on Chinese goods.

In addition to this and pre-existing "most favoured nation" tariffs, Beijing imposes retaliatory duties on imports from the US of 10 per cent on crude oil, 15 per cent on liquefied natural gas, 15 per cent on coal and up to 55 per cent on beef. The US maintains tariffs of 7.5 per cent on a raft of Chinese consumer products imposed in 2019 at the height of Trump's first-term trade war with China.

These include flat-panel television sets, flash memory devices, smart speakers, Bluetooth headphones, bed linens and multifunction printers and many types of footwear. The 10 per cent temporary global US tariff, set to expire in July, stacks on top of these duties.

The two sides are also expected to discuss the less-developed concept of a 'Board of Investment'.

Air India suspends 6 overseas services as ATF prices bite

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

GLOBAL REACH. The airline will continue operating more than 1,200 international flights every month across five continents

Tata Group-backed Air India has temporarily suspended flights on six international routes and reduced frequencies across several overseas destinations between June and August 2026 amid elevated aviation turbine fuel (ATF) prices.

Notably, *businessline* was the first to report that Air India was planning to temporarily suspend flights to some key long-haul international destinations such as Chicago after discussions between airlines and oil marketing companies on international ATF pricing relief failed to yield any material outcome.

Besides high jet fuel prices, prolonged airspace restrictions along with geopolitical disruptions have impacted the airline's international operations.

On Wednesday, Air India said the latest adjustments are aimed at improving network stability and minimising last-minute inconvenience to passengers during the peak travel season.

As part of the revised international schedule, Air India has suspended flights on six overseas routes through August. These include Delhi-Chicago, Delhi-Shanghai, Chennai-Singapore, Mumbai-Dhaka, Delhi-Malé and Mumbai-New York (JFK) services.

Furthermore, Delhi-Newark services will remain temporarily suspended during the period. Despite these reductions, the airline said it will continue operating more than 1,200 international flights every month across five continents.

FUNCTIONAL ROUTES

This includes 33 weekly flights to North America, 47 weekly services to Europe, 57 weekly flights to the UK, eight weekly services to Australia, 158 weekly flights across the Far East, Southeast Asia and SAARC regions, as well as seven weekly services to Mauritius.

Meanwhile, Delhi-San Francisco services have been reduced from 10 weekly flights to seven through August.

Similarly, Delhi-Toronto operations have been reduced from 10 weekly flights to five through July before returning to daily operations from August. Services between Delhi and Vancouver have also been reduced from seven weekly flights to five.

As per the airline, Mumbai-Newark operations will increase from three weekly services to daily flights.

However, Delhi-New York (JFK) will continue operating as a daily service.

In Europe, Air India has reduced frequencies on several routes, including Delhi-Paris, where services have been reduced from 14 weekly flights to seven. Delhi-Copenhagen operations have also been reduced from four weekly flights to three.

Accordingly, Delhi-Milan, Delhi-Vienna, Delhi-Zurich and Delhi-Rome services have each been reduced by one weekly flight.

In Australia, both Delhi-Melbourne and Delhi-Sydney operations have been reduced from seven weekly services to four.

FREQUENCY DROP

Additionally, Air India has undertaken significant frequency reductions across Southeast Asian and neighbouring markets.

Delhi-Singapore services have been reduced from 24 weekly flights to 14, while Mumbai-Singapore frequencies have been reduced from 14 weekly services to seven.

Likewise, Delhi-Bangkok flights will be reduced from 28 weekly services to 21 from July, while Mumbai-Bangkok operations will decline from 13 weekly services to seven.

Delhi-Kuala Lumpur services have been reduced from 10 weekly flights to five.

In addition, Delhi-Ho Chi Minh City services will reduce from seven weekly flights to four during July and August, while Delhi-Hanoi operations will decline from five weekly services to four during the same period.

SAARC REGION

In the SAARC region, Delhi-Kathmandu services will reduce from 42 weekly flights to 28 in June and further to 21 weekly services during July and August. Delhi-Dhaka operations have been reduced from seven weekly services to four, while Mumbai-Colombo flights will decline from seven weekly services to four.

Also, Delhi-Colombo services have been reduced from 14 weekly flights to 12.

The airline said passengers affected by the suspensions and frequency cuts will be assisted with alternative flight arrangements, complimentary date changes, or full refunds, wherever applicable.

Global AI, GenAI spend to cross $1 trillion by 2030: UnearthInsight

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Global spending on AI, generative AI and agentic AI solutions is projected to cross $1 trillion by 2030, as enterprises ramp up investments in vertical-specific AI applications and cloud infrastructure, according to a report by UnearthInsight.

The report, titled *World-wide Tech and AI/Gen AI Spend Analysis*, estimates that global GenAI spending will rise from $236 billion in 2026 to nearly $1.2 trillion by 2030, while the broader tech spend is expected to exceed $8.5 trillion in value over the same period.

Enterprise AI platforms are expected to account for 40 per cent of the market in 2026, while agentic AI is emerging as the fastest-growing segment with more than 80 per cent CAGR, the report said.

TECHNOLOGY MARKET

AI infrastructure remains the fastest-growing segment within the broader technology market, with spending on cloud services and AI-driven data centres expected to drive growth. The global tech industry is currently valued at around $6 trillion, with AI infrastructure accounting for roughly $1.6 trillion.

North America continues to dominate global AI spending, accounting for nearly 62 per cent of the market in FY26, or around $140-150 billion, followed by Europe, West Asia and APAC.

The report also highlighted a major shift in enterprise technology budgets, with AI increasingly taking wallet share away from traditional ERP, IT services and BPM providers.

In one case study of a global BFSI enterprise, AI and GenAI spending rose from 3 per cent of the company's technology budget in FY20 to 16 per cent in FY26.

Large enterprises continue to dominate spending, with companies generating over $10 billion in revenue accounting for around 42 per cent of the enterprise AI market.

'Appetite for international travel will continue despite geopolitical tensions'

Rohan Das
Chennai

The recent geopolitical tensions and resulting increase in airfares have caused some dent in international travel but the structural demand has remained, according to Hari Ganapathy, CEO and Co-founder Pickyourtrail, a Chennai-based travel solutions company.

Speaking to *businessline,* Ganapathy said that while domestic travel had grown massively in recent years, the infrastructure has not kept up.

This, combined with value-for-money appeal of overseas locations, makes international travel attractive, he added. "Our observation has been that massive disruptions generally occur when there are calamities and when people truly are not able to take that flight or reach locations. This is when cancellations happen. Otherwise, sentiments get impacted, but it is more temporary than being a trend," he said.

MINOR IMPACT

The issue has come into focus after Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged Indians to avoid spending on holidays abroad, citing concerns regarding the current account deficit. Ganapathy suggested that there was a slight dip in traffic on the day of the announcement but there were no largescale cancellations.

He added that the disruptions in West Asia, which having reduced traffic to the high demand locations like Europe and West Asia, had reignited interest towards eastern countries like Thailand, Japan and Vietnam.

Meanwhile, the company has also expanded beyond international travel to corporate travel management and a newer off-sites vertical.

It recently entered the domestic holiday market, and Ganpathy suggested that the segment now contributes "a few percentage points" to its topline.

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
AdityaBirlaL	101.66	101.42	101.77	103.48	101.00	695.38	175.00	87.91	-	-
AdityaInfote	2509.80	2502.10	2490.00	2530.00	2480.00	145.15	2575.00	1015.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	541.05	542.25	534.95	546.95	531.25	89.89	598.70	327.60	-	-
AdorWelding	1022.50	1030.80	1026.00	1044.90	1009.20	19.32	1260.00	848.00	-	-
Advait Ener	1908.60	2009.30	1908.60	2069.80	1905.00	69.52	2163.00	1351.00	-	-
Advent Hotel	159.19	150.71	160.00	160.28	148.00	216.59	345.05	121.35	-	-
Advenzymes [2]	369.80	367.95	369.80	379.35	363.50	394.24	419.80	251.90	30	368.80
Aegis Log [1]	658.80	652.15	661.00	668.80	646.75	555.81	946.50	576.00	36	652.55
Aegis VopakT	202.67	197.18	200.81	203.15	196.50	568.77	302.00	158.00	-	-
Aequs	180.23	191.50	177.00	198.24	177.00	1927.30	223.47	113.30	-	-
Aeroflex Ind	365.25	365.00	365.00	381.00	361.80	2787.63	458.70	158.00	-	-
AeroflexEnt	101.93	102.21	103.72	106.50	100.52	435.40	114.80	62.20	-	-
AeroflexNeu	90.42	86.91	90.90	95.01	86.50	110.04	125.37	63.21	-	-
Aether Ind	1155.70	1146.90	1156.20	1181.60	1144.10	109.96	1275.10	725.00	-	-
Afcons Infra	335.10	333.95	337.00	343.00	332.00	946.94	479.40	265.80	-	-
Affle [2]	1585.30	1533.50	1571.00	1577.40	1509.10	557.49	2186.80	1251.85	161	1530.65
Agarwal ind	416.65	417.55	418.50	439.45	413.75	52.63	1083.10	360.45	16	420.30
AGI Greenpac	587.35	593.45	586.45	601.25	584.10	146.64	1009.00	465.00	-	-
AGI Infra	365.80	369.20	367.80	377.90	367.20	844.45	1408.00	224.70	-	-
Ahluwalia [2]	811.45	811.05	800.15	814.50	799.45	43.04	1129.20	645.00	20	810.75
AIA Engg [2]	3749.80	3794.80	3770.00	3896.70	3767.00	16.51	4200.00	3000.60	27	3799.95
Ajanta Pha [2]	3091.70	3123.20	3129.90	3168.00	3096.30	209.86	3161.10	2335.00	41	3122.25
Ajax Engg	519.10	524.00	518.50	526.90	511.25	96.68	756.20	394.80	-	-
Ajmera [2]	117.01	121.69	117.55	125.10	115.15	591.44	221.23	98.10	22	121.90
Akums Drugs	528.40	540.35	528.40	550.00	528.40	150.25	622.95	409.30	-	-
Albert david	781.10	716.80	730.00	738.60	705.10	21.52	959.35	581.30	-	716.40
ALEM PHAR [2]	768.15	767.85	768.15	779.15	762.15	36.87	1107.80	635.30	30	768.40
Alembic Ltd [2]	90.43	89.93	89.00	90.64	88.80	215.99	125.70	70.64	17	89.98
Algoquant Fi	62.83	62.66	63.00	63.92	61.33	1232.91	71.01	47.80	-	-
Alicon [5]	729.50	693.65	706.05	717.90	680.00	53.87	1024.95	580.55	30	691.75
AlivusLife	1098.80	1080.80	1098.00	1110.00	1077.70	53.12	1225.10	819.00	-	-
Alkem labs [2]	5496.50	5462.50	5450.00	5553.00	5441.50	31.56	5933.00	4716.75	30	5455.00
ALKYL AMIN [2]	1592.60	1636.70	1598.70	1663.80	1590.50	87.40	2448.80	1212.35	46	1633.55
Allcargo Glo [2]	9.33	9.15	9.33	9.54	9.11	3818.40	16.18	7.10	-	9.16
ALLIED DIGIT [5]	123.87	126.01	123.88	129.38	123.11	257.75	226.50	86.50	52	126.50
AlliedBlend	567.45	561.65	563.55	575.00	553.00	195.41	696.80	332.85	-	-
AllTimePlas	244.66	241.23	246.92	249.55	239.56	54.84	334.90	186.00	-	-
Alok Ind	13.57	13.75	13.57	13.90	13.41	4309.28	23.50	11.11	-	-
Amagi Media	409.55	404.25	403.20	411.90	392.95	147.21	450.80	310.20	-	-
AmantaHealth	134.29	132.54	135.00	137.81	132.00	58.35	154.40	92.00	-	-
Amar.Raj.Enr	832.20	839.60	832.10	854.25	830.30	436.16	1094.00	670.00	-	-
Amber	8163.50	8300.50	8200.00	8435.00	8200.00	310.10	8970.00	5404.00	201	8300.65
AMBIKA COTTO	1524.30	1570.60	1532.60	1641.00	1520.10	52.29	1700.00	1100.60	14	1573.40
Ambuja Cem [2]	426.95	438.40	428.15	441.15	425.40	3622.41	625.00	394.00	28	438.50
AMIR CHAND JA	131.31	130.62	132.49	132.49	130.00	340.50	200.00	117.02	-	-
Amrutanjan [1]	557.60	585.05	565.00	598.00	545.55	92.93	789.95	490.00	26	587.10
Anand RathiW	3529.80	3550.10	3512.20	3561.80	3508.00	181.08	3735.00	1699.00	-	-
AnandRathiS	546.45	544.60	549.95	558.90	535.65	310.14	794.85	416.00	-	-
Anant Raj [2]	502.45	498.00	503.00	511.25	494.75	2553.74	744.10	403.00	60	498.45
Anant Raj Gl	132.26	130.49	132.25	134.00	130.10	275.07	206.10	109.10	-	-
Andhra Sug [2]	93.43	94.92	92.65	97.25	92.65	346.98	107.00	63.27	12	95.08
AngelOne	299.10	298.15	300.10	303.40	297.05	4043.71	3285.00	208.63	-	-
Anlon Health	13.39	13.41	13.39	13.80	13.25	1204.57	172.75	12.91	-	-
AntelopusSel	719.35	755.30	733.95	755.30	728.05	239.00	767.95	357.00	-	-
AnthemBiosci	799.05	809.85	811.00	817.90	801.45	326.67	873.50	579.15	-	-
Antony W Hdg	476.50	476.15	476.60	484.20	470.05	72.76	693.00	372.50	-	-
Anup Engg	1970.40	1979.20	1975.00	2030.00	1964.90	23.16	3369.90	1422.30	-	-
Anupam Ras.	1359.50	1375.00	1372.20	1396.00	1360.20	735.77	1415.00	885.00	-	-
Apar Ind	12459.00	12424.00	12459.00	12795.00	12360.00	59.81	12999.95	6306.40	51	12416.65
Apcotex Ind [2]	486.70	474.75	490.00	491.45	470.00	60.67	559.65	310.15	24	474.50
Apex	458.20	462.05	459.00	474.00	458.20	427.69	514.20	202.90	46	461.75
APL Apollo [2]	1881.20	1891.10	1869.10	1906.30	1865.20	242.54	2300.90	1493.00	96	1890.95
APOLLO [1]	294.85	304.35	295.00	308.90	294.50	6879.95	354.65	127.00	112	304.35
Apollo Hosp. [5]	8022.50	8004.50	7981.00	8112.00	7981.00	329.34	8143.25	6680.00	79	8001.20
Apollo Pipes	476.10	473.65	471.50	482.90	471.50	167.36	540.15	252.10	-	-
Apollo Tyres [1]	398.75	396.45	397.65	401.20	394.60	728.29	540.30	392.25	23	396.50
Aptech Ltd	99.63	98.75	101.00	102.99	98.01	318.62	172.60	69.50	27	99.10
Aptus V Hsg	274.15	269.40	273.70	280.00	268.65	1118.40	364.00	193.03	-	-
Aqylon Nexus	51.50	54.06	51.40	54.07	51.40	4054.95	2247.00	39.26	-	-
Archean Chem	597.50	560.00	594.00	602.10	550.85	261.13	727.60	483.00	-	-
Arfin IndiaL	99.77	96.02	102.33	104.16	92.58	3773.52	106.20	31.43	-	-
Arih.Capital	69.37	69.53	69.86	71.75	69.21	350.75	120.00	56.97	-	-
Arisinfra So	144.90	147.42	143.59	149.90	142.22	1224.20	208.50	82.18	-	-
Arkade Dev	117.94	119.06	117.94	120.00	117.14	156.38	213.69	92.62	-	-
Arman Fin	1770.90	1801.30	1770.00	1875.00	1770.00	45.90	1903.15	1256.10	44	1800.55
Arrow green	551.25	511.05	551.45	565.00	506.70	135.87	816.15	342.00	17	511.25
Artemis Med	270.68	275.26	270.00	277.00	263.81	248.59	297.50	203.35	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	431.90	429.55	433.00	438.75	425.20	308.88	579.05	366.60	-	429.15
Arvind Ltd	442.00	442.40	437.00	451.35	437.00	542.81	460.35	275.00	42	442.75
Asahi Ind. [1]	813.05	814.95	808.00	824.05	798.60	89.27	1072.95	689.80	69	817.05
Ashapura [2]	648.55	660.00	651.05	682.20	651.05	677.76	924.70	348.70	47	660.00
Ashiana ho [2]	349.85	365.95	350.15	374.40	345.05	191.19	389.00	250.60	30	364.75
ASHIKA CREDIT	380.75	375.95	391.00	391.00	353.70	88.20	410.95	353.70	-	-
Ashok Leyl [1]	155.95	153.21	155.95	157.36	152.76	25946.24	215.35	114.75	24	153.30
Ashoka [5]	127.23	128.06	126.55	130.29	126.40	989.93	230.70	101.00	18	128.05
Asian Energy	284.65	288.10	285.00	292.30	277.75	179.93	391.65	230.00	-	-
Asian granit	60.74	60.99	60.40	61.57	60.11	780.23	79.08	44.54	-	60.88
Asian Paints [1]	2505.50	2617.60	2554.00	2642.40	2554.00	3515.02	2985.50	2116.00	62	2617.85
ASK Auto.	425.60	433.90	422.85	434.95	421.00	61.41	578.50	375.30	-	-
Asso Alcohol	861.50	856.85	861.50	875.00	851.95	15.22	1277.00	660.65	-	-
ASTECFE	671.50	668.40	675.00	695.00	654.05	37.20	990.87	512.35	-	668.20
ASTERDM	730.35	735.75	730.00	754.40	728.00	542.05	769.95	519.80	116	736.90
Astra Micro [2]	1108.70	1111.20	1101.00	1137.90	1101.00	193.47	1195.65	835.90	72	1111.95
Astral Poly [1]	1527.60	1544.00	1521.40	1571.50	1503.00	425.28	1767.95	1262.75	72	1543.10
Astrazeneca [2]	8320.00	8376.00	8399.50	8439.50	8231.50	5.59	10653.05	7630.00	101	8372.20
Atal RealTe	28.28	28.75	28.50	28.87	28.05	2657.30	29.20	13.70	-	-
AtherEnergy	924.25	951.95	927.60	958.80	914.15	4592.13	989.40	298.20	-	-
Atlanta	40.10	39.12	38.65	41.00	38.36	97.52	73.39	29.41	-	-
Atlanta Elec	1814.80	1811.30	1850.00	1886.80	1756.00	198.13	1886.80	707.60	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	476.90	491.10	479.95	498.00	470.85	186.50	554.20	381.00	29	489.90
ATUL.	6851.50	6988.00	6886.50	7070.00	6862.00	39.65	7793.00	5563.00	35	6983.65
AU SFB	999.60	994.80	996.10	1010.60	988.70	1163.02	1079.65	681.35	28	994.30
Auri GrowInd	0.33	0.32	0.32	0.33	0.32	17378.72	1.00	0.20	-	-
Aurionpro So	762.20	765.45	766.00	794.50	757.50	367.33	1663.15	720.10	38	766.65
Aurob Pha [1]	1488.20	1497.50	1490.00	1509.80	1483.60	1821.81	1514.00	1017.00	41	1497.55
Authum Inv	478.35	478.50	470.00	485.75	470.00	216.53	3318.70	400.00	-	-
Auto Axles	1724.60	1695.80	1720.00	1747.80	1666.00	27.83	2125.95	1536.00	16	1694.90
AUTOMOTIVE S	491.30	497.60	508.70	508.70	487.05	26.04	656.50	377.10	27	498.80
Avalon Tech	1291.20	1292.60	1296.70	1342.90	1271.20	351.81	1427.80	777.30	-	-
Avantel	157.01	156.05	157.00	160.00	155.01	1781.83	215.00	108.65	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	1357.30	1344.50	1359.50	1383.70	1335.70	333.10	1592.30	614.05	32	1344.60
AvenueSai	14.05	14.10	14.10	14.34	13.99	14553.06	23.64	12.92	-	-
Avonmore Cap	11.06	11.47	11.16	11.85	11.16	224.35	24.19	10.00	-	-
Awfis Space	366.40	351.95	363.80	365.95	343.00	321.32	718.95	229.05	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1260.10	1255.70	1256.10	1275.30	1247.50	6045.41	1418.30	1041.30	16	1255.75
AXISCADES [5]	2017.10	2042.70	2020.00	2076.00	2014.90	94.46	2210.00	817.00	271	2043.35
Axita Cott.	8.00	7.94	8.09	8.09	7.89	273.14	13.42	7.85	-	-
Aye Finance	134.85	133.40	134.86	137.64	132.25	1013.45	161.50	132.55	-	133.40
Azad Engg	2123.70	2117.90	2120.00	2171.90	2109.00	320.90	2350.00	1360.00	-	-
B										
Baazar Style	391.15	408.30	393.05	427.00	386.25	3430.15	427.00	229.95	-	-
BAJAJ AUTO	10397.00	10262.00	10370.50	10455.00	10220.00	367.91	10784.85	7879.45	29	10258.10
Bajaj Cons [1]	547.95	525.25	544.90	556.00	522.05	1172.89	560.65	165.75	35	525.75
Bajaj Elect [2]	385.55	380.55	386.15	389.70	377.10	155.21	710.00	332.95	95	380.60
Bajaj Fin [1]	904.20	896.15	902.00	907.40	890.05	7422.95	1102.45	788.40	33	896.15
Bajaj Finser [1]	1744.80	1728.90	1748.90	1758.00	1726.00	666.28	2194.65	1598.15	193	1728.60
Bajaj HCare	292.80	295.30	300.00	301.45	294.40	124.75	608.90	273.25	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	19.05	18.73	19.05	19.29	18.61	8284.98	29.62	14.89	-	18.77
Bajaj Holdng	10097.00	10025.00	10060.00	10195.00	9958.00	32.34	14873.20	8597.50	39	10018.30
Bajaj HsgFin	83.87	85.22	83.70	85.50	83.18	3731.41	128.70	72.65	-	-
Bajel Proj.	167.71	170.03	166.50	173.75	166.22	215.26	263.90	135.10	-	-
Balaji Amine [2]	1339.50	1352.90	1339.50	1408.10	1339.50	112.32	1946.00	905.15	31	1352.15
Balaji Tele. [2]	113.13	106.45	114.95	115.48	104.65	559.51	139.99	70.00	21	106.11
Balkrish Ind [2]	2110.60	2105.10	2114.40	2151.80	2063.70	502.42	2800.20	2016.00	33	2104.95
BALMER LAWRIE	74.66	74.39	75.40	75.94	71.41	194.58	79.50	71.00	-	-
BalmerLawrie	189.83	195.44	188.00	196.90	188.00	268.23	238.00	148.35	14	195.25
BalramChini [1]	534.15	548.90	534.00	561.90	531.55	2254.00	627.00	393.40	27	549.30
Balu Forge	496.15	504.10	497.95	508.45	492.00	494.04	784.00	341.05	-	-
Banco Prod [2]	593.25	598.55	603.00	609.00	594.70	136.94	879.60	384.50	24	598.80
Bandhan Bk	196.07	194.88	196.09	200.73	194.50	11577.29	212.55	134.30	26	194.80
Bank of Maha	78.37	79.97	78.35	80.48	78.13	14533.43	85.93	50.10	9	79.98
Bansal Wire	298.55	300.95	299.00	306.65	298.85	67.25	434.30	222.50	-	-
BartronicInd	7.41	7.55	7.49	7.70	7.49	709.74	18.25	6.95	-	-
BASF India	3755.90	3860.50	3770.00	3985.50	3770.00	48.24	5418.20	2906.90	43	3860.35
Bata India [5]	699.65	701.30	699.00	709.80	696.05	55.80	1300.05	605.55	48	702.10
Bayer Crop	4450.70	4417.90	4443.00	4482.40	4402.00	15.69	6539.95	4276.85	30	4415.60
BCL Ind.	34.24	34.05	34.50	34.94	33.94	478.16	49.30	25.53	-	-
BDL [5]	1334.20	1360.30	1330.00	1376.70	1330.00	1009.98	2096.00	1090.00	86	1360.30
Belrise Inds	205.30	211.07	207.00	213.32	206.77	2643.49	228.80	89.15	-	-
BEML [5]	1792.90	1848.80	1802.50	1866.90	1800.00	289.26	2437.43	1361.10	60	1847.05
BergerPaints [1]	488.10	507.70	505.00	533.35	500.00	9314.43	604.60	391.50	52	507.15
Best Agroli	17.79	17.79	17.79	18.48	17.60	369.02	533.70	12.30	-	-
Beta Drugs	1361.60	1416.80	1338.00	1465.00	1338.00	27.93	2000.00	990.10	-	-
BF UTILI [5]	546.60	536.45	548.90	558.00	533.35	40.55	899.00	369.00	252	535.40
BFLYGANDHI	708.60	697.70	740.00	757.90	692.00	1504.76	844.00	566.95	27	697.25
Bhandari H [1]	3.64	3.73	3.73	3.86	3.50	663.01	5.80	2.02	-	3.73
BHANSALI E [1]	94.57	93.13	94.05	95.21	92.52	306.78	123.60	75.52	13	93.26
BHARAT BIJ [5]	2575.70	2507.40	2557.00	2609.90	2492.50	76.78	3472.55	2009.45	24	2507.00
Bharat Elect [1]	416.50	428.25	416.60	432.00	415.75	13230.83	473.25	322.85	53	428.80
Bharat Forge [2]	1913.00	1945.90	1912.90	1986.90	1911.80	1225.14	2043.90	1100.50	80	1944.95
Bharat Ras [5]	1388.20	1393.10	1388.20	1417.90	1381.60	7.13	3030.25	1202.05	16	1391.95
Bharat Wire	232.67	246.09	231.50	248.76	228.79	807.56	262.20	149.15	22	246.15
BharatCoking	33.13	33.81	33.16	34.08	32.94	12694.17	45.09	29.74	-	-
BharatSeats	188.46	188.66	190.00	196.26	187.66	185.49	239.45	96.55	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1756.80	1789.20	1740.50	1798.00	1740.50	9825.41	2174.70	1745.00	50	1788.10
Bharti Hexa	1464.80	1489.50	1477.50	1494.40	1465.90	67.28	2052.90	1439.30	-	-
BHEL [2]	391.75	403.85	392.50	407.75	392.50	21916.00	408.90	205.20	89	403.80
Bigbloc [2]	56.64	58.48	56.65	60.00	56.65	178.76	80.60	38.00	-	58.38
Bikaji Fds	658.20	648.35	662.50	665.65	643.10	85.78	818.70	592.55	-	-
Billionbrain	183.09	188.41	185.00	194.61	184.56	102264.54	227.20	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	402.45	417.60	403.05	420.25	402.85	11445.15	424.95	327.75	284	417.75
BIRLA CORPN.	1053.55	1030.25	1056.50	1065.00	1015.40	150.15	1537.15	773.90	27	1033.05
Birlanu Ltd	1559.10	1455.50	1524.00	1549.30	1434.90	19.68	2428.30	1190.10	-	-
Birlasoft	331.60	318.70	331.60	334.75	317.45	2312.91	474.00	317.45	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	259.95	261.65	260.70	264.30	258.10	14028.63	325.55	226.60	7	261.75
Bk of India	140.14	140.59	140.20	142.40	138.65	7974.43	178.45	109.00	6	140.65
BL kashyap [1]	55.25	54.27	54.50	55.20	53.71	661.47	80.07	40.79	-	54.25
Black Box	829.15	824.90	835.00	844.00	807.90	1717.19	872.55	400.55	-	-
Bliss GVS [1]	273.80	279.55	274.95	285.00	268.55	3575.85	285.00	114.45	30	279.95
BLS [1]	270.80	266.65	271.45	273.95	265.10	745.30	421.90	218.45	-	267.10
BLS e-Svc	190.23	189.43	190.00	193.42	187.68	112.18	232.50	124.30	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	444.80	445.65	456.00	461.70	443.50	256.00	1027.80	325.00	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1630.60	1630.60	1630.60	1662.90	1623.00	415.50	2049.95	1450.00	81	1628.55
BlueDart Exp	5167.50	5102.00	5166.00	5167.00	5051.00	14.95	7222.35	4695.00	44	5107.10
BluestoneJew	474.20	483.90	469.55	490.40	468.00	337.12	793.00	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	68.79	66.60	69.75	69.93	65.65	258.04	100.88	43.98	-	-
Bodal Chem [2]	69.37	66.98	68.16	69.95	66.53	366.17	81.50	41.25	31	67.16
Bom Dyeing [2]	120.55	123.60	120.50	125.40	118.60	978.49	196.50	92.10	92	123.55
BombayBur [2]	1465.60	1494.10	1475.20	1520.00	1475.20	58.51	2156.10	1301.00	172	1497.25
BoranaWeaves	332.10	328.85	329.00	341.40	325.00	71.28	420.00	211.00	-	-
Borosil	236.68	235.82	238.00	245.35	234.50	135.23	397.95	213.73	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	548.10	540.90	559.90	565.65	538.25	1382.22	721.00	374.40	-	-
Bosch Home	1436.30	1413.40	1425.00	1450.00	1379.00	19.29	1849.00	1021.30	-	-
BOSCH	36510.00	36315.00	36510.00	36880.00	36235.00	19.08	41894.30	28650.05	46	36318.70
BPCL	287.85	297.10	288.55	299.00	288.55	12403.06	391.85	266.55	5	297.30
BrainbeesSol	235.48	236.04	235.00	237.03	233.70	647.15	438.70	207.05	-	-
Brigade	718.80	694.95	718.00	729.70	688.00	348.06	1332.35	615.00	60	695.35
BrigadeHotel	61.20	60.82	62.00	62.98	60.00	93.13	91.77	54.36	-	-
Britannia [1]	5334.00	5336.00	5345.00	5383.50	5279.50	405.23	6336.95	5280.00	50	5336.50
BSE Ltd	3851.90	3888.80	3852.50	3918.00	3847.20	3250.45	7588.00	2021.50	-	-
C										
Camlin Fine [1]	119.44	118.94	120.40	122.64	118.10	861.11	334.70	96.30	-	118.85
Campus Act.	243.61	239.88	242.55	245.45	237.61	229.28	304.40	215.20	-	-
CAMS	784.65	784.95	780.00	797.00	776.80	1167.97	4375.00	611.40	-	-
Canara Bank [2]	130.01	129.26	130.46	131.20	127.90	21722.40	162.90	100.86	6	129.25
Canara HSBCL	136.31	136.78	136.69	137.88	134.58	456.68	159.00	106.00	-	-
Canara RobAM	244.20	240.60	244.20	246.50	239.00	286.06	353.40	214.20	-	-
Canfin Hom [2]	831.85	827.40	836.35	839.35	820.05	182.87	970.00	709.05	10	827.25
Cantabil [2]	218.77	224.78	219.00	226.55	219.00	78.33	321.50	216.15	21	225.15
CAPACITE	236.65	237.00	234.20	243.25	231.25	200.66	372.25	178.90	11	236.85
CapillaryTec	533.30	524.75	530.20	530.20	519.95	36.99	798.95	464.25	-	-
Capital SFB	276.75	281.70	278.15	284.00	276.30	45.97	330.65	206.55	-	-
CAPLIN PO [2]	1815.00	1841.80	1840.00	1867.00	1815.20	65.26	2396.95	1502.45	39	1843.00
Carborund [1]	1008.65	1033.30	1008.00	1050.00	1000.00	127.72	1044.00	734.65	55	1029.60
Care Rating	1581.00	1608.20	1581.50	1629.80	1565.00	32.78	1964.80	1360.00	29	1606.60
Carraro Ind	580.45	584.15	580.60	594.70	580.00	74.26	667.55	401.05	-	-
Cartrade Tch	1892.20	1888.40	1892.10	1973.90	1878.00	540.87	3290.50	1485.00	-	-

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Rainbow Ch.	1263.20	1304.40	1269.90	1316.00	1269.90	211.30	1645.70	1084.00	-	-
RAJ.SPG.	160.31	159.24	161.99	162.55	157.05	156.66	191.00	119.90	12	159.05
Rajoo Engine	57.21	56.90	56.45	58.48	56.45	251.65	145.88	46.00	-	-
Rajputa Sta	138.41	138.99	137.16	141.95	137.16	379.79	144.90	101.70	-	-
Rajratan Glo	406.05	416.10	411.60	419.85	405.00	41.25	540.00	305.55	-	-
Rallis India [1]	266.85	266.15	269.00	271.95	264.40	349.47	385.60	216.10	26	266.35
Ram Ratna Wr	423.35	420.40	419.80	435.20	411.00	146.80	785.95	268.00	-	-
Rama Stl [1]	5.35	5.28	5.35	5.39	5.15	10775.53	14.92	3.44	-	5.29
Ramco Systm	381.80	379.80	380.25	389.35	377.35	37.26	681.80	342.50	64	381.55
Ramco Cem [1]	943.25	929.85	943.25	948.40	927.05	781.60	1214.00	860.20	116	930.35
Ramco Inds. [1]	282.20	280.00	282.20	284.85	279.00	32.15	398.05	230.70	25	279.20
RAMKY INFRA	465.90	461.70	468.95	475.70	460.15	51.54	706.50	420.05	17	461.50
Rane Holdi	1109.00	1257.00	1100.70	1321.00	1100.70	375.14	1835.00	982.05	25	1248.30
RANE MADRAS	892.15	906.50	904.95	928.85	885.10	57.01	1054.55	612.50	22	903.60
Rashi Perip.	518.10	512.75	520.95	534.85	507.10	206.37	547.05	275.60	-	-
Rashtr.chem.	123.07	124.66	123.10	125.65	121.63	988.53	166.55	106.10	22	124.75
RatanindiaEn	34.31	34.25	34.88	34.99	34.00	3153.88	69.70	24.40	-	-
Rategain Tr.	618.95	626.10	618.95	633.95	615.20	350.28	741.60	417.60	-	-
Ratnamn M [2]	2859.80	2830.40	2840.00	2899.80	2816.60	59.89	3342.35	1900.05	34	2832.00
Ratnaveer Pr	167.32	178.36	172.00	183.98	171.00	6062.31	193.39	129.98	-	-
Ravindra Enr	127.85	127.60	128.48	131.00	126.52	118.22	191.77	100.00	-	-
Raymond	479.70	468.65	478.00	481.55	466.10	393.39	782.00	320.40	-	469.00
Raymond Life	780.05	804.55	780.05	832.00	780.00	493.02	1411.90	725.20	-	-
RaymondReal	567.20	574.15	565.00	587.00	551.55	1029.21	1050.00	349.00	-	-
RBLBank	325.25	325.75	325.25	332.40	324.90	2581.64	349.75	203.35	24	325.80
RBZ Jeweller	133.80	130.97	131.00	134.93	126.10	141.41	179.00	100.00	-	-
RECLTD	344.35	346.55	345.45	351.10	342.00	4765.26	428.55	304.10	6	346.65
Redington [2]	210.69	210.05	211.91	214.49	209.50	1690.46	334.90	191.25	14	210.15
Redtape	135.00	136.00	135.00	136.81	131.83	403.76	163.50	107.53	-	-
Refex Refrig [2]	255.45	255.60	256.00	259.05	253.25	481.39	534.00	188.00	17	255.30
Relax Foot [1]	289.40	286.65	290.00	290.00	283.10	95.61	531.45	236.55	42	286.80
Reli IndInf	766.90	759.50	760.90	769.80	755.10	86.51	1047.20	620.50	111	759.10
ReliableData	116.96	129.44	118.00	132.43	118.00	161.75	175.00	65.00	-	-
Reliance	1364.00	1358.80	1361.40	1372.40	1352.40	13797.99	1611.20	1290.00	42	1359.20
Religare ent	222.30	227.44	230.00	233.10	225.00	2686.19	314.15	197.00	-	227.50
Renaiss.Glo	108.35	109.12	106.50	112.05	106.50	618.69	147.90	85.00	-	-
REPCO HOME	392.30	390.85	391.05	398.95	383.90	89.43	463.60	333.90	6	390.55
RestaurBrand	66.38	66.67	66.10	67.25	66.10	2433.92	89.50	57.15	-	-
Rhetan TMT L	26.17	26.68	26.21	27.03	26.21	1566.53	31.46	20.32	-	-
RHI Magnesit	386.35	392.25	389.75	393.70	384.95	61.50	537.70	323.05	-	-
Rico Auto [1]	114.70	115.72	115.00	117.67	114.70	783.69	142.30	64.45	45	115.55
Rishabh Ins	486.25	487.30	486.25	511.80	482.30	112.90	548.80	244.20	-	-
Ritco Logi.	234.88	271.77	234.00	279.88	231.71	1422.53	317.10	167.10	-	-
RITES	211.80	212.69	211.00	215.79	211.00	364.34	316.15	175.10	26	212.60
RK Forgings [2]	582.00	581.90	586.00	593.20	580.05	299.71	691.90	460.15	113	581.90
RMDrip&Spr	19.01	18.31	19.20	19.43	18.25	637.29	807.45	17.11	-	-
Rolex Rings	145.65	148.11	145.65	150.80	145.61	1013.17	1660.00	99.79	-	-
Rossari Bio	507.25	533.25	509.90	539.40	508.00	297.26	766.00	375.00	-	-
Rossell Tech	827.95	875.80	855.00	919.80	831.00	304.07	1061.90	318.65	-	-
Roto Pumps	56.21	57.82	55.50	59.67	55.50	549.31	310.25	47.50	-	-
Route Mobile	509.65	519.65	509.20	531.50	503.20	279.24	1158.00	410.70	-	-
RPG lifesc [8]	2311.10	2333.20	2301.60	2383.90	2301.60	8.45	2715.90	1731.25	34	2327.75
RPOWER	27.30	27.30	27.30	27.90	27.20	39446.56	76.49	20.23	-	27.33
RPSG Vent.	998.65	962.95	991.05	1021.00	960.00	139.39	1179.00	551.90	-	-
RR Kabel	1938.80	1957.30	1940.00	1982.80	1923.50	481.54	1996.90	1165.00	-	-
RSystems Int [1]	294.75	291.20	296.10	303.75	288.70	463.74	496.95	230.15	13	291.05
RTNPOWER	9.30	9.36	9.27	9.47	9.25	12871.38	16.94	7.50	-	9.37
Rubicon Rese	927.90	948.35	930.65	959.20	927.90	82.65	1013.40	570.75	-	-
RUPA & CO [1]	142.33	140.72	144.60	144.60	139.77	96.25	233.45	109.50	16	140.90
RVNL	283.30	285.00	283.70	291.35	283.70	6906.72	447.80	248.00	-	-

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
S&W Solar	202.49	203.57	202.50	206.00	201.76	1079.19	348.90	148.00	-	-
SaatvikGreen	445.75	456.10	450.80	463.50	449.10	60.80	567.00	328.00	-	-
Safari Ind	1478.80	1488.00	1481.00	1505.00	1451.40	141.35	2507.10	1363.10	-	-
Sagar Cemnt [2]	179.29	177.96	179.29	182.90	176.79	76.91	300.00	149.00	-	178.00
Sagility Ind	43.09	43.10	43.70	44.30	41.95	44703.07	57.89	35.83	-	-
Sai Life Sci	1083.80	1085.40	1093.10	1108.90	1065.40	494.01	1139.40	707.00	-	-
SAI PARENTE	473.25	476.90	474.00	482.80	472.05	66.49	526.30	400.00	-	-
Sai Silks	108.34	115.09	110.00	120.49	110.00	3966.97	223.03	89.76	-	-
Sakar Health	569.65	599.45	572.50	627.85	571.10	482.03	661.95	300.00	-	-
SAKSOFT [1]	141.12	140.10	139.00	143.15	139.00	150.78	254.15	108.00	25	140.20
SALASAR [1]	7.14	7.11	7.15	7.35	7.03	4273.74	11.53	5.60	-	7.11
Salzer Elec	715.00	716.80	711.80	734.70	702.05	95.08	1126.95	488.65	24	716.00
SambhvSteel	113.82	113.99	114.00	116.85	112.51	2618.61	149.40	81.42	-	-
Samhi Hotels	153.88	150.64	151.00	153.76	149.74	674.53	254.50	127.00	-	-
Samman Cap.	139.41	139.99	140.38	142.50	139.03	13482.69	192.95	114.10	-	-
Samvard.Moth	124.26	126.32	124.00	127.53	123.83	15031.56	162.25	89.70	-	-
Sandhar	505.95	514.05	507.00	528.00	505.20	140.79	600.10	386.25	18	513.50
Sandur Mang.	223.62	229.38	223.62	234.50	223.62	2005.19	557.75	156.30	-	-
Sangam India	492.35	514.40	499.00	521.00	491.60	23.67	575.50	340.90	28	513.05
Sanghvi Mo [1]	312.35	314.60	315.00	318.70	306.05	132.66	412.90	221.00	19	316.45
Sanofi ind	3235.80	3251.40	3235.80	3287.60	3235.80	20.28	6399.95	3151.05	23	3247.45
Sansera Engg	2386.90	2391.90	2360.00	2469.20	2350.00	98.21	2672.50	1125.10	-	-
Sanstar	98.72	99.00	98.60	100.99	97.67	231.59	107.29	74.30	-	-
Sapphire Fd	172.80	176.27	172.60	178.62	169.76	732.07	368.00	139.91	-	-
Sarda EnMin [1]	562.15	570.90	563.40	583.95	558.10	736.13	639.95	420.05	22	570.45
Saregama (I) [1]	332.80	335.05	335.30	339.15	328.10	218.99	603.00	305.65	32	335.00
SARLA PER F [1]	92.96	96.93	93.90	98.00	92.80	429.78	127.90	65.01	10	97.34
SASKEN COMM	1840.50	1724.90	1800.00	1849.90	1701.20	1177.14	1955.30	993.05	38	1726.05
Satia Ind.	67.16	66.68	67.16	67.91	66.21	124.03	97.50	50.80	-	-
SATIN	225.08	225.45	225.01	234.23	221.20	3007.46	246.00	133.50	8	225.50
SBC Exports	34.61	34.13	34.65	34.98	33.81	13472.51	35.10	13.11	-	-
SBFC Fin.	92.76	91.63	93.24	94.14	90.74	1042.68	123.00	79.60	-	-
SBI Cards	625.10	634.15	625.10	640.65	622.25	1997.26	1027.25	615.50	-	-
SBILIFE	1833.90	1837.50	1820.00	1851.40	1818.20	853.30	2132.90	1724.00	75	1837.65
SchlossBanga	411.20	413.65	410.60	416.45	406.50	109.67	474.40	382.50	-	-
ScodaTubes	151.54	151.14	151.75	154.78	148.53	174.74	230.85	110.00	-	-
SE INVESTM [1]	44.95	44.69	45.23	45.93	44.21	5794.52	51.10	29.40	17	44.72
SEDEMAC MECH	1974.40	2012.60	1974.40	2132.00	1974.40	277.55	2132.00	1413.10	-	-
Senco Gold	312.75	325.50	303.65	329.00	302.05	3997.95	404.85	276.00	-	-
Senores Phar	932.90	973.75	929.80	991.00	929.80	372.48	991.00	491.00	-	-
SEPC	7.32	7.43	7.32	7.58	7.25	8186.59	16.17	4.65	-	-
Servote.Pwr	89.60	94.57	90.55	95.95	89.00	2445.45	168.50	57.51	-	-
Sesha.paper [2]	254.15	238.65	252.90	255.30	237.00	70.46	323.80	213.00	22	238.35
Seshaasai Te	255.92	255.01	255.20	261.94	252.40	61.66	437.45	209.11	-	-
SFL [5]	556.65	540.40	556.65	561.20	534.80	149.27	768.90	460.75	81	539.30
SG Mart L	594.80	596.45	603.95	610.00	590.00	330.71	618.00	313.10	-	-
SGFinserveLt	575.60	574.10	575.00	594.50	571.05	237.51	650.00	323.00	-	-
Sh Renu Sug [1]	25.12	24.86	25.10	25.34	24.64	7691.01	35.84	22.86	-	24.88
Shadowfax Te	163.71	168.42	165.00	169.50	161.21	1527.66	177.01	98.55	-	-
Shaily Eng	2693.60	2744.00	2695.00	2751.30	2665.00	156.54	2799.90	1535.90	-	-
SHAKTI PUMPS	528.15	530.70	532.40	537.40	524.55	760.85	1047.00	457.00	27	530.20
SHARDA MO [2]	868.15	854.80	868.80	879.15	848.70	21.87	1258.00	701.85	15	855.95
ShareInd Sec	138.02	139.08	138.02	140.50	136.61	252.22	211.00	115.36	-	-
ShDigvijCem	71.81	72.99	72.47	74.56	71.81	101.24	107.70	53.90	-	-
Shilchar Tec	4182.00	4179.00	4175.00	4242.00	4150.00	25.91	5399.00	2852.50	-	-
SHILPA MED [1]	438.65	438.85	439.00	452.50	435.05	505.12	501.60	260.00	78	438.55
Shipping Cor	325.35	331.75	327.00	342.90	326.60	9204.15	368.50	171.55	12	331.70
Shipping Cor	48.29	49.53	48.55	50.20	48.42	820.97	60.34	34.30	-	-
Shivalik Bi	583.10	573.75	575.00	598.80	565.60	173.61	655.40	368.60	-	-
Shivalik Ras	257.75	255.85	255.85	264.25	253.20	39.40	651.00	206.75	-	-
SHK	144.49	141.46	144.75	148.37	141.00	337.24	275.20	111.70	86	141.10
SHOPPER ST [5]	331.50	333.25	330.00	339.40	326.00	66.97	588.50	267.00	-	333.45
Shree Cement	24860.00	24995.00	24705.00	25285.00	24705.00	13.84	32508.20	22575.00	53	24994.80
ShreejiShipp	412.10	425.05	412.00	431.00	412.00	1131.10	433.10	222.00	-	-
SHREEPUSHK	368.25	363.20	368.25	374.05	362.00	65.41	476.60	244.65	27	364.80
Shringar Hou	209.57	205.58	208.54	212.08	201.27	1618.58	266.50	166.00	-	-
Shriram Fin	930.45	920.55	925.20	938.40	915.00	10747.95	1108.00	566.50	-	-
Shriram Pist	3489.60	3400.70	3450.00	3519.00	3382.20	34.45	3764.90	2222.20	-	-
Shriram Prop	85.66	85.62	85.97	88.68	83.15	1334.41	105.58	60.57	-	-
ShyamMetalic	843.65	865.20	844.00	883.10	844.00	817.47	1001.00	746.00	-	-
Siemens Ener	3055.60	3112.60	3050.50	3132.90	3045.00	281.12	3625.00	2115.00	-	-
Siemens Ltd. [2]	3574.40	3532.20	3574.40	3628.50	3518.20	396.81	3928.00	2827.00	82	3532.35
Sigma Solve	42.98	43.12	42.00	44.00	42.00	69.28	655.00	35.46	-	-
SignatureGlo	858.95	896.65	860.50	904.00	852.90	383.13	1309.50	705.20	-	-
SIKA INTERPLAN	932.00	956.20	935.00	980.00	935.00	25.05	1199.80	927.00	-	-
Silgo Retail	76.09	72.52	74.00	76.00	64.20	1621.65	87.50	49.02	-	-
Silver Tou.	147.68	147.77	140.30	151.96	140.30	721.91	1690.20	100.50	-	-
Sirca Paint	427.05	422.75	428.00	428.90	418.30	769.49	539.00	258.80	-	-
SIS [5]	373.45	373.95	373.45	380.00	371.00	44.45	419.60	257.40	15	375.20
Siyaram Silk [2]	560.75	558.70	563.00	570.00	555.45	39.05	849.65	434.15	12	559.60
SJS Enter.	1968.60	1935.10	1950.00	1999.30	1932.00	77.85	2033.90	1023.80	-	-
SJVN	74.25	75.70	74.00	76.35	73.90	2753.58	107.50	63.06	33	75.70
SKF Ind(Ind)	2038.20	2199.40	2099.00	2220.00	1994.10	60.36	2766.00	1994.10	-	-
SKF INDIA	1669.70	1692.80	1670.00	1721.00	1649.00	41.31	2395.85	1404.00	23	1693.55
SKIPPER [1]	436.05	451.55	436.95	467.40	436.95	882.73	588.30	300.00	24	451.90
SKM Egg pro [5]	167.98	175.96	168.00	180.00	165.79	117.50	232.35	96.25	12	175.60
Sky Gold	475.80	439.70	462.00	470.00	421.65	5590.79	549.90	246.05	-	-
SMARTLINK [2]	148.49	178.18	146.01	178.18	145.15	139.01	181.80	102.00	-	181.80
SmartworksCo	428.40	444.75	438.95	450.95	422.25	63.50	619.00	361.50	-	-
SMC Glo.Sec.	61.08	62.10	61.50	62.90	60.40	186.58	160.00	54.44	-	-
SML Mahindra	3614.20	3626.00	3624.70	3673.00	3614.20	26.40	5348.00	1550.00	-	-
SMS Pharma [1]	402.00	404.05	404.30	413.30	398.15	200.19	446.50	208.20	43	403.15
Snowman Log	38.44	38.76	38.50	39.89	38.34	177.00	64.44	30.55	-	38.77
Sobha Devel	1394.30	1385.40	1402.00	1408.00	1373.30	98.18	1732.45	1131.10	49	1382.75
Solar Indus [2]	15585.00	15787.00	15550.00	15989.00	15545.00	81.89	17805.00	11641.10	133	15776.00
Solara Acti.	508.60	503.70	509.10	519.50	501.00	58.83	734.40	422.00	-	-
SolarWorldEn	217.53	222.22	218.10	223.77	211.82	173.94	388.50	139.19	-	-
Solectron	2936.00	3021.50	2900.00	3090.00	2900.00	49.44	3200.00	1826.00	53	3025.80
Solex Energy	1251.20	1243.40	1233.20	1278.20	1233.20	24.87	1985.00	795.45	-	-
SOM DISTIL [2]	85.69	88.39	85.69	90.43	85.28	739.70	173.15	61.86	24	88.35
Somany Cer [2]	442.30	452.45	442.05	459.20	434.55	38.11	623.00	332.00	21	453.15
Sona BLW Pr.	584.10	591.35	584.00	597.55	578.00	3189.07	614.00	402.30	-	-
SONA KOYO [1]	135.59	136.82	135.20	139.30	135.20	129.81	189.00	117.00	50	137.00
Sonata Soft. [1]	273.15	267.30	276.70	277.95	265.05	1675.66	453.05	208.50	25	267.85
SOTL [2]	419.95	417.85	419.00	428.35	414.00	39.05	474.15	287.00	15	419.20
SOUTH EAST	1480.10	1511.30	1472.00	1533.90	1467.10	34.08	1647.65	753.00	18	1509.65
South Ind.bk [1]	38.21	38.48	39.00	39.34	38.35	13597.76	46.85	25.26	7	38.47
South.petro.	65.62	67.68	65.68	67.98	65.62	342.86	128.10	55.00	8	67.51
SouthwestPin	220.83	234.37	221.92	238.65	220.69	490.60	264.00	117.22	-	-
SPAL	811.70	805.20	811.00	820.00	804.00	31.47	990.00	585.00	22	805.00
Spandana Sph	258.91	265.54	258.91	268.79	257.10	253.89	321.60	181.10	-	-
Spectrum Ele	1417.80	1400.30	1355.50	1423.50	1355.50	46.49	1800.00	1050.00	-	-
SPMLINFRA [2]	200.35	205.18	199.00	207.14	199.00	187.91	321.70	152.25	29	205.85
Sprtking Ind	147.05	151.01	146.32	151.92	146.32	164.63	160.30	78.17	-	-
Srf Ltd.	2721.20	2695.20	2738.90	2756.30	2688.80	642.86	3319.00	2313.75	45	2694.10
SriLotusDev	142.42	141.91	140.90	148.30	136.95	1180.36	218.49	102.20	-	-
SRM Contrac.	477.30	487.05	476.90	500.00	453.20	149.14	649.95	307.90	-	-
SSLT [1]	305.05	323.35	311.95	325.50	308.80	72680.55	325.50	157.10	70	323.10
ST.STR.WH [1]	205.66	209.57	205.00	211.92	205.00	181.35	279.60	169.00	16	209.65
Stallion Ind	147.29	139.96	148.55	152.00	132.25	3123.25	423.80	66.30	-	-
Standard Eng	132.36	137.01	132.00	138.90	131.10	139.56	203.95	104.56	-	-
StanleyLife	155.75	158.50	155.75	162.99	151.20	87.98	377.50	123.00	-	-
Star Health	511.20	507.35	512.00	517.30	503.75	285.69	586.25	367.35	-	-
STARCEME [1]	219.99	216.80	219.99	221.86	216.04	215.80	308.10	196.75	86	216.60
State Bank [1]	974.60	970.10	978.00	981.20	961.20	17584.58	1234.80	779.40	12	970.45
Steel Auth.	176.09	201.31	176.31	202.35	176.31	173466.90	202.15	115.70	28	201.60
Steel Exch.	10.01	10.33	9.97	10.70	8.01	4007.60	11.55	7.00	-	-
Steelcast	278.60	298.45	276.05	301.20	276.05	122.77	1279.00	176.02	-	-
STERL.TOO [2]	233.00	238.40	234.50	243.22	231.35	48.56	393.20	156.60	18	238.95
Sterlite Tch	398.30	405.15	398.30	414.00	396.10	6308.63	414.40	63.46	-	-
STL Networks	25.44	25.99	25.45	26.50	25.01	5828.43	35.40	15.75	-	-
Stove Kraft	563.45	541.60	587.45	587.45	539.00	691.33	813.95	447.05	-	-
STRIDES	1151.80	1146.40	1150.80	1180.80	1131.50	156.24	1231.45	655.00	58	1146.20
Studds Acces	456.20	443.85	455.00	455.00	442.00	35.59	600.00	441.05	-	-
Stylam Ind.	2460.60	2512.90	2431.40	2597.60	2431.40	49.26	2740.00	1593.70	-	-
Styrenix Per	2224.40	2215.40	2224.40	2250.00	2202.20	11.56	3498.00	1780.00	-	-
SUBROS. [2]	750.70	756.10	740.00	767.45	740.00	26.05	1212.40	619.25	29	757.30
SUDARSH.C [2]	874.70	878.55	863.40	898.00	863.40	116.20	1604.00	726.60	31	876.45
Sudeep Phar	631.00	634.35	634.00	650.45	624.70	46.82	795.00	524.05	-	-
Sula Vine	165.62	164.76	165.64	167.75	163.71	304.34	335.90	138.60	-	-
Sumito.Chem	444.85	455.55	442.65	467.30	442.65	485.47	665.00	362.60	-	-
Sun Pharma. [1]	1845.70	1824.80	1845.70	1860.00	1820.00	1972.37	1885.65	1547.25	100	1824.40
SUN TV [5]	560.20	532.95	560.50	560.50	530.00	741.42	662.00	485.10	13	532.05
SUNDARAM FIN	4599.20	4534.30	4560.00	4618.30	4510.00	50.50	5640.00	4200.00	28	4538.05
SundramFas [1]	826.45	848.90	830.35	866.90	830.35	84.37	1076.90	732.40	32	851.30
Sunflag Iro	365.70	379.10	363.00	384.85	361.20	581.34	427.05	191.85	32	379.30
SUNPHA A [1]	166.43	168.68	166.73	175.60	165.00	3024.13	204.25	108.20	-	168.75
SUNTECK RE [1]	304.95	308.15	306.00	310.30	301.05	260.56	478.30	270.30	-	308.55
Supraj Engg [1]	417.85	416.70	418.00	423.85	416.00	39.52	517.20	389.80	21	416.90
Supreme I [2]	3534.10	3521.00	3511.00	3570.80	3491.10	98.34	4740.00	3181.55	49	3522.85
Supreme Pet.	696.80	687.75	691.05	700.95	679.05	49.09	979.00	462.30	-	-
SupremeHoldi	49.84	53.69	49.85	55.25	48.02	527.58	114.80	43.20	-	-
Supriya Life	675.80	683.85	675.80	700.55	675.80	83.49	832.40	545.50	-	-
Suraj Est.	220.72	219.80	222.03	227.85	218.10	115.07	398.70	171.30	-	-
Suraksha Dia	291.90	306.60	287.50	316.50	287.50	116.44	352.50	224.10	-	-
Surya Ros [5]	239.70	247.00	239.05	249.95	238.60	757.61	358.30	187.00	17	247.20
Suryoday SFB	172.64	173.73	170.14	190.78	170.14	3004.33	190.78	115.41	-	-
SUVENFE S [1]	216.38	209.78	214.50	222.00	208.75	438.67	303.00	124.35	-	209.80
Suyog Telem.	784.50	760.65	783.95	796.75	750.30	40.90	988.80	526.50	-	-
Suzlon Ener [2]	51.52	53.10	51.31	53.74	51.31	93140.76	74.30	38.17	23	53.12
SwanCorp	322.55	324.40	325.30	329.60	321.95	557.21	526.70	295.65	-	-
Swaraj Engin	3805.10	3793.50	3805.00	3825.00	3765.00	9.82	4725.95	3300.00	23	3793.05
SWELECT	628.30	632.60	618.40	639.15	618.40	17.88	979.10	480.10	78	631.20
Swiggy	255.85	253.00	256.10	261.00	252.00	6249.75	474.00	252.00	-	-
SYMPHONY [2]	764.85	777.20	769.80	783.45	766.50	66.04	1338.20	684.05	32	777.70
Syncom Formu	13.57	13.78	13.40	13.95	13.36	1770.72	23.49	10.21	-	-
Syngene	478.75	463.25	478.00	478.75	462.00	750.66	728.40	380.00	52	463.55
Syrma SGS	1075.20	1035.65	1075.00	1104.65	1031.00	2245.59	1188.00	500.00	-	-

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Taj Gvk Hotl [2]	310.70	310.20	310.00	314.95	308.10	64.18	539.95	281.75	20	310.15
Talbr Auto [2]	312.75	333.70	310.00	341.35	310.00	422.20	350.00	220.00	26	333.05
Tamil.newspr	152.85	151.25	152.01	154.37	150.50	84.32	190.05	121.05	4	151.65
TamilNaduPet	86.58	87.83	87.00	88.90	86.07	85.37	129.35	77.57	8	87.68
Tanla Sol [1]	523.00	522.75	523.00	533.45	521.00	382.90	765.75	372.00	50	523.25
Tarsons Prod	214.70	216.84	215.57	220.59	215.00	64.39	458.00	164.45	-	-
TATA CAPITAL	309.45	305.35	310.00	312.00	304.55	3272.41	367.30	300.15	-	-
Tata Chem.	770.25	768.10	770.60	779.75	765.15	519.17	1026.00	581.30	32	768.55
TATA COMM	1539.90	1558.80	1545.00	1575.90	1532.30	278.57	2004.00	1323.00	57	1558.40

Exchange Traded Funds

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

BSE Stocks

NSE Trade for Trade